

# **TYPE 2 DIABETES COOKBOOK FOR BEGINNERS**

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*A Complete Guide of Nutritious, Tasty and Low-  
Glycaemic Diabetic Recipes to Control Your Blood  
Sugar, Incl. 60-Day Meal Plan*

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# Introduction

This book is created to support you in managing your type 2 diabetes through diet and nutrition. If you're newly diagnosed or you've been living with diabetes for some time, you're likely aware of how important a balanced diet is in controlling blood sugar levels. Our goal here is to provide you with practical, easy-to-implement dietary solutions that are not only nutritious but also delicious.

Type 2 diabetes requires careful management of your blood sugar levels, which are directly affected by what you eat. Each meal presents an opportunity to either positively influence your health or miss the mark on maintaining optimal glucose levels. A balanced diet can help manage glucose fluctuations, improve your overall health, and prevent potential complications linked to diabetes.

By choosing foods that have a low glycaemic index (GI), you're selecting options that slowly release glucose into the bloodstream, preventing spikes in blood sugar levels. Incorporating plenty of fresh vegetables, whole grains, lean proteins and healthy fats into your diet can make a world of difference. Understanding food labels and serving sizes is also key in making informed choices.

This cookbook is filled with recipes carefully curated to align with diabetic-friendly guidelines without compromising taste or variety. Whether it's breakfast to kickstart your day, a satisfying lunch or dinner or even snacks and desserts to enjoy guilt-free, you'll find plenty of options within these pages.

Moreover, the 60-day meal plan included in this book simplifies meal planning for you. Planning ahead takes out the guesswork and helps ensure you're feeding your body the nutrients it needs while enjoying every meal.

Each recipe within this book has been developed with attention to health benefits without sacrificing flavour. You will also find tips on portion control and how different food components like carbohydrates, proteins, and fats impact your blood sugar levels. In addition, we have dedicated sections for those special occasions – seasonal and holiday recipes so you can enjoy festivities without worry.

I understand that adapting a new way of eating can be overwhelming at first; however, this cookbook aims to make this transition as smooth as possible by empowering you with knowledge and tasty solutions. Diet is an integral part of managing type 2 diabetes effectively and these recipes are designed to help support your health while adding joy back into cooking and eating.

This cookbook reflects a commitment to helping you lead a full and healthy life by making informed nutritional choices every day—choices that support balanced blood sugar levels and enhance well-being.

# **CHAPTER 1**

## **Introduction to Type 2 Diabetes**

# Understanding Type 2 Diabetes

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Type 2 diabetes is a condition that affects how your body uses glucose (sugar), which is vital for your energy. When you eat food, it's turned into sugar in your bloodstream. For most people, a hormone called insulin helps this sugar get from your blood into your cells, where it's used as fuel.

In type 2 diabetes, though, the body either doesn't produce enough insulin or doesn't use it properly. This can lead to a buildup of sugar in your blood, which over time, can cause various health issues like heart disease, vision problems, and nerve damage among others.

Throughout my experience and discussions with individuals managing their diabetes, I've found that this condition often creeps up slowly and can go unnoticed for years. This is why having regular check-ups and being aware of any symptoms is so crucial.

## Symptoms and Diagnosis

*What should you be looking out for?* Well, there are some telltale signs that might suggest type 2 diabetes:

1. **Increased Thirst and Hunger:** If you're finding yourself more thirsty or hungry than usual despite eating regularly, it might be worth getting checked.
2. **Frequent Urination:** Having to dash for the loo more often than before is another sign.
3. **Fatigue:** Feeling unusually tired all the time could be more than just stress or lack of sleep.
4. **Blurred Vision:** Changes in your vision could be linked back to fluctuating blood sugar levels.
5. **Slow-Healing Sores:** If cuts or bruises take longer than usual to heal, it may not just be ageing.
6. **Weight Loss:** Shedding weight without trying could seem great at first but might indicate something's amiss.

If some of these symptoms sound familiar, I'd recommend speaking with a healthcare professional who can offer guidance tailored specifically for your needs. Diagnosing type 2 diabetes typically involves a straightforward process:

1. **HbA1c Test:** This blood test gives an average of your glucose levels over the past two to three months.
2. **Fasting Plasma Glucose Test:** Here you're asked to fast overnight before having your blood sugar levels measured.

3. **Oral Glucose Tolerance Test (OGTT):** Initially fasted then consuming a sugary drink followed by testing glucose levels over several hours.

These tests are usually conducted at your local GP's surgery or a clinic with recommendations possibly varying slightly depending on personal circumstances. Keeping an eye out for the symptoms I mentioned earlier can really make a difference in early detection and management.

## **The Role of Insulin and Blood Sugar Levels**

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Insulin is a hormone produced by the pancreas, an organ located just behind the stomach. It plays a critical role in how our bodies use and store glucose, also known as blood sugar. Think of insulin as a key that unlocks the doors of your body's cells, allowing glucose to enter. Once inside, this glucose is used for energy or stored for future use.

In people without diabetes, insulin works efficiently to maintain normal blood sugar levels. However, in those with Type 2 diabetes, either the body doesn't produce enough insulin or it doesn't use insulin effectively. This situation leads to higher-than-normal levels of blood glucose, a condition called hyperglycaemia.

### **Blood Sugar Levels Explained**

Blood sugar levels refer to the amount of glucose present in your bloodstream at any given time. These levels fluctuate throughout the day due to factors like what you eat, physical activity, and stress. Maintaining them within a normal range is essential for overall health.

For those with Type 2 diabetes, tracking blood sugar becomes even more critical. Consistently high blood sugar can lead to complications such as heart disease, nerve damage, and kidney issues.

*Normal Blood Sugar Ranges:*

*Fasting (Before eating): 4.0 – 5.4 mmol/L*

*After meals (2 hours): <7.8 mmol/L*

Monitoring these levels regularly can help you understand how different foods and activities affect your condition.

| BLOOD GLUCOSE MONITORING CHART |                                   |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| TIME                           | TARGET BLOOD SUGAR LEVEL (MMOL/L) |
| <i>Fasting</i>                 | 4.0 – 5.4                         |
| <i>Before Meal</i>             | 4 – 7                             |
| <i>2 Hours After Meal</i>      | <7.8                              |
| <i>Bedtime</i>                 | 6 – 8                             |

*Note: These targets can vary based on individual health goals; consult with your healthcare team for personalised advice.*

### How Insulin Affects Your Diet

Having Type 2 diabetes requires considering insulin's role in metabolizing carbohydrates—the main source of glucose in our diet. When we consume carbohydrate-rich foods like bread, pasta, or fruits, our bodies break them down into glucose, raising blood sugar levels.

The pancreas releases insulin to help cells absorb this glucose from the bloodstream. Balancing your intake of carbs with your body's ability to produce or utilize insulin effectively is key. Many individuals find success with meal planning that keeps carbohydrate consumption consistent throughout the day—known as carbohydrate counting or “*carb counting*.” This approach prevents sudden spikes or drops in blood sugar after meals.

## Myths and Facts about Type 2 Diabetes

Nowadays, it's more important than ever to clear up the myths and facts surrounding Type 2 diabetes. This condition is on the rise, and misinformation can lead to poor decisions regarding diet, lifestyle, and health management. Understanding what is true and what is false about Type 2 diabetes can empower you to make informed choices that impact your well-being.

### 1. MYTH: Eating too much sugar causes Type 2 Diabetes.

**FACT:** Type 2 Diabetes is influenced by diet, but it's more about overall lifestyle factors, including obesity, physical inactivity, and genetics, rather than sugar intake alone. Excessive consumption of sugary foods can lead to weight gain, which in turn increases the risk of developing Type 2 Diabetes.



**2. MYTH: Only overweight or obese people get Type 2 Diabetes.**

*FACT:* While being overweight is a significant risk factor, it is possible for normal-weight individuals to develop Type 2 Diabetes. Genetics and other lifestyle factors also play crucial roles.

**3. MYTH: People with diabetes should avoid all carbohydrates.**

*FACT:* Carbohydrates are an essential part of a balanced diet. The key is choosing complex carbs like whole grains, vegetables, and fruits that are high in fibre, which helps manage blood sugar levels effectively.

**4. MYTH: Fats in your diet should be avoided.**

*FACT:* Not all fats are bad. Healthy fats found in avocados, nuts, seeds, and olive oil can be beneficial for heart health and do not negatively impact blood sugar levels when consumed in moderation.

**5. MYTH: People with diabetes can't eat sweets or chocolate.**

*FACT:* Sweets and chocolate can be enjoyed occasionally as part of a healthy diet if portion sizes are controlled and factored into the overall meal plan.

**6. MYTH: You don't need medication if you feel fine.**

*FACT:* Type 2 Diabetes is often silent in its early stages but can still cause long-term damage if not managed properly. Regular monitoring and following prescribed treatments are crucial even if you feel well.

**7. MYTH: Insulin therapy means you've failed to manage your diabetes.**

*FACT:* Insulin therapy is not a sign of failure but rather one of many treatment options available to maintain optimal blood sugar control when other medications are not sufficient.

**8. MYTH: You can "catch" diabetes from someone else.**

*FACT:* Diabetes is not contagious at all; it can't be caught like a cold or the flu as it involves non-infectious factors relating to one's own health condition.

**9. MYTH: Fruits should be avoided due to their natural sugars.**

*FACT:* Fruits provide essential nutrients and fibre that aid blood sugar management when eaten in appropriate portions as part of a balanced diet.

**10. MYTH: Skipping meals helps lower blood sugar.**

*FACT:* Skipping meals can lead to irregular blood sugar levels and overeating later on; it's important to maintain regular meal times throughout the day to keep those levels stable.

**11. MYTH: Once on medication, lifestyle changes aren't important.**

*FACT:* Medication works best when combined with healthy eating habits, regular exercise, stress management, and adequate sleep. These lifestyle changes help in significantly controlling blood sugar levels naturally.

## **CHAPTER 2**

# **The Importance of Diet in Managing Type 2 Diabetes**

# How Diet Affects Blood Sugar Levels

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When it comes to managing type 2 diabetes, understanding how our diet affects blood sugar levels is essential. Eating well can dramatically influence blood sugar control, and with the correct knowledge, it's possible to enjoy food without fear.

Blood sugar levels fluctuate based on what and when you eat. Carbohydrates have the most immediate effect on blood sugar as they are broken down into glucose, which circulates in the blood. Foods high in carbohydrates include bread, rice, pasta, and starchy vegetables like potatoes. It doesn't mean you have to avoid these foods altogether; the key lies in choosing the right amount and type of carbohydrates.

One practical aspect of choosing carbohydrates is looking at their quality – such as whether they're wholegrain or refined. Wholegrain options typically have more fibre and nutrients, and they tend to raise blood sugar more slowly than refined ones. Fibre is essential as it helps slow down digestion, resulting in a slower release of glucose into the bloodstream.

Another vital element influencing blood sugar levels is protein. Including protein in your meals can help control how quickly your blood sugar rises after eating a carbohydrate-rich meal. Protein sources include lean meat, poultry, fish, eggs, beans, lentils, tofu, and dairy products like milk or yogurt.

Fat often gets a bad rap but not all fats are created equal. Healthy fats found in nuts, seeds, avocados and oily fish can be beneficial in a balanced diet and may improve heart health — something people with diabetes should keep an eye on. While fat doesn't raise blood sugar directly, consuming it alongside carbohydrates can help slow down the absorption of sugars.

We also need to talk about portion sizes; they matter significantly when managing diabetes. It's not just about what you eat but also how much you eat that impacts your blood sugar levels. Portions need to be balanced across all components: carbs, proteins, fat, and fibre to manage your diabetes effectively.

When arranging meals throughout the day, frequency matters too. Eating smaller meals more frequently ensures steadier insulin levels compared to having fewer large meals. Skipping meals can cause ***hypoglycemia*** (low blood sugar) if you're on certain diabetes medications.

| COMPONENT            | IMPACT ON BLOOD SUGAR                     |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| <i>Carbohydrates</i> | ↑ Most immediate impact                   |
| <i>Protein</i>       | ↓ Slows carbohydrate digestion            |
| <i>Healthy Fats</i>  | - No direct impact but beneficial overall |
| <i>Fibre</i>         | ↓ Slows absorption of glucose             |

Finally, don't forget hydration. Water is best for hydration since sugary drinks can spike your blood sugars rapidly unnoticed. As always with diabetes management, it's crucial to keep track of how different foods affect your personal blood sugar levels through regular monitoring and adjusting as needed based on those results.

## Understanding the Glycaemic Index

The glycaemic index is a system that ranks foods based on how quickly they raise our blood sugar levels after eating. Foods are scored on a scale from 0 to 100. Low GI foods have a score of 55 or less, medium GI foods fall between 56 and 69, and high GI foods score over 70. This ranking can be a crucial tool for anyone looking to manage their blood sugar more effectively.

Consuming high-GI foods can cause rapid spikes in blood sugar levels. For someone with type 2 diabetes, this can potentially lead to complications or make managing the condition more challenging. Low-GI foods, on the other hand, release glucose slowly and steadily. This steady release helps keep blood sugar levels within an acceptable range.

Let's take a look at some examples of foods categorized by their GI scores:

| GI CATEGORY           | FOODS                         |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------|
| <i>Low (0-55)</i>     | Lentils, chickpeas, oats      |
| <i>Medium (56-69)</i> | Whole wheat bread, brown rice |
| <i>High (70-100)</i>  | White bread, sugary cereals   |

When you compare white bread to whole grains like oats or lentils, it's clear that choosing lower-GI options can be beneficial for controlling blood sugar. Now, *how do we use this information in everyday life?* One way is by swapping high-GI foods with lower ones. Let's say you're used to

having white toast for breakfast—opting for wholegrain bread instead could help regulate your morning blood sugar levels better. Similarly, replacing white rice with brown rice is another small change that could make a difference.

Another important consideration is that the glycaemic index doesn't take portion size into account. This is where the concept of glycaemic load (GL) comes into play. GL considers both the quality (GI value) and quantity (grams of carbohydrate) per serving size of food. However, focusing primarily on the GI can still provide a good foundation for making healthier choices.

Additionally, factors like preparation method and food ripeness can also influence a food's GI. For instance, cooking pasta al dente results in a lower GI compared to cooking it longer until it's soft. Similarly, ripe fruits have higher GI scores than when they are less ripe because sugars develop as fruits ripen.

While incorporating low-GI foods into our diets seems simple enough in theory, it's equally important to enjoy a wide variety of foods to ensure we're getting all necessary nutrients. This doesn't mean avoiding high-GI items altogether but being thoughtful about when and how much we consume them.

Experimenting with balanced meals that include proteins and fats alongside carbohydrates can help slow down digestion and minimise spikes in blood sugar levels as well. For instance, pairing beans with lean meats or preparing dishes using olive oil isn't just tasty—it's beneficial for your overall health.

# Benefits of a Balanced and Nutritious Diet

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Eating properly can keep blood sugar levels steady, improving overall health, and enhancing the quality of life. A balanced diet consists of a variety of foods in the right proportions. This includes fruits, vegetables, whole grains, lean proteins, and healthy fats. The key is to find a harmony that suits your lifestyle while also helping you control your diabetes effectively. Let's break down the components of such a diet and see why they matter.

## **Fruits and Vegetables: Nature's Nutritional Powerhouses**

Fruits and vegetables are packed with essential vitamins, minerals, and fibre. They are low in calories but high in nutrients that can help boost your immune system. Including a variety of colours on your plate ensures that you're getting a range of nutrients.

For those with Type 2 diabetes, non-starchy vegetables such as spinach, broccoli, tomatoes, and peppers are excellent choices. They have little impact on blood sugar levels and provide that much-needed fibre that aids digestion and helps maintain healthy cholesterol levels.

## **Whole Grains: A Steady Source of Energy**

Unlike refined grains which are stripped of beneficial nutrients during processing, whole grains like brown rice, oats, whole wheat bread, and quinoa retain their fibre content. Fibre is beneficial for adding bulk to your meal without adding calories. It takes longer to digest which helps keep you fuller for longer periods and slows down the absorption of sugar into the bloodstream.

Incorporating whole grains into your meals can help in maintaining steady blood glucose levels—a vital aspect when managing diabetes.

## **Lean Proteins: For Strength and Repair**

Proteins are fundamental as they provide energy for daily activities and repair tissues. Lean sources include chicken breast without skin, turkey, fish like salmon rich in omega-3 fatty acids, tofu, legumes, beans like lentils and chickpeas.

Including sufficient protein in every meal can prevent muscle loss while promoting healing in tissues. Furthermore, proteins have minimal impact on blood sugar which makes them an essential part of diabetic management.

## **Healthy Fats: Essential for Heart Health**

Not all fats are bad! Healthy fats found in avocados, nuts (such as almonds or walnuts), seeds (chia or flax seeds), olives, and oils such as olive oil or canola oil offer significant health benefits. These fats help protect heart health—a prime concern for those with diabetes due to increased cardiovascular risk.

Healthy fats can help improve total cholesterol levels by boosting good cholesterol (HDL) and reducing bad cholesterol (LDL).

## **Hydration: Don't Neglect Your Fluids**

Water should be your primary source of hydration throughout the day but other low-calorie options like herbal teas can be included too. Staying hydrated is important for all bodily functions including digestion. Sugary drinks should be avoided as they can cause spikes in blood sugar levels.

*While these dietary recommendations form an essential part of managing diabetes, it's important to check in regularly with nutritionists or healthcare providers who can offer personalized advice suitable for your unique health needs. The aim is not perfection but progress towards making healthier choices that support optimal blood sugar control and overall wellbeing.*



## **CHAPTER 3**

# **Stocking Your Diabetic Kitchen**

# Essential Ingredients for a Diabetic-Friendly Kitchen

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A diabetic-friendly kitchen allows us to prepare meals that maintain stable blood sugar levels and keep us feeling our best. Now, I'm going to walk you through some essential ingredients you should consider having in your kitchen.

1. **Whole Grains:** Whole grains like oats, barley, and quinoa are a staple for a diabetic-friendly kitchen. They are packed with fibre, which helps to stabilise blood sugar levels by slowing down the absorption of sugar into the bloodstream. Fibre is essential for managing diabetes as it aids in maintaining healthy digestion and keeping you fuller for longer periods.
2. **Leafy Greens:** Spinach, kale, and other leafy greens should be part of your diet plan. They are low in carbohydrates and calories but high in nutrients like Vitamin C. Research suggests that people with diabetes have lower Vitamin C levels, and increasing your intake of leafy greens can prove beneficial for overall health.
3. **Healthy Fats:** Avocados, nuts, seeds, and olive oil offer healthy fats that are essential in a diabetic-friendly diet. These fats help to reduce inflammation and improve insulin sensitivity. A moderate amount of fats is important for brain function and cellular health.
4. **Lean Proteins:** Chicken breast, turkey, tofu, and fish such as salmon are excellent choices for lean proteins. They help build the body's tissues and manage hunger without causing blood sugar spikes. Always opt for grilling or baking instead of frying to keep meals as healthy as possible.
5. **Non-Starchy Vegetables:** Broccoli, carrots, peppers, and tomatoes are non-starchy vegetables rich in vitamins, minerals, and antioxidants. These vegetables are crucial because they can be consumed liberally while managing carbohydrate intake.
6. **Sweet Potatoes:** Sweet potatoes are an excellent choice because they contain fibre and several nutrients while having a moderate GI compared to regular potatoes when cooked correctly (preferably boiled or baked).
7. **Berries:** Berries such as blueberries, strawberries, raspberries, and blackberries provide sweetness but are comparatively lower on the glycaemic index than other fruits. They are packed with antioxidants which support overall wellbeing.

8. **Beans and Legumes:** Beans like lentils and chickpeas are an excellent source of complex carbohydrates full of fibre and protein. They help control blood sugar by preventing peaks through their slow-release energy format.
9. **Herbs and Spices:** Herbs and spices like cinnamon, turmeric, garlic, coriander, and basil not only add flavour without calories but also possess properties beneficial for blood glucose control and reducing inflammation.
10. **Low-Fat Dairy or Dairy Alternatives:** Choosing low-fat options of milk, yoghurt or opting for unsweetened plant-based alternatives such as almond or soy milk can work well since they have lower carbohydrate content compared to full-fat versions or carbohydrates-heavy alternatives.
11. **Sugar Alternatives:** For those who need a sweetener occasionally, stevia or artificial sweeteners like sucralose (found in many low-calorie drinks) offer sweetness without increasing blood glucose levels substantially.
12. **Whole Fruits:** Apples and pears make good choices when seeking snacks that satisfy without upsetting blood sugar balance due to their soluble fibre content aiding digestion control.

*A kitchen replete with these ingredients is well on its way to supporting a healthier lifestyle conducive to managing diabetes effectively—understanding what each ingredient offers empowers us to make better choices in our culinary adventures!*

## List of Low-Glycaemic Index Foods

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As we know, the glycaemic index (GI) measures how a carbohydrate-containing food raises blood glucose levels. Foods are ranked on a scale of 0 to 100, with higher values given to foods that cause a rapid rise in blood sugar levels. For those managing type 2 diabetes, choosing foods with a low GI is important for maintaining steady blood glucose levels.

A low-GI food is one with a score of 55 or less. Consuming these can help prevent spikes in your blood sugar, thus assisting in diabetes management. I've put together a concise list of some common low-GI foods that you can include in your daily diet.

### 1. Whole Grains and Cereals

- a) *Oats:* Rolled or steel-cut oats have a GI typically around 55. They provide lasting energy and fibre.

- b) *Barley*: With a GI of about 28, this grain is both versatile and nutritious.
- c) *Quinoa*: Packed with protein, quinoa is not only low-GI but also gluten-free and rich in nutrients.
- d) *Brown Rice*: This whole grain has a GI of around 50, making it a better choice than white rice.

## 2. Legumes

- a) *Lentils*: With a GI score of about 32, lentils are not only low in sugar but high in protein and fibre.
- b) *Chickpeas*: Scoring around 28 on the GI scale, they offer fibre and protein without sharply increasing glucose.
- c) *Kidney Beans*: These are another fantastic option packed with fibre and protein that slowly release energy.

## 3. Vegetables

- a) *Carrots*: They're not just for rabbits! Carrots can complement any meal with their low-GI benefits.
- b) *Sweet Potatoes*: Not only delicious but sweet potatoes have a much lower GI compared to regular potatoes.
- c) *Broccoli*: A cruciferous vegetable loaded with nutrients yet very low in carbohydrates.

## 4. Fruits

- a) *Apples*: Crunchy and satisfying, apples have a decent amount of fibre aiding slow digestion.
- b) *Berries (strawberries, blueberries)*: These fruits are low-GI and full of antioxidants, making them a healthy treat.
- c) *Oranges*: While sweet, oranges actually rank lower on the GI scale due to their natural sugars being encased in fibrous fruit tissues.

## 5. Dairy Products

- a) *Milk*: Both full-fat and skimmed milk have GIs close to 30–40.

- b) *Yoghurt*: Natural yoghurt generally keeps to around 35–38; opt for unsweetened varieties when possible.

Remember, it's not just about individual foods but also how you combine them in meals. Pairing low-GI foods with moderate or even high-GI foods can help maintain better overall control over blood sugar levels. For example, enjoy brown rice alongside grilled chicken and plenty of vegetables for a balanced meal.

As you prepare your meals using these foods, always consider portion sizes. Even low-GI foods can affect your glucose levels if eaten in large amounts. It's essential to listen to your body's signals and adhere to tailored dietary recommendations from healthcare professionals.

Don't forget that everyone's response to different foods can vary slightly due to individual health conditions and differences in metabolism. Therefore, monitoring your blood sugar levels after meals will give you direct feedback on how various foods affect you personally.

## **Tips on Choosing Fresh and Healthy Ingredients**

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Selecting fresh and healthy ingredients is an essential step in preparing meals that are not just delicious but also nourishing. Here, I'll share some tips on how you can make the best choices every time you shop.

### **1. Choose Whole Fruits and Vegetables**

When it comes to picking fruits and vegetables, opt for whole, fresh ones rather than processed or pre-packaged options. Fresh produce retains more nutrients and has no added sugars, which is crucial for keeping your blood sugar levels stable. Look for vibrant colours and firm textures. For instance, bright green broccoli or crisp apples are usually fresher and harbour more nutrients. Seasonal produce is often fresher and cheaper, so keep an eye out for what's in season.

### **2. Prioritise Whole Grains**

Whole grains should be a staple in your kitchen. Unlike refined grains, whole grains maintain their bran and germ, making them higher in fibre and nutrients and having a lower impact on blood sugar levels. When choosing bread or pasta, read labels to ensure the first ingredient is a whole grain like whole wheat or oats.

### 3. Understanding Labels

Labels can be tricky but understanding them is key to choosing healthier options. Look for foods with low levels of saturated fats, sugars, and sodium. Make sure to check serving sizes on nutritional labels as well; sometimes what seems like a small snack can contain multiple servings!

| NUTRIENT      | CHOOSE FOODS WITH... |
|---------------|----------------------|
| <i>Fat</i>    | Low Saturated Fat    |
| <i>Sugar</i>  | Low Added Sugars     |
| <i>Sodium</i> | Low Sodium           |

4. **Leverage Protein Sources:** Proteins are essential for repairing tissues and can help maintain steady blood sugar levels. Opt for lean protein sources such as skinless chicken, turkey, fish, beans, and lentils. Vegetarian proteins like beans and legumes also boost your fibre intake.

5. **Dairy Decisions:** For those who include dairy in their diets, opt for low-fat or non-fat versions of milk, yogurt, and cheese. These contain less saturated fat while still providing necessary calcium and vitamins.

6. **Mindful Snacks:** We all love snacks! Choose nuts or seeds without added salt or sugars as a healthier alternative to crisps or sweets. They're not only nutritious but also filling due to their high fibre content.

7. **Hydration Helpers:** Though not always considered 'ingredients,' beverages play a pivotal role in your diet. Water should always be the top choice for staying hydrated. If you crave something different, unsweetened herbal teas can add variety without impacting your blood sugar.

8. **Shopping Smart:** Shopping with intention can make all the difference. Try planning your meals ahead of time based on the above tips to avoid impulse buys of less healthy foods. Shopping the perimeter of the store often leads you to fresher foods compared to the middle aisles stocked with processed items.

These tips are straightforward but effective steps toward assembling ingredients that cherish both flavour and health. Remember always to listen to your body's needs—everyone's nutritional requirements can differ slightly based on individual conditions and lifestyles

## **CHAPTER 4**

# **Nutritional Guidelines for Diabetics**

# Understanding Carbohydrates, Proteins, and Fats

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These three macronutrients are the foundation of any diet and directly influence blood sugar levels, which is especially important when living with diabetes. Carbohydrates, proteins, and fats each play distinct roles in our body. Being knowledgeable about them helps us make informed food choices and maintain proper blood glucose levels.

**Carbohydrates** are the body's main source of energy. They're found in foods such as bread, rice, pasta, potatoes, fruits, and some dairy products. When you consume carbohydrates, your body breaks them down into glucose, which enters your bloodstream and raises blood sugar levels. For those managing type 2 diabetes, it's crucial to understand the types of carbohydrates you're consuming. There are simple carbs like sugars found in sweets and complex carbs found in whole grains and legumes. Complex carbohydrates are generally healthier choices as they contain more fibre and are digested slower.

*Fiber* is a type of carbohydrate that the body can't digest. It's found naturally in plant-based foods like vegetables, fruits, beans, and whole grains. Fiber is important because it can help regulate blood sugar levels by slowing sugar absorption into the bloodstream. Moreover, it helps you feel full longer, which can aid in weight management—a key aspect of diabetes control.

**Proteins** are essential for building and repairing tissues in our body. They're made up of amino acids and can be sourced from both animal (like chicken, fish, eggs) and plant-based foods (such as beans, lentils, tofu). Proteins have minimal effect on blood sugar levels; they provide steady energy without spiking blood glucose levels sharply. Including enough protein in your meals not only supports muscle health but also helps keep you full between meals.

**Fats** often get a bad reputation but they're crucial for storing energy and supporting cell function. However, not all fats are created equal. Saturated fats found in butter, cheese, and red meat can increase the risk of heart disease if consumed excessively. On the other hand, unsaturated fats found in olives, avocados, nuts, and oily fish like salmon can be beneficial to heart health when consumed in moderation.

Understanding how to balance these macronutrients is key for anyone managing type 2 diabetes. Here's a simple breakdown to help visualize their roles:



| MACRONUTRIENT        | SOURCE              | DIABETES IMPACT                           |
|----------------------|---------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| <i>Carbohydrates</i> | Bread, rice, fruit  | Raises blood sugar; choose complex carbs  |
| <i>Protein</i>       | Chicken, tofu       | Steady energy; doesn't spike blood sugar  |
| <i>Fat</i>           | Olive oil, avocados | Energy storage; focus on unsaturated fats |

Including a balanced mix of these macronutrients at each meal can help maintain steady blood sugar levels throughout the day. A diet focusing on complex carbohydrates rich in fibre—paired with lean proteins and healthy fats—is beneficial not just for those with type 2 diabetes but also for overall health.

## Portion Control and Serving Sizes

It's not just about what we eat, but also how much we eat. Learning how to manage portion sizes can have an impact on blood sugar levels, weight management, and overall health. A portion is the amount of food that you choose to eat at one time, whether in a restaurant, from a package, or at home. Serving size, on the other hand, is a standard amount of food – such as a cup or an ounce – used to help give advice about how much to eat. These terms are often used interchangeably, but it's important to understand the difference because they can greatly affect your daily caloric intake and nutrient balance.

When we're eating at home or dining out, it's easy to misjudge portions. Many times, we base our portions on what we're served or what we're used to seeing in restaurants without realising that these are often much larger than the recommended serving sizes.

Understanding serving sizes can help us make healthier choices daily. For example:

1. A typical serving size for cooked pasta is about the size of your fist (roughly 75g before cooking), while a meat portion should typically be about the size of the palm of your hand (roughly 100g-150g).
2. When it comes to vegetables, aim for about two handfuls (or 80g). This might be more generous since vegetables are low in calories but high in nutrients.
3. For dairy products like cheese, consider roughly the size of two thumbs together (about 30g).

These benchmarks aren't strict rules but useful guidelines that help maintain balanced meals and control carbohydrate intake. Here's a table to help with some common foods:

| FOOD ITEM         | RECOMMENDED SERVING SIZE                         |
|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| <i>Rice</i>       | 125g cooked (about the size of a computer mouse) |
| <i>Bread</i>      | 1 slice                                          |
| <i>Meat/Fish</i>  | Palm-sized piece                                 |
| <i>Vegetables</i> | 100g raw or 90g cooked                           |
| <i>Fruit</i>      | Medium-sized piece or 110g berries               |
| <i>Cheese</i>     | Two thumb-sized pieces                           |

Portion control doesn't mean you have to restrict yourself from enjoying your favourite meals. It simply means knowing how much energy (calories) and nutrients are in what you're eating so you can make more informed choices.

A helpful tip is using smaller plates when serving meals. It's been proven that this can subconsciously encourage us to consume less at meal times because our minds associate small plates filled with food as being enough to satisfy hunger. Similarly, paying attention to hunger cues - like eating slowly and stopping when you're full - rather than simply eating until your plate is empty can prevent overeating.

Planning meals ahead also maintain portion control. Preparing balanced meals with correct serving sizes can take control over spur-of-the-moment decisions that lead to higher calorie intake.

## Reading Food Labels: What to Look For

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When we're at a grocery store, every item on the shelf comes with a label—a treasure trove of information. The first thing you'll want to spot is the serving size mentioned on the packaging. This little detail is crucial because all the nutritional information that follows is based on the serving size. If a package contains multiple servings, eating it all means multiplying each nutrient you consume by that number.

Next up, we need to pay special attention to carbohydrates. Carbohydrates directly impact blood sugar levels, so keeping them in check is vital. On the label, look for “*Total Carbohydrates.*” Underneath this heading, you might notice “*Dietary Fibre*” and “*Sugars.*” Fibre is our friend because it helps slow down sugar absorption and can aid in keeping blood sugar stable. Higher fibre content is usually a good sign. On the other hand, sugars could contribute to quicker spikes in your blood glucose levels, so be mindful of their quantity.

Another key component on these labels is fats. You'll often see *Total Fats* broken down into saturated fats and unsaturated fats. Unsaturated fats can be beneficial for heart health and are found in foods like nuts and avocados. Saturated fats should be consumed in moderation as they can affect cholesterol levels.

*Protein* content is something else we should consider—it's essential for maintaining muscle mass and helps with feeling fuller for longer periods. It's less likely than carbohydrates or fats to impact blood glucose levels negatively. One often overlooked but vital part of food labels is *sodium* content. High sodium intake has been linked with increased blood pressure, so keeping an eye on this number is essential for overall health.

*Here's a simple trick:* if you're ever confused or confronted with multiple products, look out for products labelled as low-sodium or reduced-fat; they typically offer healthier alternatives.

Vitamins and minerals are also detailed on labels. Look out for essential ones like Calcium and Iron. These are important for bone health and overall energy levels respectively.

| NUTRIENT                   | WHAT TO LOOK FOR                                               |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>Serving Size</i>        | Compare to your portion sizes                                  |
| <i>Total Carbohydrates</i> | Opt for lower values; higher fibre content                     |
| <i>Sugars</i>              | Keep as low as possible                                        |
| <i>Total Fats</i>          | Prefer lower saturated fats; consider healthy unsaturated fats |
| <i>Proteins</i>            | Beneficial but find balance                                    |
| <i>Sodium</i>              | Lower numbers are better; opt for low-sodium varieties         |
| <i>Vitamins/Minerals</i>   | Ensure adequate daily allowance                                |

Remember, reading food labels isn't about restriction but about making informed choices that align with our nutritional needs while managing Type 2 Diabetes effectively.

## The Importance of Fiber in a Diabetic Diet

When managing type 2 diabetes, incorporating fibre into your diet is not just a recommendation, it's essential. Fibre is important in controlling blood sugar levels, improving heart health, aiding weight management, and enhancing overall digestive health. Fibre is a type of carbohydrate that the body cannot digest. Unlike other carbs that break down into sugar molecules and raise blood glucose levels, fibre passes through the body undigested. This characteristic makes it particularly beneficial for individuals with diabetes.

*There are two types of fibre:* soluble and insoluble. Soluble fibre dissolves in water to form a gel-like substance. It can help lower blood glucose levels by slowing down the digestive process, which leads to more gradual rises in blood sugar after meals. Foods rich in soluble fibre include oats, apples, carrots, and beans.

Insoluble fibre does not dissolve in water and remains intact as it passes through the gut. It helps keep bowel movements regular and supports overall digestive health. Good sources of insoluble fibre include whole grains, nuts, seeds, and vegetables like cauliflower and green beans.

For someone with type 2 diabetes, the benefits of including adequate amounts of fibre in the diet are manifold:

1. **Blood Sugar Control:** Fibre can help stabilise blood glucose levels by slowing down digestion and absorption of carbohydrates. This means less dramatic spikes after meals — a crucial factor for managing diabetes effectively.
2. **Improved Heart Health:** A high-fibre diet can contribute to lowering cholesterol levels. Soluble fibre helps reduce levels of LDL or “bad” cholesterol in the bloodstream. Given that people with diabetes are at higher risk for heart disease, managing cholesterol through dietary choices is particularly important.
3. **Weight Management:** Foods high in fibre tend to be more filling than low-fibre foods because they add bulk without extra calories. This can help manage weight by promoting satiety so you feel full longer after eating.
4. **Digestive Health:** Regular consumption of both soluble and insoluble fibres supports overall gut health by preventing constipation and promoting regular bowel movements.

For those new to adjusting their diet for diabetes management, gradually increasing your intake of fibre-rich foods is advisable to avoid gastrointestinal discomfort like bloating or gas.

| FOOD ITEM       | TYPE OF FIBRE | SERVING SIZE  | FIBRE CONTENT (G) |
|-----------------|---------------|---------------|-------------------|
| <i>Oats</i>     | Soluble       | 240g (cooked) | 4                 |
| <i>Apples</i>   | Soluble       | 1 medium      | 4                 |
| <i>Broccoli</i> | Insoluble     | 91g           | 5                 |
| <i>Lentils</i>  | Both          | 100g (cooked) | 8                 |
| <i>Almonds</i>  | Insoluble     | 23 nuts       | 3.5               |

Incorporating these foods into everyday meals can make a real difference without requiring drastic changes to one's dietary habits. Begin your day with a warm bowl of porridge made from oats topped with fresh apple slices for breakfast or add lentils to your lunchtime salad for an extra boost of protein and texture. Don't forget snacks like almonds that are not only high in insoluble fibres but also provide healthy fats crucial for an energised day.

## **CHAPTER 5**

### **Breakfast Recipes**

# Nutritious Breakfast Smoothies and Shakes

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## 1. Berry Spinach Smoothie

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 150g fresh spinach
- 100g mixed berries (strawberries, blueberries, raspberries)
- 250ml almond milk
- 1 tbsp chia seeds
- A few ice cubes

**Directions:**

1. Wash the spinach and berries thoroughly. Add all ingredients to a blender.
2. Blend until smooth and creamy. Pour into glasses and serve immediately.

**Tips:** For a thicker consistency, add more ice cubes. You can also add a tsp of honey for additional sweetness if needed.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 110; Fat: 3g; Carbs: 18g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 85mg; Sugar: 9g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 6g

## 2. Avocado and Mint Smoothie

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 1 ripe avocado (about 200g)
- Handful of fresh mint leaves
- 200ml unsweetened coconut milk
- Juice of half a lime
- A small handful of cucumber slices

**Directions:**

1. Cut the avocado in half, remove the stone, and scoop out the flesh. Place all ingredients in a blender.
2. Blend until smooth and creamy. Serve chilled and enjoy immediately.

**Tips:** Garnish with a sprig of mint for extra freshness.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 170; Fat: 14g; Carbs: 10g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 60mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 7g

### 3. Peanut Butter Banana Shake

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 2 medium bananas, peeled
- 2 tbsp natural peanut butter
- 250ml unsweetened almond milk
- 1 tbsp chia seeds
- 100ml Greek yoghurt

**Directions:**

1. Peel the bananas and add them to a blender along with the peanut butter, almond milk, chia seeds, and Greek yoghurt.



2. Blend until smooth and creamy. Pour into glasses and serve immediately.

**Tips:** For an extra cold shake, use frozen bananas.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 220; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 25g; Protein: 9g; Sodium: 110mg; Sugar: 15g; Cholesterol: 6mg; Fibre: 5g

## 4. Kale and Kiwi Smoothie

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 150g fresh kale leaves, washed and stems removed
- 3 ripe kiwis
- 250ml coconut water
- Juice of half a lemon (about 15ml)
- Small handful of fresh mint leaves

**Directions:**

1. Peel and slice the kiwis, then place them in a blender with the kale, coconut water, lemon juice, and mint leaves.
2. Blend until smooth. You may add a little extra coconut water if needed for consistency.
3. Serve immediately in chilled glasses for freshness.

**Tips:** Add a few ice cubes while blending for a cooler drink.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 120; Fat: 1g; Carbs: 27g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 70mg; Sugar: 16g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 8g

## 5. Chia Seed and Cinnamon Shake

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 250ml unsweetened almond milk
- 30g chia seeds
- 1/2 tsp ground cinnamon
- 10g almond butter
- 5ml vanilla extract
- Sweetener to taste (optional)

**Directions:**

1. In a blender, combine the almond milk, chia seeds, cinnamon, almond butter, and vanilla.
2. Blend on high speed until smooth and creamy. Taste and add a sweetener if desired. Blend again briefly to combine. Serve.

**Tips:** You can prepare this shake in advance by soaking the chia seeds in almond milk overnight. This will make them swell and create a thicker texture.

**Serving size:** 200ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 150; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 11g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 100mg; Sugar: 1g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 8g

## 6. Blueberry and Almond Smoothie

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 150g fresh blueberries or frozen blueberries (thawed)
- 250ml unsweetened almond milk
- 10g almond butter
- 30g rolled oats
- Sweetener to taste (optional)

**Directions:**

1. Add the blueberries, almond milk, almond butter, and rolled oats to a blender. Blend on high speed until smooth and well combined.
2. Add a sweetener if preferred. Blend again briefly to integrate the sweetener. Serve.

**Tips:** For extra nutrition, add a handful of spinach for added fibre without altering the taste significantly.

**Serving size:** 200ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 180; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 25g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 60mg; Sugar: 5g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 5g

## 7. Coconut and Lime Green Shake

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 200g baby spinach
- 150ml coconut milk
- 200ml water
- Juice of 1 lime
- 1 tbsp chia seeds
- 1 tbsp honey (optional)

**Directions:**

1. In a blender, combine the spinach, coconut milk, water, lime juice, and chia seeds. Blend on high speed until smooth and creamy.
2. Taste and add honey if desired for sweetness. Blend again until well-mixed. Serve.

**Tips:** Ensure the spinach is fresh for optimal flavour.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 95; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 8g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 25mg; Sugar: 6g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 3g

## 8. Mango Turmeric Smoothie

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 300g ripe mango flesh, peeled & cubed
- 200ml unsweetened almond milk
- 100ml water
- ½ tsp ground turmeric
- Juice of half a lemon
- Pinch of black pepper

**Directions:**

1. Add the mangoes to a blender with almond milk and water. Add ground turmeric, lemon juice, and black pepper.
2. Blend until smooth and creamy. Add additional water if needed to reach desired consistency. Serve.

**Tips:** Use fresh mangoes for the best flavour; if not available, frozen mangoes work well too.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 105; Fat: 3g; Carbs: 21g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 10mg; Sugar: 18g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 2g

## 9. Ginger Peach Protein Shake

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 200ml skimmed milk
- 150g fresh peaches, pitted and sliced
- 1-inch piece of fresh ginger, peeled and grated
- 30g unflavoured protein powder
- 100ml plain Greek yoghurt
- 10ml fresh lemon juice

**Directions:**

1. In a blender, combine the skimmed milk, peaches, grated ginger, protein powder, Greek yoghurt, and lemon juice.
2. Blend on high speed until smooth and creamy. Serve.

**Tips:** For a thicker shake, add a few ice cubes before blending or allow it to chill in the fridge for a bit longer. Ensure peaches are ripe for a sweeter flavour without added sugar.

**Serving size:** 280ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 160; Fat: 2g; Carbs: 25g; Protein: 15g; Sodium: 80mg; Sugar: 18g; Cholesterol: 10mg; Fibre: 3g

## 10. Apple Cinnamon Protein Shake

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 200ml almond milk (unsweetened)
- 1 medium apple (approx.150g), cored and chopped
- 30g cinnamon-flavoured protein powder
- A pinch of ground cinnamon & nutmeg
- Ice cubes (optional)

**Directions:**

1. Add almond milk, apple, protein powder, cinnamon, nutmeg, and ice cubes (if using) into a blender.
2. Blend until smooth and frothy. Serve.

**Tips:** For additional texture and nutrients, leave the apple skin on before blending after ensuring it's washed thoroughly to remove any wax or pesticides.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 130; Fat: 3g; Carbs: 20g; Protein: 12g; Sodium: 75mg; Sugar:14g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 4g

# High-Fibre Breakfast Bowls and Oatmeal

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## 11. Apple Cinnamon Porridge

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 10 minutes

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 120g rolled oats
- 300ml water
- 1 small apple, grated (about 100g)
- 1 tsp ground cinnamon
- A pinch of salt
- 10g chopped walnuts

**Directions:**

1. In a medium saucepan, combine the rolled oats, water, apple, cinnamon, and salt.
2. Cook for 10 minutes over medium heat, stirring occasionally until the mixture thickens.  
Serve warm, topped with chopped walnuts.

**Tips:** Substitute water with skimmed milk for a creamier texture.

**Serving size:** 220g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 210; Fat: 5g; Carbs: 37g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 2mg; Sugar: 6g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 7g

## 12. Chia Berry Overnight Oats

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes + overnight chilling

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 50g rolled oats
- 30g chia seeds
- 250ml almond milk
- 80g mixed berries (e.g., strawberries, blueberries)
- 5ml vanilla extract

**Directions:**

1. In a bowl or jar, combine the rolled oats, chia seeds, almond milk, and vanilla. Stir well.
2. Gently fold in the berries before covering and refrigerating overnight. In the morning, stir the mixture well before serving chilled.

**Tips:** Add a tsp of honey for extra sweetness if desired (not included in nutritional values).

**Serving size:** 165g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 200; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 27g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 45mg; Sugar: 5g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 8g

## 13. Quinoa Breakfast Bowl with Almond Milk

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 15 minutes

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 100g quinoa, rinsed
- 250ml unsweetened almond milk



- 50g fresh blueberries
- 1 tbsp flaxseeds
- 1 tbsp chopped almonds
- 1 tsp cinnamon

**Directions:**

1. In a saucepan, combine the quinoa and almond milk. Let it boil, then adjust to a simmer for 12-15 minutes until the quinoa is fluffy and has absorbed the milk.
2. Once cooked, stir in the cinnamon, and divide the quinoa between two bowls. Top with blueberries, flaxseeds, and almonds.

**Tips:** You can also add a splash more almond milk for a creamier texture.

**Serving size:** 225g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 250; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 34g; Protein: 9g; Sodium: 60mg; Sugar: 5g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 6g

## 14. Flaxseed and Blueberry Porridge

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 10 minutes

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 100g rolled oats
- 300ml unsweetened almond milk
- 50g fresh blueberries
- 2 tbsp ground flaxseeds
- 1 tbsp chia seeds

**Directions:**

1. In a pot, let the almond milk simmer over medium heat. Add rolled oats and stir occasionally for about 5 minutes until creamy.

2. Stir in flaxseeds and chia seeds, then remove. Divide the porridge between two bowls and top with fresh blueberries.

**Tips:** For added sweetness, incorporate a few slices of ripe banana.

**Serving size:** 275g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 320; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 44g; Protein: 11g; Sodium: 70mg; Sugar: 5g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 9g

## **15. Pumpkin Spice Oatmeal with Walnuts**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 10 minutes

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 100g rolled oats
- 300ml almond milk (unsweetened)
- 100g pumpkin puree
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- 1/2 tsp ground nutmeg
- 20g walnuts, chopped

**Directions:**

1. In a saucepan, combine oats and almond milk. Cook over medium heat until the mixture starts to boil.
2. Stir in pumpkin puree, cinnamon, and nutmeg. Continue to cook for another 5 minutes, stirring occasionally.
3. Once thickened to your desired consistency, remove from heat. Serve topped with chopped walnuts.

**Tips:** For an extra touch of sweetness, add a few drops of vanilla extract or a sprinkle of stevia.

**Serving size:** 1 bowl

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 220; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 31g; Protein: 7g; Sodium: 40mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 6g

## **16. Raspberry Chia Breakfast Bowl**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes + chilling time

**Cooking time:** N/A required

**Servings:** 2

### **Ingredients:**

- 50g chia seeds
- 250ml coconut milk (light)
- 100g fresh raspberries
- 1 tbsp honey (optional)
- A pinch of vanilla bean powder

### **Directions:**

1. In a bowl, mix chia seeds, coconut milk, and vanilla bean powder until well combined.
2. Allow it to set in the fridge for at least an hour or overnight to thicken into a pudding-like consistency.
3. Before serving, mash half of the raspberries and mix them into the chia mixture.
4. Divide into bowls and top with remaining whole raspberries and drizzle with honey if desired.

**Tips:** This can be prepared the night before for a quick breakfast option.

**Serving size:** 1 bowl

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 200; Fat: 11g; Carbs: 25g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 20mg; Sugar: 8g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 9g

## **17. Banana Nut High-Fibre Porridge**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 10 minutes

**Servings:** 2

### **Ingredients:**

- 100g rolled oats
- 300ml skimmed milk or almond milk
- 1 ripe banana, mashed
- 20g walnuts, chopped
- Pinch of cinnamon

### **Directions:**

1. In a saucepan, combine the oats and milk over medium heat. Stir occasionally to prevent sticking.
2. Once it begins to simmer, reduce the heat and add the mashed banana and cinnamon. Stir until well combined.
3. Cook for about 5 minutes until the porridge thickens to your desired consistency. Remove and stir in the chopped walnuts.

**Tips:** For added sweetness, you may add a drop of vanilla extract or a sprinkle of stevia.

**Serving size:** 1 bowl

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 230; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 36g; Protein: 7g; Sodium: 30mg; Sugar: 6g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 5g

## **18. Blackberry Almond Crisp Oats**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 15 minutes

**Servings:** 2

### **Ingredients:**

- 150g fresh blackberries
- 100g rolled oats
- 200ml water or almond milk
- 20g almonds, sliced
- Pinch of nutmeg

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to grill setting. In a pot, combine oats and water over medium heat. Allow it to simmer for 8 minutes until thickened.
2. Place blackberries in an ovenproof dish, sprinkle with nutmeg, and gently mash them with the back of a spoon.
3. Pour the cooked oats over the blackberries, then top with sliced almonds evenly distributed over the surface.
4. Grill for 5 minutes until the almonds are golden brown and crispy on top.

**Tips:** You can substitute half of the blackberries with raspberries for a mixed berry flavour.

**Serving size:** 1 bowl

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 220; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 36g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 10mg; Sugar: 7g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 8g

## 19. Cinnamon Raisin High-Fibre Cereal Mix

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 200g whole grain oats
- 50g raisins
- 1 tsp ground cinnamon
- 10g chia seeds
- 20g chopped almonds
- 15g flaxseed
- 250ml almond milk or skimmed milk

**Directions:**

1. In a large bowl, combine oats, raisins, cinnamon, chia seeds, almonds, and flaxseed. Mix well to ensure even distribution of ingredients.
2. Serve with a portion of almond milk or skimmed milk.

**Tips:** For added sweetness, consider adding a sprinkle of stevia or a drizzle of honey if suitable. This mix also pairs well with fresh berries when in season.

**Serving size:** 100g of cereal mix with 62.5ml of milk

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 230; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 32g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 30mg; Sugar: 8g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 7g

## 20. Apricot and Hazelnut Breakfast Bowl

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 150g unsweetened Greek yogurt
- 60g dried apricots, chopped
- 30g hazelnuts, chopped
- 1 tbsp pumpkin seeds
- 10ml honey (optional)
- Pinch of ground cinnamon

**Directions:**

1. Divide the Greek yogurt evenly between two bowls. Top each bowl with chopped dried apricots and hazelnuts.
2. Sprinkle pumpkin seeds over the top and add a pinch of ground cinnamon to taste. Drizzle with honey if desired for added sweetness.

**Tips:** For additional flavour, toast the hazelnuts lightly before adding them to the bowl.

**Serving size:** ½ of the recipe

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 270; Fat: 11g; Carbs: 32g; Protein: 10g; Sodium: 60mg; Sugar: 20g; Cholesterol: 5mg; Fibre: 6g

# Protein-Packed Breakfast

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## 21. Vegetable Omelette with Spinach and Tomato

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 10 minutes

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 100g fresh spinach leaves
- 100g cherry tomatoes, halved
- 4 large eggs
- 50ml semi-skimmed milk
- 15ml olive oil
- Salt and pepper to taste

**Directions:**

1. In a bowl, whisk together the eggs, milk, salt, and pepper. Set aside.
2. Heat the olive oil in a non-stick frying pan over medium heat. Add the spinach and cook until wilted. Add the cherry tomatoes to the pan and cook for another 2 minutes.
3. Pour the egg mixture over the vegetables in the pan and cook on medium-low heat until the bottom sets.
4. Gently lift the edges of the omelette to allow uncooked egg to flow underneath until completely set. Slide onto a plate and serve immediately.

**Tips:** For added flavour, sprinkle some fresh herbs like chives or parsley before serving.

**Serving size:** 1 omelette

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 190; Fat: 13g; Carbs: 5g; Protein: 12g; Sodium: 210mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 225mg; Fibre: 1g



## 22. Smoked Salmon Scrambled Eggs

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 8 minutes

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 4 large eggs
- 50ml semi-skimmed milk
- 100g smoked salmon, sliced into strips
- A handful of fresh dill, chopped
- Salt and pepper to taste
- 15ml olive oil

**Directions:**

1. In a bowl, whisk together the eggs, milk, salt, and pepper until combined. Heat olive oil in a non-stick frying pan over medium-low heat.
2. Pour in the egg mixture and stir gently. When the eggs are nearly done but still slightly runny, add smoked salmon strips and fold gently into the mixture.
3. Remove just before fully cooked as they'll continue to cook off heat. Garnish with fresh dill before serving.

**Tips:** Serve with whole-grain toast for additional fibre content.

**Serving size:** ½ of the recipe

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 220; Fat: 14g; Carbs: 3g; Protein: 18g; Sodium: 650mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 300mg; Fibre: <1g

## 23. Egg White Veggie Muffins

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 250g egg whites
- 100g spinach, chopped
- 100g bell peppers, diced
- 80g mushrooms, sliced
- 30g cheddar cheese, grated
- 5ml olive oil
- Salt and pepper to taste

**Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 180°C. Lightly grease a muffin tin with olive oil.
2. In a mixing bowl, combine egg whites, spinach, bell peppers, mushrooms, salt and pepper. Mix well.
3. Pour the mixture evenly into the muffin cups. Top each with a sprinkle of cheddar cheese. Bake for 20 minutes or until the muffins are set and slightly golden on top.

**Tips:** These muffins can be prepared in advance and stored in the fridge for quick breakfasts.

**Serving size:** 2 muffins

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 100; Fat: 3g; Carbs: 5g; Protein: 15g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 8mg; Fibre: 2g

## 24. Tofu Scramble with Mixed Vegetables

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 10 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 400g firm tofu, crumbled
- 150g kale, chopped
- 100g cherry tomatoes, halved
- 50g red onion, diced
- 1 clove garlic, minced (5g)
- 5ml olive oil
- Salt and pepper to taste

**Directions:**

1. Heat olive oil in a non-stick frying pan over medium heat. Add garlic and red onion, cooking until softened.
2. Add crumbled tofu to the pan, stirring well to combine with the onion mixture. Season with salt and pepper.
3. Add kale and cherry tomatoes. Stir occasionally until vegetables are tender and tofu is heated through.
4. Serve warm as a protein-packed breakfast or light lunch.

**Tips:** Experiment with other vegetables such as courgette or asparagus.

**Serving size:** ¼ of the recipe

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 120; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 8g; Protein: 10g; Sodium: 180mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 3g

## 25. Quinoa Protein Pancakes

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 15 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 150g quinoa flour
- 2 medium eggs
- 100ml almond milk unsweetened
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 2 tbsp Greek yogurt (non-fat)
- A pinch of cinnamon & salt

### **Directions:**

1. In a bowl, whisk together the quinoa flour, baking powder, cinnamon, and salt.
2. In another bowl, whisk the eggs and then mix in the almond milk and Greek yogurt until smooth. Combine it with flour mixture until blended.
3. Heat a non-stick pan over medium heat and pour batter to form pancakes. Cook for about 2 minutes on each side, or until bubbles form and the edges are cooked.

**Tips:** Serve with fresh berries or a sprinkle of nuts for extra flavour.

**Serving size:** 1 pancake

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 140; Fat: 4g; Carbs: 18g; Protein: 7g; Sodium: 85mg; Sugar: 1g; Cholesterol: 45mg; Fibre: 2g

## 26. Grilled Chicken Breakfast Wrap

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 10 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 400g grilled chicken breast slices
- 4 whole-wheat tortillas
- 60g spinach leaves
- 80ml hummus
- 100g cherry tomatoes, halved
- Salt and pepper to taste

**Directions:**

1. Spread a thin layer of hummus onto each tortilla. Layer with grilled chicken slices, fresh spinach leaves, and cherry tomatoes. Season with salt and pepper.
2. Roll up wraps tightly and grill them over medium heat for about two minutes on each side until lightly toasted.

**Tips:** Replace hummus with mashed avocado for a different taste profile.

**Serving size:** Half a wrap

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 220; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 22g; Protein: 20g; Sodium: 310mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 55mg; Fibre: 5g

## 27. Lean Turkey Sausage Egg Bake

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 30 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 250g turkey sausage, removed from casing and crumbled
- 6 large eggs
- 100ml skimmed milk
- 1 red bell pepper, diced
- 50g spinach, chopped
- 50g low-fat cheddar cheese, grated
- Salt and black pepper to taste

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat the oven to 180°C. Grease a baking dish with a little non-stick spray.
2. In a frying pan over medium heat, cook the turkey sausage until browned; drain any excess grease.
3. In a bowl, whisk together the eggs and skimmed milk. Season with salt and pepper.
4. Layer the cooked sausage, bell pepper, and spinach in the prepared dish. Pour over the egg mixture. Sprinkle with cheddar cheese on top.
5. Bake in the preheated oven for about 30 minutes or until set and golden brown on top.

**Tips:** For added flavour, incorporate a sprinkle of herbs like thyme or oregano in the egg mixture before baking.

**Serving size:** 1 slice (1/4 of the bake)

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 220; Fat: 12g; Carbs: 3g; Protein: 23g; Sodium: 450mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 220mg; Fibre: 1g

## **28. Protein-Packed Veggie Breakfast Burrito**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 5 minutes

**Servings:** 2

### **Ingredients:**

- 4 large eggs
- 100ml egg whites
- 100g cherry tomatoes, halved
- 50g kale, chopped
- 100g low-fat cottage cheese
- Salt and black pepper to taste
- 2 Whole wheat tortillas, warmed

### **Directions:**

1. In a non-stick skillet over medium heat, scramble the eggs and egg whites until nearly cooked through. Add cherry tomatoes and kale until vegetables are tender.
2. Stir in cottage cheese until heated through and season with salt and pepper. Divide the filling between two warmed tortillas, wrap tightly, and serve immediately.

**Tips:** For extra flavour, add fresh herbs like coriander or parsley before rolling up your burritos.

**Serving size:** One burrito

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 280; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 28g; Protein: 22g; Sodium: 410mg; Sugar: 4g; Cholesterol: 200mg; Fibre: 6g

## 29. Poached Egg on Whole Grain Toast

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 5 minutes

**Servings:** 1

**Ingredients:**

- 1 large egg
- 1 slice whole grain bread (approx. 40g), toasted
- 100ml water (for poaching)
- Pinch of salt & black pepper

**Directions:**

1. Let the water simmer in a small saucepan. Add a pinch of salt. Crack the egg into a cup, then gently slide it into the simmering water.
2. Poach for about 3-4 minutes until the white is set but the yolk is still runny. Place the poached egg on top of the toasted bread and season with black pepper.

**Tips:** Use fresh eggs for best results when poaching. Serve immediately to enjoy optimal texture and flavour.

**Serving size:** 1 poached egg on toast

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 180; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 24g; Protein: 10g; Sodium: 250mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 186mg; Fibre: 4g



### 30. Cottage Cheese and Berry Parfait

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 200g low-fat cottage cheese
- 100g mixed berries (such as strawberries, blueberries, raspberries)
- 20g chopped nuts
- Pinch of cinnamon

**Directions:**

1. In two serving glasses or bowls, layer half of the cottage cheese at the bottom. Add a layer of mixed berries on top of the cottage cheese in each glass or bowl.
2. Repeat with another layer of cottage cheese and top with remaining berries. Sprinkle chopped nuts and a pinch of cinnamon over each parfait before serving.

**Tips:** Use a combination of fresh or frozen berries depending on seasonal availability. Nuts like almonds or walnuts provide extra crunch and nutrients.

**Serving size:** Half portion of parfait

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 160; Fat: 5g; Carbs: 12g; Protein: 13g; Sodium: 220mg; Sugar: 7g; Cholesterol: 10mg; Fibre: 3g

# Savoury Breakfast

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## 31. Mushroom and Spinach Frittata

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 15 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 100g spinach
- 150g mushrooms, sliced
- 1 small onion, chopped
- 6 eggs
- 50ml semi-skimmed milk
- 10g parmesan cheese, grated
- Salt and pepper to taste

**Directions:**

1. Preheat the oven to 180°C. Sauté the onion in a non-stick pan until soft. Add mushrooms and cook for 5 minutes. Stir in the spinach until wilted.
2. Whisk together eggs, milk, salt, and pepper in a bowl. Pour the mixture over the vegetables.
3. Cook on low heat until the edges set but the centre is still runny. Sprinkle parmesan cheese on top and bake in the oven for 8 minutes or until fully set.
4. Allow to cool slightly before slicing.

**Tips:** Serve with a side salad for added fibre and nutrients.

**Serving size:** 1/4 of frittata

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 145; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 4g; Protein: 12g; Sodium: 215mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 215mg; Fibre: 1g

### **32. Tomato and Avocado Breakfast Bake**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 250g cherry tomatoes, halved
- 2 medium avocados, diced
- 150g low-fat feta cheese
- Juice of half a lemon
- Salt and pepper to taste
- Fresh basil leaves for garnish

**Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 180°C. Arrange halved tomatoes in an ovenproof dish.
2. Sprinkle diced avocados evenly over tomatoes. Crumble feta cheese on top.
3. Drizzle with lemon juice and season with salt and pepper. Bake for 20 minutes or until tomatoes are soft. Garnish with fresh basil leaves before serving.

**Tips:** Pair with whole grain toast for added carbohydrates if advisable.

**Serving size:** ¼ of the recipe

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 180; Fat: 12g; Carbs: 10g; Protein: 7g; Sodium: 250mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 9mg; Fibre: 6g

### **33. Savoury Courgette Bread with Seeds**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 45 minutes

**Servings:** 8

**Ingredients:**

- 200g grated courgette
- 100g whole wheat flour
- 50g sunflower seeds
- 2 eggs
- 50ml olive oil
- 1 tsp baking powder
- Salt, to taste

**Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 180°C. Line a loaf tin with baking paper. In a bowl, whisk the eggs and olive oil together. Add the grated courgette and mix well.
2. In another bowl, combine the flour, baking powder, and salt. Add this to the courgette mixture and mix until just combined. Stir in the sunflower seeds.
3. Pour the mixture into the prepared loaf tin and bake for about 45 minutes or until a skewer inserted into the centre comes out clean. Allow to cool slightly before slicing.

**Tips:** Avoid overmixing the batter to prevent it from becoming too dense.

**Serving size:** 1 slice

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 160; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 12g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 1g; Cholesterol: 40mg; Fibre: 2g

### **34. Mediterranean Vegetable Stir Fry**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 15 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 150g cherry tomatoes, halved
- 200g courgette, diced
- 1 red bell pepper, sliced
- 60ml extra virgin olive oil

- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- Salt and pepper, to taste
- Fresh basil leaves for garnish

**Directions:**

1. Heat olive oil in a large frying pan over medium heat. Add garlic and sauté for about a minute until fragrant.
2. Add the red bell pepper and courgette to the pan and stir regularly for 5 minutes. Add cherry tomatoes and season with salt and pepper.
3. Cook for another 5 minutes until all vegetables are tender but still vibrant. Garnish with fresh basil leaves before serving.

**Tips:** Use fresh vegetables for best flavour and retain some crunch.

**Serving size:** ¼ of the recipe

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 130; Fat: 11g; Carbs: 10g; Protein: 2g; Sodium:120mg; Sugar:5g; Cholesterol:0mg; Fibre: 3g

## 35. Cheesy Cauliflower Muffins

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 300g cauliflower, grated
- 100g mature cheddar cheese, grated
- 2 eggs
- 50ml milk
- 1 tsp baking powder
- Salt and pepper to taste

**Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 180°C. Grease a muffin tray.
2. In a bowl, mix together the grated cauliflower, cheddar cheese, eggs, milk, and baking powder. Season with salt and pepper.
3. Divide the mixture into the muffin tray, filling each section about three-quarters full. Bake for 20 minutes or until golden and firm.

**Tips:** For added flavour, sprinkle some herbs like chives or parsley on top before baking.

**Serving size:** 2 muffins

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 200; Fat: 14g; Carbs: 7g; Protein: 12g; Sodium: 220mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 70mg; Fibre: 3g

## **36. Spicy Baked Beans on Wholegrain Toast**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 15 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 400g canned baked beans
- 1 tsp chilli powder
- 150ml tomato passata
- A pinch of dried oregano
- Salt and pepper to taste
- 8 slices of wholegrain bread, toasted

**Directions:**

1. Heat a saucepan over medium heat and add the canned baked beans, chilli powder, tomato passata, and oregano. Stir well to combine.
2. Simmer for about 10 to 15 minutes until heated through and thickened slightly. Season with salt and pepper. Serve the spicy baked beans over the toasted bread slices.

**Tips:** Add some chopped fresh coriander for extra freshness before serving.

**Serving size:** 2 toast slices with beans

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 320; Fat: 5g; Carbs: 55g; Protein: 12g; Sodium: 500mg; Sugar: 8g; Cholesterol: negligible; Fibre: 10g

### **37. Cumin-Spiced Lentil Patties**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 300g lentils, cooked
- 1 large onion, finely chopped
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 50g wholemeal breadcrumbs
- 1 egg, beaten
- Salt and pepper to taste

**Directions:**

1. In a bowl, mix cooked lentils, onion, cumin, garlic, breadcrumbs, and beaten egg. Season with salt and pepper. Form mixture into small patties.
2. Heat a non-stick frying pan over medium heat and cook patties for about 5 minutes per side until golden brown.

**Tips:** Serve with a side of fresh salad or steamed vegetables for a complete meal.

**Serving size:** 2 patties

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 180 kcal; Fat: 3g; Carbs: 28g; Protein: 10g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 40mg; Fibre: 10g

### 38. Pepper Jack Stuffed Peppers

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 30 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 4 large bell peppers, halved and deseeded
- 150g quinoa
- 100g Pepper Jack cheese, grated
- 100g sweetcorn kernels
- Salt and pepper to taste
- Fresh coriander leaves for garnish

**Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 180°C. Cook quinoa according to package instructions.
2. Mix cooked quinoa with grated cheese and sweetcorn in a bowl. Season mixture with salt and pepper.
3. Stuff each pepper half with the quinoa mixture. Place stuffed peppers in a baking dish and bake for about 30 minutes until peppers are tender.

**Tips:** Garnish with fresh coriander leaves before serving for an extra burst of freshness.

**Serving size:** Half a stuffed pepper

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 220; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 30g; Protein: 8g; Sodium: 160mg; Sugar: 5g; Cholesterol: 15mg; Fibre: 7g

### 39. Thyme Roasted Sweet Potato Hash

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 25 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**



- 800g sweet potatoes, peeled and diced
- 1 red onion, finely chopped
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tsp dried thyme
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- Salt and pepper to taste

**Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 200°C. Combine sweet potatoes, olive oil, thyme, garlic, salt, and pepper in a bowl. Toss to coat evenly.
2. Spread mixture onto a baking tray and roast for 25 minutes until tender and golden brown, stirring halfway through. Serve warm with onion sprinkled on top.

**Tips:** Ensure sweet potatoes are cut into even pieces for uniform cooking.

**Serving size:** 200g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 160; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 23g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 30mg; Sugar: 5g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 4g

## 40. Herbed Quinoa Breakfast Pilaf

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 15 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 200g quinoa, rinsed
- 500ml water
- A handful of fresh parsley, chopped
- A handful of fresh mint leaves, chopped
- Juice of half a lemon
- Salt and pepper to taste

**Directions:**

1. Let the water boil in a saucepan. Add quinoa, adjust to low heat, cover and simmer for about 15 minutes until water is absorbed.
2. Fluff with a fork and stir in parsley, mint, lemon juice, salt and pepper. Serve warm as a nutritious breakfast option.

**Tips:** Prepare quinoa in advance and reheat gently for quick breakfast preparation.

**Serving size:** 150g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 180; Fat: 3g; Carbs: 30g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 10mg; Sugar: 1g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 3g

## **CHAPTER 6**

### **Lunch Recipes**

# Low-Carb Wraps and Sandwiches

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## 41. Chicken Caesar Lettuce Wraps

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 10 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 500g boneless, skinless chicken breasts
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tsp garlic powder
- 100g Parmesan cheese, grated
- 100ml low-fat Caesar dressing
- 1 large Romaine lettuce
- Salt and pepper to taste

**Directions:**

1. Season chicken breasts with garlic powder, salt, and pepper.
2. Heat olive oil in a pan over medium heat. Cook the chicken for about 5 minutes per side or until fully cooked. Slice into strips.
3. Separate the Romaine lettuce leaves, wash and pat dry. Place a few slices of chicken on each lettuce leaf.
4. Drizzle with Caesar dressing and sprinkle with Parmesan cheese. Roll each lettuce leaf to form a wrap.

**Tips:** For added crunch, consider adding some sliced radishes or cucumbers.

**Serving size:** 2 wraps

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 300; Fat: 15g; Carbs: 6g; Protein: 38g; Sodium: 450mg; Sugar: 1g; Cholesterol: 90mg; Fibre: 2g

## **42. Turkey and Avocado Collard Greens Wraps**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 400g turkey breast slices
- 2 ripe avocados, peeled & pitted
- Juice of half a lemon
- 4 large collard green leaves, washed & pat dried
- Salt and pepper to taste
- Optional: a handful of cherry tomatoes

### **Directions:**

1. Mash the avocados with lemon juice, salt, and pepper to create guacamole.
2. Spread a layer of guacamole on each collard green leaf. Place slices of turkey breast over the guacamole.
3. If desired, add some halved cherry tomatoes for extra flavour. Roll the collard leaves tightly around the fillings to form wraps.

**Tips:** You can blanch collard greens in boiling water for softer leaves if desired.

**Serving size:** 1 wrap

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 250; Fat: 14g; Carbs: 10g; Protein: 24g; Sodium: 350mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 35mg; Fibre: 5g

## **43. Mediterranean Veggie Flatbread Sandwich**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 5 minutes

**Servings:** 2

### **Ingredients:**

- 100g whole grain flatbread
- 150g hummus
- 100g cherry tomatoes, halved
- 50g cucumber, sliced
- 40g red onion, thinly sliced
- 50g feta cheese, crumbled
- 20g black olives, pitted and sliced

**Directions:**

1. Warm the flatbread in a dry frying pan over medium heat for about 2 minutes per side. Spread a generous layer of hummus over each flatbread.
2. Arrange cherry tomatoes, cucumber slices, red onion, and feta cheese evenly over the hummus. Sprinkle the black olives on top.
3. Fold the flatbread in half to form a sandwich and serve immediately.

**Tips:** Use gluten-free flatbread if desired. Add fresh basil or mint leaves for extra flavour.

**Serving size:** Half of a sandwich

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 220; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 28g; Protein: 7g; Sodium: 340mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 15mg; Fibre: 6g

## 44. Tuna and Cucumber Nori Wraps

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 1 can (150g) tuna in water, drained
- 15ml reduced-fat mayonnaise
- 5ml lemon juice
- 1 small cucumber, thinly sliced
- 2 nori seaweed sheets

- A handful of mixed salad leaves

**Directions:**

1. In a bowl, mix the drained tuna with mayonnaise and lemon juice until well combined. Lay a nori sheet on a clean surface and spread half of the tuna mixture evenly along one edge.
2. Top with cucumber slices and mixed salad leaves. Roll up tightly from the filling side to form a wrap.
3. Repeat with the second nori sheet and remaining ingredients. Slice into bite-sized pieces before serving.

**Tips:** Add grated carrot or radish for extra crunch.

**Serving size:** One full wrap

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 150; Fat: 4g; Carbs: 7g; Protein: 21g; Sodium: 310mg; Sugar: <1g; Cholesterol: 10mg; Fibre: <1g

## 45. Egg and Spinach Breakfast Wrap

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 10 minutes

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 4 large eggs
- 100g fresh spinach leaves
- 100g whole wheat wraps (2 wraps)
- 50ml semi-skimmed milk
- 20g reduced-fat cheddar cheese, grated
- Salt and pepper to taste

**Directions:**

1. In a bowl, whisk together the eggs, milk, salt, and pepper until fully combined. Heat a non-stick pan over medium heat, add the spinach, then cook until wilted.

2. Pour the egg mixture into the pan with spinach and gently scramble until cooked through. Warm the wraps in a separate dry pan or microwave for a few seconds to soften.
3. Divide the egg and spinach mix evenly between the two wraps, sprinkling with cheese on top. Roll up tightly and serve immediately.

**Tips:** For added flavour, include a pinch of nutmeg while scrambling the eggs.

**Serving size:** 1 wrap

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 285; Fat: 12g; Carbs: 22g; Protein: 21g; Sodium: 430mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 315mg; Fibre: 3g

## **46. Grilled Chicken and Peppers Lettuce Boats**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 15 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 400g chicken breast fillets
- 2 bell peppers (red or yellow), sliced
- 100g cherry tomatoes, quartered
- A handful of fresh coriander leaves, chopped
- Juice of one lime
- Salt and pepper to taste
- Large lettuce leaves (such as Romaine), washed – about 8 leaves

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat your grill to medium-high heat. Season the chicken breasts with lime juice, salt, and pepper.
2. Grill the chicken for about 6 minutes on each side until cooked through. Add peppers to grill during last few minutes until tender.
3. Let chicken rest for a few minutes before slicing into thin strips. Arrange lettuce leaves on a serving plate.



4. Fill each lettuce leaf with grilled chicken slices, peppers, cherry tomatoes, and garnish with coriander.

**Tips:** For extra zest, mix some chilli flakes into the lime juice before marinating the chicken.

**Serving size:** 2 lettuce boats

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 250; Fat: 4g; Carbs: 12g; Protein: 40g; Sodium: 300mg; Sugar: 7g; Cholesterol: 70mg; Fibre: 4g

## **47. Smoked Salmon and Cucumber Sandwich**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 150g smoked salmon
- 1 cucumber, sliced thinly
- 100g reduced-fat cream cheese
- 4 slices whole grain bread
- Fresh dill (a few sprigs)
- Lemon juice (a squeeze)

**Directions:**

1. Spread the cream cheese evenly over each slice of bread. Arrange the smoked salmon and cucumber slices on top of two of the slices.
2. Add a squeeze of lemon juice and sprinkle some fresh dill over the top. Top with the remaining slices of bread, slice each sandwich into halves or quarters, and serve immediately.

**Tips:** You can add a pinch of black pepper for extra flavour. For added crunch, use seeded whole grain bread.

**Serving size:** 1 sandwich

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 230; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 25g; Protein: 14g; Sodium: 340mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 25mg; Fibre: 4g

## **48. Hummus and Veggie Stuffed Pita Pockets**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 2

### **Ingredients:**

- 200g hummus
- 2 whole wheat pita breads
- 100g halved cherry tomatoes
- 1 red bell pepper, thinly sliced
- A handful of fresh spinach leaves
- A handful of alfalfa sprouts

### **Directions:**

1. Cut each pita bread in half to form pockets. Spread a generous amount of hummus inside each pocket.
2. Fill each pocket with cherry tomatoes, red bell pepper slices, spinach leaves, and alfalfa sprouts. Serve immediately for freshness.

**Tips:** Try mixing different vegetables as per your preference. You can lightly toast the pita for additional texture.

**Serving size:** Half a stuffed pita pocket

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 200; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 27g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 250mg; Sugar: 4g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 6g

## **49. Roast Beef and Horseradish Lettuce Wraps**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 400g roast beef slices
- 100g cream cheese
- 2 tbsp horseradish sauce
- 1 head of romaine lettuce, leaves separated
- 50g radishes, thinly sliced
- 50g cucumber, julienned

**Directions:**

1. In a bowl, mix the cream cheese and horseradish sauce until well combined. Lay out the lettuce leaves and spread a spoonful of the cream cheese mixture onto each leaf.
2. Place a few slices of roast beef on top followed by some radish and cucumber slices. Roll each lettuce leaf to form wraps and secure with a toothpick if needed.

**Tips:** For added flavour, sprinkle with black pepper before serving.

**Serving size:** 1 wrap

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 180; Fat: 12g; Carbs: 5g; Protein: 15g; Sodium: 350mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 34mg; Fibre: 1g

## 50. Caprese Salad Chicken Sandwich

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 400g cooked chicken breast, shredded
- 200g fresh mozzarella cheese, sliced
- 150g cherry tomatoes, halved
- Handful of fresh basil leaves
- Balsamic glaze (to drizzle)
- Salt and pepper to taste
- Mixed seed wholegrain sandwich rolls (4 pieces)

### **Directions:**

1. Slice the sandwich rolls in half and layer each bottom half with shredded chicken breast. Top the chicken with slices of mozzarella and cherry tomato halves.
2. Add fresh basil leaves on top, drizzle lightly with balsamic glaze, and season with salt and pepper to taste.
3. Place the other half of the sandwich roll on top and serve immediately.

**Tips:** For extra crunch, lightly toast the sandwich rolls before assembling.

**Serving size:** 1 sandwich

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 370; Fat: 13g; Carbs: 28g; Protein: 35g; Sodium: 600mg; Sugar: 5g; Cholesterol: 70mg; Fibre: 3g

# Diabetic-Friendly Salads with Flavourful Dressings

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## 51. Spinach and Strawberry Salad with Balsamic Vinaigrette

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

### Ingredients:

- 200g fresh spinach leaves
- 250g strawberries, hulled and sliced
- 50g walnuts, roughly chopped
- 100g feta cheese, crumbled
- 60ml balsamic vinegar
- 30ml olive oil
- Salt and ground black pepper to taste

### Directions:

1. In a large salad bowl, combine the spinach leaves, sliced strawberries, walnuts, and feta cheese.
2. In a separate small bowl or jar, whisk together the balsamic vinegar, olive oil, salt, and pepper until well combined.
3. Drizzle the dressing over the salad just before serving and toss gently to combine.

**Tips:** For an extra crunch, try adding some sunflower seeds. Make the salad just before serving to keep the spinach fresh.

**Serving size:** ¼ of the recipe

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 220; Fat: 16g; Carbs: 15g; Protein: 7g; Sodium: 230mg; Sugar: 8g; Cholesterol: 10mg; Fibre: 3g

## **52. Chickpea and Tomato Salad with Lemon-Tahini Dressing**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 400g canned chickpeas, drained and rinsed
- 300g cherry tomatoes, halved
- 1 small cucumber, diced (approx.150g)
- 50g red onion, finely chopped
- Handful of fresh parsley, chopped (approx.10g)

### **For the Dressing:**

- Juice of one lemon (approx.60ml)
- 2 tbsp tahini (approx.30ml)
- 1 garlic clove, minced
- Salt and ground black pepper to taste

### **Directions:**

1. In a large bowl, combine the chickpeas, cherry tomatoes, cucumber, red onion, and parsley.
2. In a separate bowl or jar, whisk together the lemon juice, tahini, minced garlic, salt and pepper until smooth.
3. Pour the dressing over the chickpea mixture and toss well to combine.

**Tips:** For added flavour you can add some cumin powder into dressing; use fresh ingredients for best taste.

**Serving size:** ¼ of the recipe

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 180; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 24g; Protein: 7g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 5g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 6g

### **53. Grilled Vegetable Salad with Basil Pesto**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 10 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 500g mixed vegetables (courgettes, bell peppers, and aubergine), sliced
- 100g cherry tomatoes
- 50g basil leaves
- 30g pine nuts
- 30g Parmesan cheese, grated
- 50ml extra virgin olive oil
- Salt and pepper to taste

**Directions:**

1. Preheat a grill or griddle pan over medium heat.
2. Grill the courgettes, bell peppers, and aubergine for about 3-4 minutes on each side or until tender. Set aside to cool slightly.
3. For the pesto, blend basil leaves, pine nuts, Parmesan cheese, and olive oil until smooth. Season with salt and pepper to taste.
4. Toss the grilled vegetables and cherry tomatoes with the basil pesto sauce until well coated.

**Tips:** Use seasonal vegetables for optimal freshness and variety. Adjust the grilling time based on your preferred vegetable texture.

**Serving size:** 150g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 125; Fat: 11g; Carbs: 6g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 90mg; Sugar: 4g; Cholesterol: 3mg; Fibre: 3g

## 54. Greek Salad with Herbed Olive Oil Dressing

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 200g cucumber, diced
- 200g tomatoes, diced
- 100g red onion, thinly sliced
- 100g feta cheese, cubed or crumbled
- 50g black olives
- Juice of half a lemon
- An assortment of fresh herbs (20g basil, parsley, or oregano)
- 60ml extra virgin olive oil
- Salt and pepper to taste

### **Directions:**

1. In a large bowl, combine cucumber, tomatoes, red onion, feta cheese, and black olives.
2. In a separate small bowl, whisk together olive oil, lemon juice, chopped fresh herbs of choice, salt, and pepper.
3. Pour the dressing over the salad ingredients and gently toss to combine.

**Tips:** Opt for Kalamata olives for a more authentic flavour. Ensure feta is reduced-fat if available for better dietary compatibility.

**Serving size:** 130g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 160; Fat: 14g; Carbs: 5g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 320mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 18mg; Fibre: 2g



## **55. Avocado and Black Bean Salad with Lime- Coriander Dressing**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 200g canned black beans, drained and rinsed
- 2 ripe avocados, diced
- 250g cherry tomatoes, halved
- 60g red onion, finely chopped
- 30ml lime juice
- 15g fresh coriander, chopped
- Salt and pepper to taste

**Directions:**

1. In a large bowl, combine the black beans, avocados, cherry tomatoes, and red onion.
2. In a small bowl, whisk together lime juice and coriander. Season with salt and pepper.
3. Pour the dressing over the salad ingredients and toss gently to combine. Serve.

**Tips:** For added crunch, consider sprinkling some pumpkin seeds on top before serving.

**Serving size:** 150g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 230; Fat: 16g; Carbs: 20g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 200mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 9g

## 56. Quinoa Tabbouleh with Mint Dressing

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 100g quinoa, rinsed
- 300ml water
- 150g cucumber, diced
- 250g cherry tomatoes, quartered
- 50g spring onions, sliced
- Juice of one lemon (about 50ml)
- Handful fresh mint leaves (10g), finely chopped
- Salt and pepper to taste

### **Directions:**

1. Cook the quinoa in a saucepan with the water for about 15–20 minutes or until water is absorbed. Fluff the quinoa with a fork and let it cool.
2. In a large bowl, combine cooled quinoa with cucumber, cherry tomatoes, and spring onions.
3. In a separate small bowl, mix lemon juice and fresh mint to make the dressing.
4. Pour dressing over tabbouleh mixture and toss well to coat evenly. Season with salt and pepper. Serve immediately or refrigerate before serving.

**Tips:** To add extra flavour to your quinoa as it cooks, try adding a pinch of cinnamon or cumin powder.

**Serving size:** 200g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 190; Fat: 3.5g; Carbs: 35g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 100mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 5g

## **57.        Roasted Beetroot and Goat's Cheese Salad with Walnut Dressing**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 30 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 500g beetroot, peeled and cut into wedges
- 100g goat's cheese, crumbled
- 50g walnuts, chopped
- 30ml olive oil
- 15ml balsamic vinegar
- Mixed lettuce leaves (about 100g)

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 200°C.
2. Toss the beetroot wedges in 15ml olive oil and place them on a baking sheet. Roast for about 30 minutes or until tender. Allow to cool slightly.
3. In a small bowl, mix remaining olive oil, balsamic vinegar, and chopped walnuts to make the dressing.
4. Arrange lettuce leaves on a serving platter, scatter roasted beetroot and goat's cheese on top. Drizzle the walnut dressing over the salad before serving.

**Tips:** Ensure you use fresh beetroot for the best taste.

**Serving size:** 150g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 240; Fat: 15g; Carbs: 20g; Protein: 8g; Sodium: 200mg; Sugar: 12g; Cholesterol: 7mg; Fibre: 4g

## **58.        Mixed Berry Salad with Honey-Mustard Drizzle**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 150g mixed berries (strawberries, blueberries, raspberries)
- 100g baby spinach leaves
- 50ml Greek yoghurt (low-fat)
- Juice of half a lemon
- 15ml honey
- 5ml wholegrain mustard

### **Directions:**

1. In a bowl, whisk together Greek yoghurt, lemon juice, honey, and mustard until smooth to create the dressing.
2. In a large bowl, combine mixed berries and baby spinach leaves. Drizzle the honey-mustard dressing over the salad and toss gently to combine.

**Tips:** Use seasonal berries for better freshness and flavour. Adjust the amount of honey in the dressing according to your taste preference.

**Serving size:** 100g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 110; Fat: 2g; Carbs: 22g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 40mg; Sugar: 15g; Cholesterol: 5mg; Fibre: 3g

## **59. Courgette Ribbon Salad with Chilli-Lime Vinaigrette**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 500g courgette, spiralized
- 1 red chilli, finely chopped
- 30ml lime juice
- 30ml extra virgin olive oil
- Fresh coriander leaves, for garnish

**Directions:**

1. In a small bowl, mix the chilli, lime juice, and olive oil to make the vinaigrette.
2. Toss the courgette ribbons in the vinaigrette until well coated. Garnish with fresh coriander leaves before serving.

**Tips:** For added crunch, sprinkle some toasted sesame seeds on top.

**Serving size:** 125g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 80; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 4g; Protein: 1g; Sodium: 5mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 1g

## **60. Asian Cabbage Slaw with Sesame-Ginger Dressing**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 400g cabbage, finely shredded
- 100g carrot, grated

- 50ml sesame oil
- 20ml low sodium soy sauce
- Juice of one lemon (approx. 50ml)
- 1 tsp grated fresh ginger

**Directions:**

1. Combine cabbage and carrot in a large mixing bowl. Whisk together the sesame oil, soy sauce, lemon juice, and ginger to make the dressing.
2. Pour the dressing over the cabbage mixture and toss well until evenly coated.

**Tips:** Chill for at least half an hour before serving for better flavour melding.

**Serving size:** 125g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 120; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 8g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 170mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 3g

# Hearty Soups and Stews that Satisfy

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## 61. Lentil and Vegetable Stew

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 30 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 200g red lentils, rinsed
- 15ml olive oil
- 1 onion, finely chopped
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 carrots, diced
- 300g butternut squash, cubed
- 1 litre vegetable stock

**Directions:**

1. Heat the olive oil in a large saucepan over medium heat. Add the onion and garlic, and cook for 3 minutes until softened.
2. Stir in the carrots and butternut squash, then cook for another 5 minutes. Add the lentils and vegetable stock to the pan.
3. Let it boil, then adjust to simmer for 20 minutes or until the lentils and vegetables are tender.

**Tips:** Add a sprinkle of fresh herbs like parsley before serving for extra flavour.

**Serving size:** One bowl

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 220; Fat: 3g; Carbs: 36g; Protein: 11g; Sodium: 500mg; Sugar: 5g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 8g

## 62. Chicken and Mushroom Soup

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 25 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 400g chicken breast, diced
- 15ml olive oil
- 1 onion, finely chopped
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 250g mushrooms, sliced
- 1 litre chicken stock

**Directions:**

1. Heat olive oil in a large pot over medium heat. Add onion and garlic, sauté for about 3 minutes until fragrant.
2. Add mushrooms and cook for another 5 minutes until they start to brown slightly. Stir in diced chicken breast, cooking until all sides are lightly browned.
3. Pour in the chicken stock, let it boil, then simmer for 15 minutes or until the chicken is fully cooked through.

**Tips:** Garnish with freshly ground black pepper or a pinch of thyme for enhanced taste.

**Serving size:** One bowl

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 250; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 5g; Protein: 35g; Sodium: 650mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 70mg; Fibre: <1g



## 63. Spicy Sweet Potato Soup

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 25 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 800g sweet potatoes, peeled and cubed
- 1 medium onion, chopped (150g)
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- 1/2 tsp cayenne pepper
- 750ml low-sodium vegetable stock
- 100ml coconut milk

### **Directions:**

1. In a large pot, sauté onion and garlic over medium heat until softened.
2. Add sweet potatoes, cumin, and cayenne pepper. Stir for 2 minutes to coat the sweet potatoes with spices.
3. Pour in the vegetable stock and let it boil. Adjust to a simmer for about 20 minutes or until sweet potatoes are tender.
4. Puree the soup using your immersion blender until smooth. Stir in coconut milk and heat through.

**Tips:** For added texture, garnish the soup with a sprinkle of roasted pumpkin seeds or fresh coriander (optional).

**Serving size:** ¼ of the recipe

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 180; Fat: 5g; Carbs: 32g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 120mg; Sugar: 8g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 5g

## 64. Beef and Broccoli Stir-Fry Soup

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 250g lean beef strips
- 200g broccoli florets
- 1 medium red bell pepper, sliced (approximately 120g)
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 750ml low-sodium beef stock
- 15ml soy sauce
- Fresh ginger, minced (approximately a thumb-sized piece)

### **Directions:**

1. In a large pan, sear the beef strips over high heat for 3 minutes until browned. Remove and set aside.
2. Add garlic and ginger to the pan, then stir-fry for about a minute until fragrant. Add broccoli and red bell pepper; stir-fry for another minute.
3. Pour in beef stock and soy sauce, let it boil then simmer for 15 minutes until vegetables are tender-crisp. Add beef back to the pot to warm through before serving.

**Tips:** Substitute soy sauce with tamari if you need gluten-free options.

**Serving size:** ¼ of the recipe

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 220; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 12g; Protein: 27g; Sodium: 350mg; Sugar: 7g; Cholesterol: 45mg; Fibre: 3g

## 65. Creamy Cauliflower Soup

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 25 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 1kg cauliflower, chopped
- 1 large onion, chopped
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 500ml vegetable stock
- 200ml low-fat milk
- Salt and pepper to taste
- Fresh parsley, for garnish (optional)

### **Directions:**

1. In a large pot, sauté the onion and garlic until translucent.
2. Add the cauliflower and vegetable stock. Let it boil, then simmer for 20 minutes until the cauliflower is tender.
3. Blend the soup until smooth using a blender or immersion blender. Return to the pot.
4. Stir in the milk and season with salt and pepper. Heat gently without boiling. Serve hot, garnished with fresh parsley if desired.

**Tips:** For added creaminess, add a touch of Greek yoghurt before serving.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 95; Fat: 1g; Carbs: 17g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 250mg; Sugar: 6g; Cholesterol: 4mg; Fibre: 5g

## 66. Spiced Pumpkin Stew

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 30 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 1kg pumpkin, diced
- 1 large red onion, sliced
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 400ml low-sodium tomato passata
- 300ml vegetable stock
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- Salt and pepper to taste
- Handful of coriander, chopped

### **Directions:**

1. In a large saucepan, sauté the red onion and garlic until soft. Add the pumpkin, cumin, tomato passata, and vegetable stock.
2. Let it boil, then simmer for 30 minutes until the pumpkin is tender. Season with salt and pepper. Serve hot topped with fresh coriander.

**Tips:** Serve with a small side of whole-grain bread for extra fibre.

**Serving size:** 1 bowl

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 120; Fat: 0.5g; Carbs: 27g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 320mg; Sugar: 7g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 6g

## 67. Turkey and Kale Soup

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 500g turkey breast, diced
- 1 litre chicken stock
- 200g kale, chopped
- 1 onion, diced
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 carrots, sliced
- 15ml olive oil

**Directions:**

1. Heat olive oil in a large pot over medium heat. Add diced onion and garlic, then cook until onion is translucent.
2. Add diced turkey breast to the pot and sauté until browned. Pour in chicken stock and let it simmer.
3. Add kale and carrots to the pot, then simmer for 15 minutes or until vegetables are tender and turkey is cooked through. Season with salt and pepper to taste.

**Tips:** For additional flavour, add a pinch of thyme or rosemary.

**Serving size:** 400ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 210; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 8g; Protein: 32g; Sodium: 350mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 60mg; Fibre: 3g

## 68. Tomato Basil Soup

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 800g canned tomatoes, chopped
- 500ml vegetable stock
- 1 onion, diced
- Handful of fresh basil leaves, roughly chopped
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 15ml olive oil

**Directions:**

1. In a large saucepan, heat olive oil over medium heat. Add the onion and garlic, then sauté until the onion is soft.
2. Add canned tomatoes and vegetable stock to the saucepan and let it boil. Adjust to low heat and let it simmer for about 15 minutes.
3. Purée the soup using your immersion blender until smooth. Stir in fresh basil leaves before serving.

**Tips:** Serve with a dash of black pepper or a swirl of low-fat cream for added richness.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 120; Fat: 4g; Carbs: 17g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 400mg; Sugar: 12g; Cholesterol: 5mg; Fibre: 4g

## 69. Quick Fish Chowder

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 500g white fish fillets, diced
- 1 large onion, finely chopped
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 large potato, peeled and diced (200g)
- 750ml fish stock
- 200ml semi-skimmed milk
- 150g sweetcorn kernels (fresh or frozen)
- Salt and pepper to taste

### **Directions:**

1. In a large saucepan over medium heat, sauté the onion and garlic until translucent. Add the potato and pour in the fish stock. Let it boil, then simmer for about 10 minutes.
2. Add the fish fillets and sweetcorn, then cook for another 5 minutes until the fish is cooked through and the potato is tender.
3. Stir in the milk, season with salt and pepper, and gently heat until warmed through.

**Tips:** Serve with a sprinkle of chopped parsley for added freshness.

**Serving size:** 1 bowl

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 220; Fat: 5g; Carbs: 22g; Protein: 25g; Sodium: 180mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 55mg; Fibre: 3g

## 70. Moroccan Chickpea Stew

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 25 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 15ml olive oil
- 1 large onion, diced
- 3 cloves garlic, minced
- 2 tsp ground cumin
- 1 tsp ground coriander
- 800g canned chickpeas, drained and rinsed
- 400g canned tomatoes
- 250ml vegetable stock
- Salt and pepper to taste

### **Directions:**

1. Heat olive oil in a large pot over medium heat. Sauté the onion until softened. Add garlic, cumin, and coriander, then cook for another minute until fragrant.
2. Stir in chickpeas, tomatoes, and vegetable stock. Let it simmer. Cover and cook on low for about 20 minutes until flavours meld together.
3. Season with salt and pepper before serving.

**Tips:** Garnish with fresh coriander leaves for an authentic touch.

**Serving size:** 1 bowl

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 250; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 40g; Protein: 10g; Sodium: 200mg; Sugar: 7g; Cholesterol: 5mg; Fibre: 6g



## **CHAPTER 7**

### **Dinner Recipes**

# Balanced Grilled and Roasted Proteins with Vegetables

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## 71. Lemon Herb Grilled Chicken with Asparagus

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 15 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### Ingredients:

- 4 boneless, skinless chicken breasts (about 600g)
- 1 lemon, juiced and zested (about 30ml juice)
- 30ml olive oil
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 tsp dried thyme
- 500g asparagus spears, trimmed
- Salt and pepper to taste

### Directions:

1. In a small bowl, mix the lemon juice, zest, olive oil, garlic, thyme, salt, and pepper.
2. Place the chicken breasts in a shallow dish and pour half of the marinade over them. Turn to coat well. Reserve the remaining marinade for basting.
3. Preheat a grill pan over medium heat. Grill the chicken for 6-7 minutes on each side or until cooked through. Baste with reserved marinade occasionally.
4. Meanwhile, toss the asparagus with a little olive oil, salt, and pepper. Grill for about 5 minutes until tender-crisp. Serve grilled chicken with asparagus.

**Tips:** For extra flavour, marinate the chicken for at least an hour before grilling.

**Serving size:** 1 chicken breast with asparagus

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 260; Fat: 12g; Carbs: 6g; Protein: 32g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 80mg; Fibre: 3g

## **72. Balsamic Roasted Salmon and Brussels Sprouts**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- Four salmon fillets (about 500g)
- 400g Brussels sprouts, halved
- 45ml balsamic vinegar
- Four cloves garlic, sliced thinly
- 30ml olive oil
- Salt and pepper to taste

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 200°C. Toss Brussels sprouts with half of the olive oil, garlic slices, salt, and pepper on a baking sheet. Spread out into an even layer.
2. Roast in your oven for 10 minutes until lightly browned. Remove tray and push sprouts to one side.
3. Place salmon fillets on empty space of tray, then brush each with a mix of balsamic vinegar, remaining olive oil, salt and pepper on top.
4. Return tray back into your oven, then continue to roast for ten minutes till salmon turns opaque.

**Tips:** Use wild-caught salmon for better flavour and nutrients.

**Serving size:** One salmon fillet with Brussels sprouts

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 325; Fat: 19g; Carbs: 11g; Protein: 31g; Sodium: 320mg; Sugar: 4g; Cholesterol: 70mg; Fibre: 5g

### **73.        Cajun Spice Turkey Breasts with Bell Peppers**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 500g turkey breasts
- 1 tbsp Cajun spice mix
- 2 bell peppers, sliced
- 30ml olive oil
- 100ml vegetable broth
- Salt and pepper to taste

**Directions:**

1. Preheat a pan over medium heat and add olive oil. Season turkey breasts with salt, pepper, and Cajun spice mix.
2. Sear the turkey breasts in the pan for about 3 minutes on each side until lightly brown.
3. Remove the turkey, add vegetable broth and bell peppers. Cook for about 5 minutes until peppers are tender.
4. Return the turkey to the pan, cover, and cook for another 12 minutes or until fully cooked through.

**Tips:** Use red, green, or yellow bell peppers for additional colour and flavour.

**Serving size:** 125g turkey breast with bell peppers

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 320; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 8g; Protein: 45g; Sodium: 350mg; Sugar: 4g; Cholesterol: 70mg; Fibre: 2g

## **74. Grilled Lime Marinated Pork Chops with Broccoli**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes + marinating time

**Cooking time:** 15 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 500g pork chops
- 50ml fresh lime juice
- Zest of one lime
- 30ml olive oil
- Salt and pepper to taste
- 500g broccoli florets

### **Directions:**

1. In a small bowl, combine lime juice, lime zest, olive oil, salt, and pepper. Marinate pork chops in the mixture for at least an hour in the refrigerator.
2. Preheat grill to medium-high heat and cook pork chops for 6 minutes on each side or until fully cooked through.
3. Meanwhile, steam broccoli florets for about 5 minutes until tender yet crisp. Serve the pork with the broccoli.

**Tips:** Ensure grill is preheated properly to sear pork chops nicely.

**Serving size:** One pork chop with 100g broccoli

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 280; Fat: 12g; Carbs: 6g; Protein: 36g; Sodium: 610mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 85mg; Fibre: 4g

## 75. Rosemary Infused Lamb Chops with Cauliflower

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 500g lamb chops
- 15ml olive oil
- 2 sprigs fresh rosemary
- 200g cauliflower, cut into florets
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- Salt and pepper to taste

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat your grill to medium-high heat.
2. In a bowl, mix olive oil, rosemary leaves, and minced garlic. Season the lamb chops with salt and pepper. Rub the rosemary mixture onto the lamb chops.
3. Place the cauliflower florets on a baking sheet and lightly drizzle with olive oil, season with salt and pepper.
4. Grill lamb chops for 3-4 minutes on each side until desired doneness is reached. Meanwhile, roast cauliflower in the oven for 15 minutes until tender and slightly golden.
5. Serve lamb chops hot with roasted cauliflower on the side.

**Tips:** Adjust seasoning as per your taste preference. Use fresh herbs for a more aromatic flavour.

**Serving size:** 125g lamb and 50g cauliflower

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 280; Fat: 18g; Carbs: 5g; Protein: 25g; Sodium: 70mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 65mg; Fibre: 2g

## **76. Garlic and Thyme Roasted Sea Bass with Green Beans**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 500g sea bass fillets
- 15ml olive oil
- Juice of one lemon
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- Fresh thyme leaves from two sprigs
- Salt and pepper to taste
- 200g green beans

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 200°C. Place sea bass fillets on baking tray, then drizzle with olive oil and lemon juice.
2. Sprinkle minced garlic, thyme leaves, salt, and pepper over fish. Add green beans to the tray around fish fillets, season lightly with salt.
3. Roast for about 15 minutes or until fish is cooked through and flakes easily. Serve immediately.

**Tips:** You can add a zest of lemon for extra tanginess. Make sure not to overcrowd fish and beans on tray for even cooking.

**Serving size:** One fillet and a handful of green beans

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 220; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 6g; Protein: 29g; Sodium: 75mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 70mg; Fibre: 3g

## **77. Paprika Spiced Beef Steaks with Courgettes**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 15 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 600g beef steaks
- 2 tsp paprika
- 30ml olive oil
- 300g courgettes, sliced
- Salt and black pepper to taste

### **Directions:**

1. Rub the beef steaks with olive oil, paprika, salt, and pepper. Heat a pan over medium-high heat and cook the steaks for 3–4 minutes on each side or until cooked to your liking. Remove and let it rest.
2. In the same pan, add sliced courgettes and stir-fry for about 5 minutes until tender. Season with salt and pepper. Serve the steaks with courgettes on the side.

**Tips:** For added flavour, squeeze some lemon juice over the courgettes before serving.

**Serving size:** 150g steak and 75g courgette

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 320; Fat: 20g; Carbs: 5g; Protein: 30g; Sodium: 70mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 80mg; Fibre: 2g



## **78. Grilled Cod Fillets with Cherry Tomatoes and Spinach**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 12 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 4 (150g) cod fillets
- 250g cherry tomatoes, halved
- 200g fresh spinach leaves
- Juice of one lemon
- Salt and black pepper to taste

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat your grill to medium-high heat. Season the cod fillets with lemon juice, salt, and pepper.
2. Place cod fillets on a baking tray lined with parchment paper. Grill for about 8–10 minutes until the fish is opaque and flakes easily.
3. In a separate pan, sauté cherry tomatoes in a small splash of water for about 2 minutes until soft.
4. Add spinach leaves to the tomatoes, cooking until just wilted. Serve the grilled cod garnished with warm tomato and spinach salad.

**Tips:** A sprinkle of fresh dill can enhance the flavour of this dish.

**Serving size:** One cod fillet and accompanying vegetables

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 240; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 6g; Protein: 34g; Sodium: 60mg; Sugar: 4g; Cholesterol: 65mg; Fibre: 3g

## **79.      Ginger Soy Chicken Thighs with Bok Choy**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 25 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 800g boneless, skinless chicken thighs
- 30ml soy sauce (low sodium)
- 1 tbsp fresh ginger, grated
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 200g bok choy, halved
- 15ml sesame oil
- 100ml water

### **Directions:**

1. In a bowl, mix soy sauce, ginger, and garlic. Add chicken thighs and marinate for 10 minutes.
2. Heat sesame oil in a large pan over medium heat. Add chicken and cook for 5 minutes on each side.
3. Pour in water, cover, and simmer for another 15 minutes. Add bok choy to the pan for the last 5 minutes of cooking.

**Tips:** Serve with steamed brown rice or quinoa for added fibre.

**Serving size:** 1 chicken thigh and bok choy

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 220; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 3g; Protein: 30g; Sodium: 340mg; Sugar: 1g; Cholesterol: 90mg; Fibre: 1g

## 80. Moroccan Spiced Roast Duck with Carrots

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 40 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 800g duck breast fillets, skin on
- 2 tsp ground cumin
- 1 tsp paprika
- Salt to taste
- Pepper to taste
- 300g carrots, sliced
- 15ml olive oil

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 200°C. Score duck skin lightly. Mix cumin, paprika, salt, and pepper in a small bowl. Rub spice mixture onto duck breasts.
2. Heat olive oil in an ovenproof pan over medium heat. Sear duck, skin-side down, until golden brown.
3. Turn the duck breasts over and add carrots to the pan. Transfer the pan to the oven and roast for about 20 minutes.

**Tips:** Let the duck rest before slicing to retain juices.

**Serving size:** One duck breast slice with carrots

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 295; Fat: 18g; Carbs: 7g; Protein: 25g; Sodium: 80mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 85mg; Fibre: 2g

# Simple One-Pot Meals for Busy Days

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## 81. Chicken and Chickpea Stew with Spinach

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 30 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### Ingredients:

- 500g chicken breast, diced
- 400g can of chickpeas, drained and rinsed
- 200g fresh spinach
- 1 onion, chopped
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 400g can of chopped tomatoes
- 300ml low-sodium chicken stock
- 15ml olive oil

### Directions:

1. Heat the olive oil in a large pot over medium heat. Add the onion and garlic, then sauté until softened.
2. Add the chicken, and cook until browned. Stir in the chickpeas, tomatoes, and chicken stock. Let it simmer.
3. Cover and cook for about 20 minutes until the chicken is cooked through. Add the spinach in the last few minutes of cooking, allowing it to wilt. Season with salt and pepper.

**Tips:** Serve with a squeeze of lemon juice for added flavour.

**Serving size:** 1 bowl

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 320; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 30g; Protein: 36g; Sodium: 350mg; Sugar: 6g; Cholesterol: 80mg; Fibre: 8g

## 82. Vegetable Lentil Soup with Herbs

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 40 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 250g dried lentils, rinsed
- 2 carrots, diced
- 2 celery stalks, diced
- 1 onion, chopped
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 litre low-sodium vegetable stock
- 15ml olive oil
- Mixed fresh herbs (e.g. parsley, thyme), chopped

**Directions:**

1. Heat olive oil in a large pot over medium heat. Sauté onion, garlic, carrots and celery until softened.
2. Add lentils and vegetable stock to the pot. Let it boil then adjust to a simmer for about 30 minutes until lentils are tender. Stir in the fresh herbs before serving.

**Tips:** For added zest, add a splash of vinegar before serving.

**Serving size:** 1 bowl

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 270; Fat: 5g; Carbs: 45g; Protein: 18g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 7g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 12g

### **83. Beef and Barley Casserole with Mushrooms**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 40 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 500g beef mince
- 150g pearl barley
- 200g mushrooms, sliced
- 1 onion, diced
- 400g (1 can) chopped tomatoes in juice
- 500ml beef stock
- 15ml olive oil
- Salt and pepper to taste

**Directions:**

1. In a large pot, heat olive oil over medium heat. Add the onion and cook until softened. Add beef mince and cook until browned. Drain any excess fat.
2. Stir in mushrooms and cook for a few more minutes until tender. Add the pearl barley, chopped tomatoes, and beef stock. Season with salt and pepper.
3. Let it boil, adjust to low heat, cover, and simmer for 30 minutes or until the barley is tender and liquid absorbed.

**Tips:** For added flavour, sprinkle with fresh herbs like parsley before serving.

**Serving size:** 350g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 320; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 35g; Protein: 25g; Sodium: 300mg; Sugar: 5g; Cholesterol: 70mg; Fibre: 7g

## **84. Tuscan White Bean Chicken Skillet**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 25 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 500g chicken breast, diced
- 400g (1 can) white beans, drained and rinsed
- 200g cherry tomatoes, halved
- 100ml chicken stock
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- Handful of spinach leaves
- Salt and pepper to taste

### **Directions:**

1. In a large skillet, heat olive oil over medium heat. Add the chicken pieces and cook until golden brown on all sides.
2. Add cherry tomatoes and cook for another few minutes until they start to soften.
3. Stir in the white beans and chicken stock. Cook for about 10 minutes until everything is well combined and heated through.
4. Add spinach leaves for the last minute of cooking to wilt slightly. Season with salt and pepper before serving.

**Tips:** For extra zest, add a squeeze of lemon over the dish before serving.

**Serving size:** ¼ of the recipe

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 290; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 28g; Protein: 30g; Sodium: 240mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 75mg; Fibre: 6g

## **85. Cod and Vegetable Ratatouille Medley**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 500g cod fillets, cut into chunks
- 2 courgettes, diced
- 1 red pepper, diced
- 400g tin of chopped tomatoes
- 1 aubergine, diced
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 15ml olive oil

### **Directions:**

1. Heat olive oil in a large pot over medium heat. Add garlic and cook for 1 minute until fragrant.
2. Add courgettes, red pepper, and aubergine. Sauté for about 5 minutes until vegetables begin to soften.
3. Pour in the chopped tomatoes and stir well to combine. Allow to simmer for 10 minutes.
4. Place the cod chunks on top of the vegetables, cover the pot and let cook for about 5 minutes or until the fish is just cooked through and flakes easily with a fork.

**Tips:** For added flavour, sprinkle with fresh basil or parsley before serving.

**Serving size:** 300g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 231; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 18g; Protein: 30g; Sodium: 288mg; Sugar: 8g; Cholesterol: 62mg; Fibre: 6g



## **86. Sausage, Tomato, and Pepper Stew**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 25 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 450g turkey sausages, sliced
- 400g tin of chopped tomatoes
- 2 red peppers, sliced
- 150ml vegetable stock
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 15ml olive oil

### **Directions:**

1. Heat olive oil in a large pot over medium heat. Add the turkey sausages and cook until browned on all sides.
2. Add the garlic and peppers to the pot and sauté for an additional minute. Pour in the tomatoes and vegetable stock. Stir well.
3. Let it boil, adjust to low heat and simmer for about 20 minutes until the stew thickens slightly.

**Tips:** Serve with a side salad for a balanced meal.

**Serving size:** 350ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 265; Fat: 14g; Carbs: 12g; Protein: 22g; Sodium: 680mg; Sugar: 6g; Cholesterol: 56mg; Fibre: 4g

## **87. Turkey Mince and Kidney Bean Chilli**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 25 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 500g turkey mince
- 1 can (400g) kidney beans, drained and rinsed
- 1 red pepper, diced
- 400g chopped tomatoes
- 1 onion, finely chopped
- 15ml olive oil
- 2 tsp chilli powder

### **Directions:**

1. Heat the olive oil in a large pot over medium heat. Add the onion and red pepper, and sauté until soft.
2. Add the turkey mince and cook until browned, breaking it apart with a wooden spoon as it cooks.
3. Stir in the chopped tomatoes, kidney beans, and chilli powder. Simmer for 15 minutes until thickened and flavours have melded together.

**Tips:** Serve with a dollop of natural yogurt or a squeeze of lime juice for added flavour.

**Serving size:** 250g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 320; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 20g; Protein: 35g; Sodium: 480mg; Sugar: 8g; Cholesterol: 75mg; Fibre: 6g

## **88. Mediterranean Chickpea and Spinach Skillet**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 2 cans (400g each) chickpeas, drained and rinsed
- 200g fresh spinach leaves
- 400g chopped tomatoes
- 1 onion, sliced
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 30ml extra virgin olive oil
- Salt and black pepper to taste

### **Directions:**

1. In a large skillet, heat the olive oil over medium heat. Add the onion and garlic, cooking until softened.
2. Stir in the chickpeas and chopped tomatoes; cook for about 10 minutes until it begins to thicken slightly.
3. Add the spinach and cook for another few minutes until wilted. Season with salt and pepper. Serve.

**Tips:** Top with crumbled feta cheese or pine nuts for added texture and flavour if permissible within dietary needs.

**Serving size:** 300g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 290; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 35g; Protein: 10g; Sodium: 400mg; Sugar: 8g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 10g

## **89. Pork and Apple Braised Cabbage Pot**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 35 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 500g pork tenderloin, sliced thinly
- 300g green cabbage, shredded
- 2 small apples, chopped
- 1 onion, finely sliced
- 300ml low-sodium chicken stock
- 15ml olive oil
- Salt and pepper to taste

### **Directions:**

1. Heat oil in a large pot over medium heat. Add pork slices and cook until browned. Remove and set aside.
2. In the same pot, add onion and cook until translucent. Add cabbage, apples, and chicken stock. Stir well.
3. Return the pork to the pot and bring to a simmer. Cover and cook on low heat for about 25 minutes or until the cabbage is tender. Season with salt and pepper before serving.

**Tips:** Serve hot with a side of boiled potatoes or whole grain bread for added fibre.

**Serving size:** 1/4 of the total dish

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 250; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 18g; Protein: 24g; Sodium: 110mg; Sugar: 12g; Cholesterol: 65mg; Fibre: 4g

## 90. Thai Coconut Curry Chicken Thighs

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 30 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 500g chicken thighs, skinless and boneless
- 400ml light coconut milk
- 1 tbsp red curry paste
- 150g bell pepper, sliced
- 100g green beans
- Juice of one lime
- Fresh coriander for garnish (optional)

### **Directions:**

1. In a large pot, heat a 15ml coconut milk over medium heat. Add curry paste and cook for a minute until fragrant. Add chicken thighs and brown on all sides for 5 minutes.
2. Pour in the remaining coconut milk, then add bell pepper and green beans. Stir well to combine all ingredients.
3. Bring to a low simmer, cover, and cook for 20 minutes or until chicken is cooked through. Squeeze lime juice over the dish before serving.

**Tips:** For added flavour, garnish with fresh coriander leaves.

**Serving size:** 1/4 of the total dish

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 320; Fat: 16g; Carbs: 18g; Protein: 29g; Sodium: 95mg; Sugar: 5g; Cholesterol: 70mg; Fibre: 3g

# Delicious Vegetarian and Vegan Options

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## 91. Lentil Shepherd's Pie with Mashed Sweet Potato

**Preparation time:** 20 minutes

**Cooking time:** 35 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### Ingredients:

- 200g red lentils
- 500ml vegetable stock
- 2 medium carrots, diced
- 1 large onion, chopped
- 100g frozen peas
- 1 tbsp tomato purée
- 1/2 tsp dried thyme
- 800g sweet potatoes, peeled and chopped

### Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 200°C. Boil sweet potatoes in a pot of water for 15 minutes until tender. Drain and mash. Set aside.
2. In a separate pan, cook onion and carrots over medium heat until soft. Add lentils, tomato purée, thyme, and vegetable stock. Simmer for 20 minutes until lentils are soft. Stir in peas.
3. Spoon the lentil mixture into an ovenproof dish and top with mashed sweet potato evenly. Bake for about 10 minutes or until the top is slightly golden.

**Tips:** For added flavour, sprinkle a little paprika over the mash before baking.

**Serving size:** 1/4 of the pie

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 310; Fat: 1g; Carbs: 60g; Protein: 12g; Sodium: 310mg; Sugar: 13g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 16g

## 92. Spicy Chickpea and Quinoa Stir Fry

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 200g quinoa
- 400g canned chickpeas, drained and rinsed
- 2 red bell peppers, sliced
- 1 small broccoli head, cut into florets
- Small handful of fresh coriander, chopped
- Juice of one lime
- Spices for taste preference (like cumin or chilli powder)

**Directions:**

1. Cook quinoa according to package instructions. Heat oil in a frying pan and sauté broccoli and red peppers until tender-crisp.
2. Add chickpeas to the pan with spices and lime juice, cooking for 5 minutes. Stir in cooked quinoa. Garnish with fresh coriander before serving.

**Tips:** For extra kick, add a dash of cayenne pepper.

**Serving size:** 1/4 of the stir fry

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 360; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 67g; Protein: 14g; Sodium: 230mg; Sugar: 9g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 12g

### **93. Aubergine Bolognese over Whole Wheat Spaghetti**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 30 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 2 medium aubergines, diced
- 30ml olive oil (30ml)
- 1 onion, finely chopped
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 can chopped tomatoes
- 1 tsp dried oregano
- Salt and pepper to taste
- 250g whole wheat spaghetti

**Directions:**

1. Heat olive oil in a large pan over medium heat. Add the onion and garlic, sautéing until soft. Add diced aubergines and cook until they begin to soften.
2. Pour in tomatoes and add oregano, salt, and pepper. Simmer for 20 minutes, stirring occasionally.
3. Meanwhile, cook whole wheat spaghetti according to package instructions. Drain well. Serve the Bolognese sauce over the cooked spaghetti.

**Tips:** For added flavour, sprinkle with chilli flakes or fresh basil before serving.

**Serving size:** 200g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 280; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 45g; Protein: 8g; Sodium: 60mg; Sugar: 10g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 10g



## **94.        Roasted Red Pepper and Tomato Soup**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 25 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 3 large red peppers, roasted and peeled
- 15ml olive oil
- 1 onion, chopped
- 2 cloves garlic, crushed
- 2 cans (800g total) chopped tomatoes
- Salt and pepper to taste
- Fresh basil leaves to garnish

### **Directions:**

1. In a large pot, heat olive oil over medium heat and sauté onion and garlic until translucent.
2. Add roasted peppers and canned tomatoes to the pot, season with salt and pepper. Let it boil, then adjust to a simmer for about 15 minutes.
3. Blend the mixture until smooth using a hand blender or regular blender in batches. Reheat, if necessary, before serving hot, garnished with fresh basil leaves.

**Tips:** To save time, use jarred roasted red peppers.

**Serving size:** 1 medium bowl

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 120; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 18g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 75mg; Sugar: 9g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 4g

## **95. Cauliflower and Broccoli Tikka Masala**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 25 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 500g cauliflower, cut into florets
- 300g broccoli, cut into florets
- 200ml coconut milk
- 150ml tomato passata
- 1 onion, finely chopped
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 tbsp tikka masala paste

### **Directions:**

1. Heat a large pan over medium heat and add the onion and garlic. Sauté until soft. Stir in the tikka masala paste and cook for another minute.
2. Add the cauliflower and broccoli to the pan, stirring to coat with spices. Pour in the coconut milk and tomato passata, then cover and simmer for 20 minutes.
3. Serve hot with a sprinkle of fresh coriander if desired.

**Tips:** Use pre-chopped vegetables to save on prep time.

**Serving size:** 200g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 180; Fat: 12g; Carbs: 14g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 160mg; Sugar: 5g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 6g

## 96. Mushroom and Spinach Risotto

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 250g arborio rice
- 200g mushrooms, sliced
- 150g spinach leaves
- 1 onion, finely chopped
- 1 litre vegetable stock
- 100ml almond milk

**Directions:**

1. In a large pan, sauté the onion until translucent. Add mushrooms and cook until softened.
2. Stir in the arborio rice and gradually add vegetable stock as it absorbs.
3. Once the rice is creamy and tender, add spinach and almond milk. Stir well until spinach wilts.

**Tips:** Use frozen spinach for convenience.

**Serving size:** 220g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 220; Fat: 3g; Carbs: 42g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre :4g

## 97. Vegan Black Bean Chilli with Avocado

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 30 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 30ml olive oil
- 1 large onion, chopped
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 red bell pepper, diced
- 2 tsp ground cumin
- 400 g canned black beans, drained and rinsed
- 400 g tinned chopped tomatoes
- Salt and pepper to taste
- 1 avocado, sliced

### **Directions:**

1. Heat the olive oil in a large pot over medium heat. Add the onion and garlic, and sauté until softened.
2. Add the red bell pepper and cumin; stir well for a minute. Stir in the black beans and tinned tomatoes. Season with salt and pepper to taste.
3. Let it boil, then reduce the heat and let it simmer for about 20 minutes. Serve hot in bowls topped with slices of fresh avocado.

**Tips:** Add a pinch of smoked paprika for extra flavour. You can pair this dish with steamed rice or whole grain bread.

**Serving size:** 1 bowl

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 210; Fat: 10 g; Carbs: 25g; Protein: 8g; Sodium: 300mg; Sugar: 6g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 9g

## 98. Baked Sweet Potato Stuffed with Quinoa Salad

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 45 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 4 medium sweet potatoes (about 800g total)
- 200 g cooked quinoa
- Juice of half a lemon (25ml)
- Handful fresh parsley, chopped
- Salt and pepper to taste
- 150g cherry tomatoes halved
- Olive oil spray

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat the oven to 200°C. Wash sweet potatoes thoroughly, pierce them with a fork several times, and place them on a baking tray. Bake for about 40–45 minutes or until tender.
2. In a mixing bowl, combine cooked quinoa, lemon juice, parsley, salt, pepper, and cherry tomatoes.
3. Once sweet potatoes are cooked, cut them open lengthwise and slightly mash the insides with a fork. Stuff each sweet potato with the quinoa salad mixture.

**Tips:** Garnish with extra parsley or add a sprinkling of pumpkin seeds for crunch.

**Serving size:** One stuffed sweet potato

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 350; Fat: 5 g; Carbs: 68 g; Protein: 8g; Sodium: 60 mg; Sugar: 12g; Cholesterol: 0 mg; Fibre: 11g

## **99. Courgette Noodles with Pesto Sauce**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 5 minutes

**Servings:** 2

### **Ingredients:**

- 400g courgettes
- 50g fresh basil leaves
- 30g pine nuts
- 25g nutritional yeast
- 2 cloves garlic
- 60ml extra virgin olive oil
- Salt and pepper to taste

### **Directions:**

1. Spiralise the courgettes to create noodle-like strands. Set aside. In a food processor, blend the basil, pine nuts, nutritional yeast, and garlic until finely chopped.
2. Gradually add olive oil while blending until smooth. Adjust seasoning with salt and pepper.  
Toss the courgette noodles with the pesto sauce until well coated. Serve immediately.

**Tips:** For added texture, lightly toast the pine nuts before blending.

**Serving size:** 200g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 250; Fat: 23g; Carbs: 11g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 20mg; Sugar: 6g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 4g

## **100. Creamy Carrot and Coriander Soup**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 25 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 800g carrots, peeled and sliced
- 1 litre vegetable stock
- 200ml coconut milk
- 2 tsp ground coriander
- Salt and pepper to taste
- Fresh coriander leaves for garnish

### **Directions:**

1. In a large saucepan, combine carrots and vegetable stock. Boil over medium heat for about 20 minutes or until carrots are tender.
2. Stir in ground coriander and let simmer for another minute.
3. Use a stick blender to puree the soup until smooth. Stir in coconut milk, adjusting seasoning with salt and pepper as needed.
4. Garnish with fresh coriander leaves before serving.

**Tips:** You can add a squeeze of lime juice for a zesty kick.

**Serving size:** 300ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 180; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 22g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 300mg; Sugar: 11g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 6g

## **CHAPTER 8**

# **Snack and Appetizer Recipes**



# Guilt-Free Snacks to Curb Cravings

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## 101. Baked Kale Chips with Sea Salt

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 15 minutes

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 200g kale
- 15ml olive oil
- 1/4 tsp sea salt

**Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 150°C. Wash the kale thoroughly and dry it with a salad spinner or kitchen towel. Tear the kale leaves into bite-sized pieces, discarding the tough stems.
2. In a large bowl, drizzle the kale with olive oil and sprinkle with sea salt, tossing well to ensure even coverage.
3. Spread the kale out in a single layer on a baking tray lined with parchment paper.
4. Bake for 12-15 minutes, or until crispy but not burnt. Keep a close eye towards the end to avoid overcooking.

**Tips:** For extra flavour, add a pinch of garlic powder or chilli flakes before baking. Ensure kale is fully dried before applying oil to enhance crispiness.

**Serving size:** About 100g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 110; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 10g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 120mg; Sugar: 0g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 3g

## **102.     Roasted Chickpeas with Paprika**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 25 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 400g canned chickpeas, drained and rinsed, pat dried
- 15ml olive oil
- 1 tsp paprika
- Salt to taste (optional)

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 200°C. In a bowl, toss chickpeas with olive oil and paprika until well-coated.
2. Spread them out on a baking tray. Roast in the oven for about 25 minutes, shaking the tray occasionally for even roasting, until they are golden and crispy.

**Tips:** Adjust seasoning according to personal taste preferences.

**Serving size:** About 100g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 130; Fat: 5g; Carbs: 19g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 120mg; Sugar: <1g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 6g

## **103.     Cucumber Slices with Hummus**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 2 large cucumbers, sliced into thick rounds
- 200g hummus

- 5ml lemon juice
- Pinch of paprika (optional)
- 100g cherry tomatoes

**Directions:**

1. Spread a spoonful of hummus over each cucumber slice. Sprinkle a small amount of lemon juice on top.
2. Garnish with a dusting of paprika, if desired. Serve with whole cherry tomatoes on the side.

**Tips:** Use fresh, firm cucumbers for the best crunch. The hummus can be flavoured or plain as per preference.

**Serving size:** 100g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 78; Fat: 4g; Carbs: 9g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 158mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 3g

## 104. Greek Yoghurt Parfait with Berries

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 300g Greek yoghurt
- 150g mixed berries (such as strawberries, blueberries, raspberries)
- 1 tbsp chia seeds
- 15ml honey

**Directions:**

1. Divide half of the Greek yoghurt between two serving glasses. Layer half of the mixed berries over the yoghurt.
2. Sprinkle half of the chia seeds over the berries. Repeat the layers once more with the remaining ingredients. Drizzle honey on top before serving.

**Tips:** Chill your parfait in the fridge for a bit if you prefer a colder dessert or snack.

**Serving size:** 225g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 200; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 28g; Protein: 11g; Sodium: 60mg; Sugar: 21g; Cholesterol: 8mg; Fibre: 6g

## **105. Apple Slices with Almond Butter**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 1 large apple (approximately 250g)
- 60ml almond butter

**Directions:**

1. Wash and core the apple, then slice it into even pieces.
2. Serve the apple slices on a plate with a side of almond butter for dipping.

**Tips:** Choose almonds that are unsweetened and low in added oils for a healthier option. Opt for different types of apples depending on your taste preference—Granny Smith for tartness or Royal Gala for sweetness.

**Serving size:** Apple slices with 30ml almond butter per serving

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 155; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 16g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 0mg; Sugar: 11g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 4g

## **106. Carrot Sticks with Low-Fat Ranch Dip**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 400g carrots, peeled and cut into sticks
- 100ml low-fat ranch dressing

**Directions:**

1. Arrange the carrot sticks neatly on a platter.
2. Pour the ranch dressing into a small bowl for dipping and place it alongside the carrots.

**Tips:** Try using rainbow carrots for visual appeal and varied flavour. Prepare the carrot sticks in advance and store them in cold water to maintain crispness.

**Serving size:** 100g carrot sticks with 25ml ranch dip

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 70; Fat: 3g; Carbs: 8g; Protein:1g; Sodium:140mg; Sugar: 4g; Cholesterol:0mg; Fibre: 2g

## **107. Wholegrain Crackers with Low-Fat Cheese**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 100g wholegrain crackers
- 60g low-fat cheese slices

**Directions:**

1. Place the wholegrain crackers on a plate.

2. Top each cracker with a slice of low-fat cheese.

**Tips:** For extra flavour, add a sprinkle of black pepper or oregano on the cheese.

**Serving size:** 50g crackers with 30g cheese

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 150; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 18g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 180mg; Sugar: 1.5g; Cholesterol: 10mg; Fibre: 3g

## **108. Avocado and Tomato Lettuce Wraps**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 200g ripe avocado, mashed
- 200g cherry tomatoes, halved
- Iceberg lettuce leaves (roughly 8 large leaves)
- 30ml lime juice
- Salt and pepper to taste

**Directions:**

1. In a bowl, combine the mashed avocado with lime juice, salt, and pepper. Place the lettuce leaves flat on a serving plate.
2. Spoon the avocado mixture onto each lettuce leaf. Top with halved cherry tomatoes.

**Tips:** Serve immediately to prevent the avocado from browning. Substitute iceberg lettuce with any large leaf lettuce of your choice.

**Serving size:** Two lettuce wraps

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 120; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 9g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 10mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 5g

## **109. Celery Sticks with Peanut Butter**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 200g celery sticks
- 120g natural peanut butter (unsweetened, no added sugar)

**Directions:**

1. Wash and dry the celery sticks.
2. Spread approximately 30g of peanut butter evenly across the top of each celery stick.

**Tips:** For an added crunch, sprinkle a small amount of chopped almonds or walnuts on top of the peanut butter.

**Serving size:** 50g celery sticks with 30g peanut butter

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 120; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 5g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 70mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 2g

## **110. Strawberries with Dark Chocolate Drizzle**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 300g fresh strawberries, hulled
- 100g dark chocolate (min. 70% cocoa)

**Directions:**

1. Rinse the strawberries under cool water and pat dry with paper towels. Set aside.

2. Melt the dark chocolate in a heatproof bowl over a pan of gently simmering water, stirring until smooth.
3. Drizzle the melted dark chocolate over the strawberries using a spoon or fork.

**Tips:** Opt for organic strawberries when possible to avoid pesticide residue.

**Serving size:** 75g strawberries with 25g dark chocolate drizzle

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 145; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 17g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 5mg; Sugar: 13g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 3g



# Creative Use of Nuts, Seeds, and Fruits

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## 111. Walnut and Chia Seed Energy Balls

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 10 energy balls

**Ingredients:**

- 150g walnuts
- 50g chia seeds
- 80g oats
- 100g dates, pitted
- 2 tbsp honey or agave syrup
- 30ml almond milk

**Directions:**

1. Place the walnuts, chia seeds, oats, and dates in a food processor. Blend until finely mixed.
2. Add honey and almond milk to the mixture and blend until it forms a sticky dough.
3. Roll the mixture into small balls using your hands. If the dough is too sticky, add a little more oat to balance the consistency.
4. Chill in the refrigerator for at least 30 minutes before serving.

**Tips:** For added flavour, you can roll these energy balls in a bit of extra chia seeds or crushed nuts before chilling.

**Serving size:** 1 ball

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 120; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 12g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 5mg; Sugar: 6g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 3g

## **112. Almond and Apple Quinoa Salad**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 200g quinoa, cooked and cooled
- 1 large apple, cored and diced
- 50g almonds, chopped
- 50g dried cranberries
- 15ml lemon juice
- Salt to taste
- A handful of fresh coriander leaves

### **Directions:**

1. In a large bowl, combine the cooked quinoa, diced apple, chopped almonds, and dried cranberries.
2. Drizzle with lemon juice and season with salt to taste. Toss well to combine all ingredients thoroughly.
3. Garnish with fresh coriander leaves prior to serving.

**Tips:** To make it more vibrant, consider adding some grated carrot or diced cucumber for extra crunch.

**Serving size:** ¼ of the recipe

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 220; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 34g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 20mg; Sugar:12g; Cholesterol:0mg; Fibre:5g

### **113. Flaxseed and Banana Smoothie Bowl**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 2 ripe bananas
- 250 ml unsweetened almond milk
- 2 tbsp ground flaxseed
- 100 g Greek yoghurt (low-fat)
- 50 g blueberries
- 30 g mixed nuts (crushed)

**Directions:**

1. In a blender, combine bananas, almond milk, flaxseed, and Greek yoghurt. Blend until smooth.
2. Divide the mixture into two bowls. Top each bowl with blueberries and crushed mixed nuts.

**Tips:** You can add a dash of cinnamon for extra flavour.

**Serving size:** 300ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 250; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 30g; Protein: 10g; Sodium: 60mg; Sugar: 20g; Cholesterol: 5mg; Fibre: 6g

## **114. Pistachio-Crusted Chicken Tenders**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 500g chicken breast tenders
- 100g pistachios, shelled and finely chopped
- 1 egg, beaten
- Salt to taste
- Pepper to taste
- Cooking spray

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat the oven to 200°C. Season the chicken tenders with salt and pepper. Dip each tender into the beaten egg, then roll in the pistachios, pressing gently to coat.
2. Place the coated tenders on your lined baking tray and lightly spray with cooking oil. Bake for about 20 minutes or until the chicken is cooked through and golden brown.

**Tips:** Pair with a green salad or steamed vegetables for a balanced meal.

**Serving size:** 125g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 310; Fat: 16g; Carbs: 6g; Protein: 35g; Sodium: 120mg; Sugar: 1g; Cholesterol: 90mg; Fibre: 2g

## **115. Blueberry and Hazelnut Overnight Oats**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes + chilling time

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 100g rolled oats
- 200ml unsweetened almond milk
- 50g fresh blueberries
- 30g hazelnuts, chopped
- 1 tbsp chia seeds
- 1 tbsp Greek yoghurt

**Directions:**

1. In a bowl, combine the oats, almond milk, chia seeds, and Greek yoghurt. Stir well. Fold in half of the blueberries and hazelnuts.
2. Divide the mixture into two jars or bowls. Top with remaining blueberries and hazelnuts. Cover and refrigerate overnight or for at least 4 hours before serving.

**Tips:** For extra flavour, add a dash of cinnamon or vanilla extract before chilling.

**Serving size:** 1 jar/bowl

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 250; Fat: 12g; Carbs: 27g; Protein: 7g; Sodium: 60mg; Sugar: 5g; Cholesterol: 1mg; Fibre: 7g

## **116. Pumpkin Seed and Apricot Granola Bars**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes + chilling time

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 8 bars

### **Ingredients:**

- 120g rolled oats
- 50g dried apricots, chopped
- 40g pumpkin seeds
- 70ml honey
- 50g natural peanut butter
- A pinch of salt

### **Directions:**

1. In a large bowl, combine oats, apricots, pumpkin seeds, and salt.
2. In a small saucepan over low heat, warm the honey and peanut butter until smooth. Combine it with the oat mixture until blended.
3. Press the mixture firmly into a lined tray, then refrigerate for at least one hour until set. Cut into bars once firm and store in an airtight container in the fridge.

**Tips:** Add some cinnamon or nutmeg to the mixture for extra warmth and flavour.

**Serving size:** 1 bar

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 180; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 27g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 50mg; Sugar: 13g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 3g

## **117.     Cashew and Mango Coconut Rice Pudding**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 100g basmati rice, rinsed
- 400ml coconut milk
- 1 mango, peeled and diced (approx. 200g)
- 50g cashews, chopped
- 1 tbsp sweetener of choice (as per dietary needs)
- Pinch of salt

### **Directions:**

1. In a saucepan, combine rice, coconut milk, and salt. Let it boil over medium heat.
2. Adjust to a simmer, cover and cook for 15 minutes until rice is tender and liquid is absorbed.
3. Stir in the diced mango, sweetener, and chopped cashews. Heat through for another 5 minutes. Serve warm or chilled.

**Tips:** For extra flavour, garnish with fresh mint leaves or a sprinkle of cinnamon.

**Serving size:** 150g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 245; Fat: 12g; Carbs: 32g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 20mg; Sugar: 8g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 2g

## **118. Pecan and Pear Mini Tarts**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 6

**Ingredients:**

- 1 sheet ready-made shortcrust pastry
- 2 pears, peeled and sliced thinly
- 50g pecans, chopped
- 1 tbsp ground cinnamon
- Zest of one lemon
- Sweetener to taste (as per dietary needs)

**Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 180°C. Grease a muffin tin. Roll out the pastry and cut into circles to fit the muffin holes.
2. In a bowl, toss pear slices with cinnamon, lemon zest, and sweetener. Arrange pear slices into each pastry case and sprinkle with chopped pecans.
3. Bake for about 20 minutes until pastry edges are golden brown. Cool slightly before serving.

**Tips:** Serve with a dollop of Greek yoghurt for added creaminess.

**Serving size:** One mini tart

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 190; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 25g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 160mg; Sugar: 7g; Cholesterol: 5mg; Fibre: 3g.



## **119. Sunflower Seed and Raspberry Snack Bars**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 15 minutes

**Servings:** 8

### **Ingredients:**

- 150g rolled oats
- 100g sunflower seeds
- 75ml honey
- 50g raspberries (fresh or dried)
- 50ml almond butter
- Pinch of salt

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 170°C. In a large bowl, mix the oats, sunflower seeds, and a pinch of salt.
2. In a small saucepan, gently heat the honey and almond butter until smooth and combined. Remove from heat.
3. Pour the honey mixture over the dry ingredients, add raspberries, and stir well to combine. Press the mixture firmly onto your lined tray, ensuring an even layer.
4. Bake for about 15 minutes or until lightly golden on top. Let cool before cutting into bars.

**Tips:** Store in an airtight container for up to a week; these bars are perfect for on-the-go snacks.

**Serving size:** 1 bar

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 160; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 19g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 10mg; Sugar: 7g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 3g

## 120. Almond Flour and Cranberry Cookies

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 12 minutes

**Servings:** 12

### **Ingredients:**

- 200g almond flour
- 75g dried cranberries, chopped
- 50ml olive oil
- 50ml maple syrup or low-sugar syrup
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- Pinch of salt
- Half tsp baking powder

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 180°C. In a bowl, mix the almond flour, baking powder, and salt.
2. In another bowl, whisk together olive oil, maple syrup, and vanilla. Combine wet and dry ingredients and fold in the cranberries.
3. Scoop tbsp-sized portions onto your lined tray, flattening slightly with a fork. Bake for 12 minutes or until edges are golden brown. Allow to cool completely on a wire rack.

**Tips:** For extra flavour, add a pinch of cinnamon to the dough.

**Serving size:** 1 cookie

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 130; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 11g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 30mg; Sugar: 5g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 2g

# Dips, Spreads, and Crackers for Entertaining

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## 121. Creamy Avocado Salsa Dip with Wholegrain Crackers

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

### Ingredients:

- 2 ripe avocados, halved & pitted
- 1 small tomato, diced
- 100ml Greek yoghurt, low-fat
- 15ml lime juice
- 50g red onion, finely chopped
- 2 tbsp fresh coriander, chopped (optional)
- Salt and black pepper to taste

### Directions:

1. Scoop out the avocado flesh into a bowl. Mash with a fork until smooth. Add tomato, Greek yoghurt, lime juice, and red onion. Stir until combined.
2. Season with salt and black pepper. Garnish with fresh coriander if desired. Serve immediately with wholegrain crackers.

**Tips:** To prevent browning, store the avocado dip in an airtight container with a layer of cling film pressed directly on its surface.

**Serving size:** 75g of dip

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 150; Fat: 12g; Carbs: 8g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 5g

## **122.      Roasted Red Pepper Hummus with Veggie Sticks**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 400g chickpeas, drained and rinsed
- 100g roasted red peppers from a jar
- 30 lemon juice
- 60ml olive oil
- 2 cloves of garlic, minced
- Salt and black pepper to taste
- A selection of veggie sticks (carrot, cucumber, celery)

### **Directions:**

1. Combine chickpeas, roasted red peppers, lemon juice, olive oil, and minced garlic in a food processor.
2. Blend until smooth and creamy, adding a little water if necessary to reach desired consistency.
3. Season with salt and black pepper. Serve with a selection of fresh veggie sticks.

**Tips:** For added flavour, sprinkle with paprika or drizzle extra olive oil on top before serving.

**Serving size:** 75g of hummus with veggies

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 180; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 16g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 130mg; Sugar: 1g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 6g

### **123. Smoked Salmon Spread on Rye Crispbread**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 200g smoked salmon, finely chopped
- 100g low-fat cream cheese
- 1 tbsp lemon juice
- 1 tbsp fresh dill, chopped
- Black pepper, to taste
- 8 rye crispbreads

**Directions:**

1. In a bowl, combine the chopped salmon, cream cheese, lemon juice, and dill. Mix until well-blended.
2. Season with black pepper. Spread the mixture evenly over each rye crispbread.

**Tips:** For added crunch, top with a few slices of cucumber or radish.

**Serving size:** 2 crispbreads

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 160; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 12g; Protein: 13g; Sodium: 420mg; Sugar: 1g; Cholesterol: 30mg; Fibre: 3g

### **124. Spinach Artichoke Dip with Oat Crackers**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 6

**Ingredients:**

- 150g fresh spinach, chopped

- 120g canned artichoke hearts, drained and chopped
- 100g low-fat Greek yoghurt
- 50g grated parmesan cheese
- 1 garlic clove, minced
- Black pepper, to taste
- 18 oat crackers

**Directions:**

1. In a bowl, mix the chopped spinach and artichoke hearts.
2. Add the Greek yoghurt, parmesan cheese, and garlic. Mix well.
3. Season with black pepper to taste. Serve with oat crackers.

**Tips:** Use fresh artichokes when available for a more vibrant flavour.

**Serving size:** 3 tbsp dip with crackers

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 130; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 16g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 180mg; Sugar: 1g; Cholesterol: 10mg; Fibre: 2g

## **125. Baked Sweet Potato Chips with Lentil Dip**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 500g sweet potatoes, sliced thinly
- 15ml olive oil
- 250g canned lentils, drained and rinsed
- 100g Greek yogurt
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 50ml lemon juice
- Salt and pepper to taste

**Directions:**

1. Preheat the oven to 200°C. Toss the sweet potatoes slices in olive oil, salt, and pepper. Arrange them on the baking tray.
2. Bake for 15–20 minutes or until crispy, flipping halfway through cooking.
3. For the dip, blend lentils, Greek yogurt, garlic, and lemon juice until smooth. Season with salt and pepper to taste. Serve chips warm with lentil dip on the side.

**Tips:** For extra flavour, sprinkle sweet potato slices with cinnamon before baking.

**Serving size:** 125g of chips with dip

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 180; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 28g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 4g; Cholesterol: 2mg; Fibre: 5g

## **126. Beetroot Hummus with Seeded Crackers**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A (if using store-bought crackers)

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 250g cooked beetroot
- 400g canned chickpeas, drained and rinsed
- Juice of half a lemon (about 25ml)
- 60ml tahini
- 2 cloves garlic
- Salt and pepper to taste
- Seeded crackers (store-bought), about 16 pieces

**Directions:**

1. Blend beetroot, chickpeas, lemon juice, tahini, and garlic in a food processor until smooth.
2. Season with salt and pepper to taste.
3. Serve beetroot hummus with seeded crackers on the side.

**Tips:** Garnish hummus with fresh herbs like coriander or parsley for added freshness.

**Serving size:** About a quarter of prepared hummus with four crackers

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 220; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 28g; Protein: 8g; Sodium: 100mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 1mg; Fibre: 7g

## **127. Cottage Cheese and Herb Spread on Breadsticks**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 200g cottage cheese
- 2 tbsp fresh chives, chopped
- 2 tbsp fresh parsley, chopped
- 5ml lemon juice
- Salt and pepper, to taste
- 4 whole-grain breadsticks

**Directions:**

1. In a bowl, combine the cottage cheese, chopped chives, chopped parsley, and lemon juice. Mix well.
2. Season with salt and pepper to taste. Spread the mixture evenly on each breadstick. Serve immediately.

**Tips:** Use low-fat cottage cheese for a healthier option.

**Serving size:** 1 breadstick with spread

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 80; Fat: 2g; Carbs: 8g; Protein: 7g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 1g; Cholesterol: 5mg; Fibre: 1g



## **128. Eggplant Baba Ganoush with Pita Crisps**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 25 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 600g eggplant
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 garlic clove, minced
- Juice of one lemon
- Salt and pepper, to taste
- Whole-wheat pita bread (2 rounds)

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat the oven to 200°C. Prick the eggplant all over with a fork and place it on a baking sheet. Bake for about 25 minutes or until the skin is wrinkled and the inside is soft.
2. Let the eggplant cool slightly before peeling and mashing it in a bowl. Stir in olive oil, garlic, lemon juice, salt, and pepper until well combined.
3. Slice pita rounds into triangles and bake for about 5 minutes or until crisp. Serve baba ganoush with pita crisps.

**Tips:** Stir in some chopped coriander for extra flavour.

**Serving size:** About half a cup of baba ganoush with pita crisps

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 130; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 18g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 120mg; Sugar: <1g; Cholesterol: <1mg; Fibre: 4g

## **129. Greek Olive Tapenade on Rice Cakes**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 150g mixed olives, pitted
- 50g sun-dried tomatoes in oil
- 1 tbsp capers
- 1 clove garlic
- 15ml olive oil
- 100g rice cakes

**Directions:**

1. In a food processor, combine olives, sun-dried tomatoes, capers, and garlic. Pulse until finely chopped.
2. Add olive oil and process until combined but still slightly chunky. Spread tapenade evenly over rice cakes before serving.

**Tips:** For added flavour, top with fresh parsley or basil leaves.

**Serving size:** 2 rice cakes

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 155; Fat: 13g; Carbs: 9g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 450mg; Sugar: 0.5g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 3g

### **130. Basil Pesto Yoghurt Dip with Carrot Chips**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 100g fresh basil leaves
- 30g pine nuts
- 1 clove garlic
- 40ml olive oil
- 150ml plain Greek yoghurt (low-fat)
- Salt to taste
- 400g carrot sticks

**Directions:**

1. In a blender, combine basil leaves, pine nuts, and garlic until finely chopped. Gradually add olive oil and blend until smooth pesto forms.
2. Mix the pesto with Greek yoghurt in a bowl until well combined. Season with salt to taste. Serve the dip with carrot sticks for dipping.

**Tips:** For variation, substitute pine nuts with walnuts for a nutty flavour.

**Serving size:** 100g dip with carrot sticks

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 175; Fat: 14g; Carbs: 8g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 40mg; Sugar: 5g; Cholesterol: 5mg; Fibre: 3g

## **CHAPTER 9**

### **Dessert Recipes**

# Low-Sugar Cakes and Muffins

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## 131. Almond and Lemon Drizzle Cake

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 25 minutes

**Servings:** 8

### Ingredients:

- 100g ground almonds
- 50g self-raising flour
- 3 large eggs
- 75g granulated sweetener
- Zest of 2 lemons
- 75ml sunflower oil
- Juice of 1 lemon

### Directions:

1. Preheat the oven to 180°C and line a cake tin with baking paper. In a bowl, mix the ground almonds, flour, sweetener, and lemon zest.
2. Beat in the eggs and sunflower oil until combined. Pour the mixture into the prepared tin and bake for 25 minutes or until golden.
3. While cooling, drizzle with lemon juice for added flavour.

**Tips:** Substitute lemon with lime for a different taste variation.

**Serving size:** One slice (1/8th of cake)

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 190 kcal; Fat: 13g; Carbs: 6g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 12mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 2g

## **132. Carrot and Walnut Muffins**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 6

### **Ingredients:**

- 150g grated carrots
- 100g self-raising wholemeal flour
- 50g chopped walnuts
- 2 large eggs
- 50ml rapeseed oil
- 70g granulated sweetener
- 3 tbsp skimmed milk

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat the oven to 180°C and line a muffin tin with paper cases. In a bowl, mix grated carrots, flour, walnuts, and sweetener together.
2. In another bowl, beat eggs with rapeseed oil and milk. Fold the wet mixture into the dry ingredients until just combined.
3. Spoon into muffin cases and bake for about 20 minutes until a skewer comes out clean.

**Tips:** Use pecans if walnuts are unavailable in your pantry.

**Serving size:** One muffin

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 150; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 12g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 85mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 2g

### 133. Raspberry and Oat Muffins

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 8

**Ingredients:**

- 150g rolled oats
- 100g wholemeal flour
- 1 tsp baking powder
- 100g raspberries
- 50g brown sugar
- 2 eggs
- 150ml skimmed milk
- 50ml rapeseed oil

**Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 180°C. Line a muffin tray with paper cases. In a bowl, mix the oats, flour, and baking powder.
2. In another bowl, beat together the eggs, milk, oil, and sugar. Combine the wet and dry ingredients and fold in the raspberries gently.
3. Spoon the mixture into muffin cases. Bake for about 20 minutes until golden and an inserted skewer comes out clean.

**Tips:** Substitute raspberries with blueberries or chopped strawberries for variation. Serve warm or at room temperature.

**Serving size:** 1 muffin

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 150; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 18g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 30mg; Sugar: 7g; Cholesterol: 35mg; Fibre: 3g

### 134. Zesty Orange Polenta Cake

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 30 minutes

**Servings:** 8

**Ingredients:**

- 150g polenta
- 50g ground almonds
- Zest of two oranges
- Juice of one orange
- 100ml unsweetened apple juice
- 75g granulated sweetener
- 3 eggs

**Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 180°C. Grease a round cake tin. In a bowl, mix polenta, ground almonds, and orange zest.
2. In another large bowl, whisk together eggs, sweetener, orange juice, and apple juice until combined.
3. Gradually add the dry mixture into the wet mixture and stir until smooth. Pour into the cake tin and bake for about 30 minutes until firm to touch and golden.

**Tips:** Dust with a little icing sugar before serving if desired. Use lemon zest for a citrus twist.

**Serving size:** One slice

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 170; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 24g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 25mg; Sugar: 4g; Cholesterol: 50mg; Fibre: 2g



### 135. Sugar-Free Banana Bread

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 55 minutes

**Servings:** 8

**Ingredients:**

- 300g ripe bananas, mashed
- 75g plain whole wheat flour
- 75g almond flour
- 2 eggs
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 50ml skimmed milk
- A pinch of salt

**Directions:**

1. Preheat the oven to 180°C. Line a loaf tin with parchment paper. In a bowl, combine mashed bananas, eggs, vanilla, and milk. Mix until smooth.
2. In another bowl, mix whole wheat flour, almond flour, baking powder, and salt. Combine it with banana mixture until blended.
3. Pour the batter into the prepared loaf tin and smooth the top. Bake for about 55 minutes or until a toothpick inserted into the centre comes out clean.
4. Let it cool in the tin for a few minutes before transferring it to a wire rack to cool completely.

**Tips:** Replace almond flour with ground oats for an alternative texture and flavour adjustment.

**Serving size:** 1 slice

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 120; Fat: 5g; Carbs: 18g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 40mg; Sugar: 5g; Cholesterol: 45mg; Fibre: 3g

### 136. Spiced Apple and Cinnamon Cake

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 50 minutes

**Servings:** 8

**Ingredients:**

- 200g apples, peeled and grated
- 100g whole wheat flour
- 50g almond flour
- 2 eggs
- 100ml unsweetened apple juice
- 2 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1 tsp baking powder
- A pinch of salt

**Directions:**

1. Preheat the oven to 180°C (350°F). Grease and line a round cake tin with parchment paper. In a bowl, whisk eggs and apple juice until frothy.
2. In another bowl, mix whole wheat flour, almond flour, baking powder, cinnamon, and salt. Combine wet and dry ingredients lightly before folding in grated apples.
3. Pour the mixture into the prepared cake tin. Bake for about 50 minutes or until a skewer inserted comes out clean.
4. Allow the cake to cool in the tin for several minutes before transferring it to a cooling rack.

**Tips:** Serve with a dollop of sugar-free Greek yogurt for added richness.

**Serving size:** One eighth of cake

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 140; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 20g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 50mg; Sugar: 9g; Cholesterol: 45mg; Fibre: 3g

### 137. Blueberry and Yogurt Muffins

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 12 muffins

**Ingredients:**

- 300g wholemeal flour
- 250ml low-fat plain yogurt
- 150g fresh blueberries
- 2 large eggs
- 100ml skimmed milk
- 75g granulated sweetener (sucralose)
- 1 tbsp baking powder

**Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 180°C. In a large bowl, mix together the flour and baking powder.
2. In a separate bowl, whisk the yogurt, eggs, milk, and granulated sweetener until well combined. Combine it with flour mixture until blended. Gently fold in the blueberries.
3. Spoon the batter evenly into a muffin tray lined with paper cases. Bake for 20 minutes until golden brown and a skewer inserted comes out clean. Allow to cool on a wire rack.

**Tips:** Serve warm or cold; perfect with a cup of tea.

**Serving size:** 1 muffin

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 89; Fat: 2g; Carbs: 16g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 119mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 32mg; Fibre: 3g

### **138. Coconut and Lime Cupcakes**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 10 cupcakes

**Ingredients:**

- 200g self-raising flour
- Zest of one lime
- 50ml lime juice
- 100ml coconut milk (light)
- 75g grated unsweetened coconut
- 2 large eggs
- 50ml vegetable oil
- 100g granulated sweetener (sucralose)

**Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 180°C. Combine flour and grated coconut in a bowl.
2. In another bowl, beat together eggs, lime zest, lime juice, coconut milk, vegetable oil, and granulated sweetener. Combine it with flour mixture until blended.
3. Evenly distribute the batter into cupcake cases in a tin. Bake for 20 minutes or until lightly golden and set in the middle. Cool on a wire rack before serving.

**Tips:** Garnish with thin slices of lime if desired.

**Serving size:** 1 cupcake

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 120; Fat: 5g; Carbs: 16g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 77mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 30mg; Fibre: 2g

### 139. Vanilla Chia Seed Cake

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 25 minutes

**Servings:** 8

**Ingredients:**

- 200g whole wheat flour
- 2 tbsp chia seeds
- 1 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp baking soda
- 200ml unsweetened almond milk
- 75g granulated erythritol
- 60ml vegetable oil
- 5ml vanilla extract

**Directions:**

1. Preheat the oven to 180°C and line a cake tin with baking paper. In a large bowl, mix together flour, chia seeds, baking powder, and baking soda.
2. In another bowl, whisk together almond milk, erythritol, vegetable oil, and vanilla extract. Combine it with flour mixture until blended.
3. Pour the batter into the prepared tin and smooth the top. Bake for 25 minutes or until a skewer inserted into the centre comes out clean. Allow to cool before removing from the tin.

**Tips:** Opt for unsweetened almond milk to keep sugar levels in check.

**Serving size:** One slice

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 150; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 18g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 50mg; Sugar: <1g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 4g

## **140.     Ginger and Pear Muffins**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 12

### **Ingredients:**

- 250g whole wheat flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 50g crystallized ginger, finely chopped
- 100ml plain yoghurt
- 2 medium pears, peeled and diced
- 75g granulated stevia
- Zest of one lemon

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 180°C and line a muffin tin with paper cases. In a large bowl, combine whole wheat flour and baking powder.
2. Stir in ginger, yoghurt, pears, stevia, and lemon zest until just mixed. Spoon mixture evenly into muffin cases.
3. Bake for 20 minutes or until golden brown. Cool on a wire rack before serving.

**Tips:** Use ripe pears for natural sweetness.

**Serving size:** One muffin

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 130; Fat: 3g; Carbs: 23g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 30mg; Sugar: 1g; Cholesterol: 1mg; Fibre: 3g

# Indulgent yet Healthy Chocolate Treats

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## 141. Dark Chocolate Avocado Mousse

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 2 ripe avocados (320g), peeled & pitted
- 60g unsweetened cocoa powder
- 80ml unsweetened almond milk
- 2 tbsp erythritol or other sugar substitute
- 5ml vanilla extract
- A pinch of sea salt

**Directions:**

1. Place all the ingredients into a blender or food processor. Blend until smooth and creamy, scraping down the sides as needed.
2. Taste and adjust sweetener if necessary. Spoon the mousse into serving dishes and chill for at least 30 minutes before serving.

**Tips:** Make sure the avocados are ripe for a smooth texture. You can add a dash of cinnamon for additional flavour.

**Serving size:** 100g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 120; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 8g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 20mg; Sugar: 1g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 5g

## 142. Sugar-Free Chocolate Brownies

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 25 minutes

**Servings:** 16 brownies

### Ingredients:

- 200g almond flour
- 100g unsweetened cocoa powder
- 150g erythritol or other sugar substitute
- 100ml unsweetened almond milk
- 3 large eggs (150g)
- 5ml vanilla extract
- A pinch of salt
- 50g walnuts, chopped (optional)

### Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 180°C. Grease and line an 8x8 inch baking tin. In a large bowl, mix together almond flour, cocoa powder, erythritol, and salt.
2. In another bowl, whisk together eggs, almond milk, and vanilla. Combine it with flour mixture until blended. Fold in walnuts if using.
3. Pour the batter into the prepared baking tin and spread evenly. Bake for about 25 minutes or until a toothpick comes out clean. Let cool completely before cutting into squares.

**Tips:** Store brownies in an airtight container for up to three days for maximum freshness.

**Serving size:** 1 brownie

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 130; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 12g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 25mg; Sugar: <1g; Cholesterol: 1mg; Fibre: 4g



### **143. Cocoa and Almond Butter Fudge**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes + chilling time

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 12 fudge squares

**Ingredients:**

- 150g almond butter
- 50g unsweetened cocoa powder
- 60ml unsweetened almond milk
- 2 tbsp stevia or another sugar substitute
- Pinch of sea salt

**Directions:**

1. In a bowl, mix the almond butter, cocoa powder, almond milk, stevia, and sea salt until smooth and well combined.
2. Line a small tray or rectangular dish with baking paper, and pour the mixture in, smoothing it out evenly.
3. Put the tray in the fridge to chill for at least an hour until set. Once firm, cut into 12 pieces and serve.

**Tips:** You can substitute almond butter with peanut or cashew butter for varied flavours.

**Serving size:** 1 piece

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 90; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 5g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 15mg; Sugar: <1g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 2g

## **144. Black Bean Chocolate Cake**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 40 minutes

**Servings:** 10

### **Ingredients:**

- 400g canned black beans, drained and rinsed
- 3 large eggs
- 3 tbsp unsweetened cocoa powder
- 100g oats (gluten-free if necessary)
- 100ml unsweetened almond milk
- Stevia to taste
- Pinch of baking soda

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat the oven to 180°C. Blend the black beans, eggs, cocoa powder, oats, almond milk, stevia, and baking soda in a food processor until smooth.
2. Pour the mixture into a greased cake tin. Bake for about 40 minutes or until a toothpick inserted into the centre comes out clean. Allow it to cool before serving.

**Tips:** Add some chopped nuts on top before baking for added crunch.

**Serving size:** One slice

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 120; Fat: 4g; Carbs: 15g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 110mg; Sugar: <1g; Cholesterol: 5mg; Fibre: 4g

## 145. Dark Chocolate Chia Pudding

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes + chilling time

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 500ml unsweetened almond milk
- 50g chia seeds
- 30g dark chocolate (70% cocoa), melted
- 1 tbsp unsweetened cocoa powder
- 5ml vanilla extract
- 30g stevia or erythritol sweetener

**Directions:**

1. In a medium bowl, whisk together the almond milk, chocolate, cocoa powder, vanilla, and sweetener until well combined. Stir in the chia seeds until evenly distributed.
2. Cover the bowl and refrigerate for at least 2 hours or overnight for a thicker consistency. Before serving, stir the pudding to ensure even texture.

**Tips:** Top with fresh berries or a sprinkle of nuts for added texture and flavour.

**Serving size:** 125ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 120; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 12g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 30mg; Sugar: 1g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 6g

## 146. Pistachio Chocolate Bark

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 15 minutes

**Servings:** 8

### **Ingredients:**

- 200g dark chocolate (70% cocoa)
- 50g unsalted pistachios, roughly chopped
- A pinch of sea salt

### **Directions:**

1. Melt the dark chocolate in a heatproof bowl over a pan of simmering water, stirring occasionally until smooth. Alternatively, melt in short bursts in the microwave.
2. Pour the melted chocolate onto the prepared tray and spread evenly with a spatula to your desired thickness.
3. Immediately sprinkle chopped pistachios over the top while the chocolate is still warm and soft; lightly press them down into the chocolate. Add a pinch of sea salt if desired.
4. Allow the chocolate to cool at room temperature or refrigerate until set. Once set, break into pieces and serve.

**Tips:** Store in an airtight container in the fridge to maintain freshness.

**Serving size:** 2 small pieces

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 150; Fat: 11g; Carbs: 12g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 10mg; Sugar: 5g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 4g

## 147. Baked Chocolate Custard Pots

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### Ingredients:

- 500ml skimmed milk
- 2 large eggs
- 40g cocoa powder, unsweetened
- 50g granulated stevia or alternative sweetener
- 5ml vanilla extract

### Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 160°C. In a saucepan, gently heat the milk until warm but not boiling.
2. In a bowl, whisk together the eggs, cocoa powder, sweetener, and vanilla until smooth.
3. Gradually add the warm milk to the cocoa mixture while stirring continuously.
4. Divide the mixture between four ramekins and place them in a baking dish. Fill the dish with hot water halfway up the sides of the ramekins.
5. Bake for about 20 minutes or until set but still slightly wobbly in the centre. Remove from oven and let cool before serving.

**Tips:** Serve chilled or at room temperature with a sprinkle of grated dark chocolate on top for extra flavour.

**Serving size:** 1 custard pot

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 90; Fat: 3g; Carbs: 10g; Protein: 7g; Sodium: 70mg; Sugar: 4g; Cholesterol: 85mg; Fibre: 2g

## 148. Hazelnut Cocoa Truffles

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes + chilling time

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 12 truffles

**Ingredients:**

- 100g ground hazelnuts
- 60g cocoa powder, unsweetened
- 80g granulated stevia or alternative sweetener
- 50ml skimmed milk
- A pinch of salt

**Directions:**

1. In a bowl, mix together the ground hazelnuts and cocoa powder. Add the sweetener and salt, mixing well to combine evenly.
2. Gradually add skimmed milk while stirring until you form a dough-like consistency that can be easily rolled into balls.
3. Form small balls with your hands, rolling each one smoothly.
4. Place truffles on a tray lined with parchment paper and chill in the refrigerator for at least 30 minutes before serving.

**Tips:** Roll truffles in additional cocoa powder or crushed nuts for an extra layer of texture.

**Serving size:** 2 truffles

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 75; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 6g; Protein: 1g; Sodium: 10mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 1mg; Fibre: 1g

## 149. Sugar-Free Chocolate Lava Cakes

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 15 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 100g sugar-free dark chocolate
- 50g unsalted butter
- 2 large eggs
- 5ml vanilla extract
- 60g almond flour
- A pinch of salt

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 180°C. Grease four ramekins with a little butter.
2. Melt the chocolate and butter together in a heatproof bowl over a saucepan of simmering water, stirring occasionally, until smooth. Remove and set aside to cool slightly.
3. In a separate bowl, whisk the eggs and vanilla extract until slightly frothy. Gently fold the almond flour and salt, followed by the chocolate mixture, until well combined.
4. Divide the mixture evenly between the prepared ramekins and place them on a baking tray. Bake for 12-15 minutes, or until the edges are firm but the centre remains soft.
5. Allow to cool for a couple of minutes before serving warm.

**Tips:** Serve with a dollop of Greek yoghurt or fresh berries for added flavour and nutrition.

**Serving size:** 1 lava cake

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 270; Fat: 20g; Carbs: 10g; Protein: 7g; Sodium: 50mg; Sugar: 1g; Cholesterol: 80mg; Fibre: 3g

## **150. Coconut Milk Hot Chocolate**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 5 minutes

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 400ml coconut milk
- 30g sugar-free cocoa powder
- 5ml vanilla extract
- A pinch of cinnamon (optional)

**Directions:**

1. In a small saucepan, combine coconut milk and cocoa powder over medium heat, whisking until well blended.
2. Heat gently until steam begins to rise from the surface, taking care not to let it boil.
3. Remove and stir in vanilla and cinnamon (if using). Pour into mugs and enjoy warm.

**Tips:** For an extra creamy texture, blend with an immersion blender before serving.

**Serving size:** 1 mug

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 180; Fat: 18g; Carbs: 7g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 25mg; Sugar: <1g; Cholesterol: 1mg; Fibre: 2g



# Fruit-Based Desserts to End Your Meal on a Sweet Note

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## 151. Baked Cinnamon Apples with Nuts

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 30 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### Ingredients:

- 4 large apples (approximately 800g)
- 1 tsp ground cinnamon
- 50g walnuts, chopped
- 50g unsalted almonds, chopped
- 30ml water

### Directions:

1. Preheat the oven to 180°C. Core the apples and cut them into thick slices, then place them in a baking dish.
2. Sprinkle the cinnamon over the apple slices. Add the walnuts and almonds on top of the apples. Pour the water into the baking dish to prevent sticking.
3. Cover the dish with foil and bake for 25-30 minutes or until the apples are tender.

**Tips:** You can use different types of nuts like pecans or hazelnuts for a varied flavour.

**Serving size:** 200g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 180; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 24g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 2mg; Sugar: 13g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 5g

## 152. Strawberry Rhubarb Crumble

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 30 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 300g strawberries, hulled and quartered
- 200g rhubarb, chopped
- 2 tbsp granulated sweetener suitable for baking (such as stevia)
- 100g whole oat flour
- 50g unsalted butter, softened
- 25g rolled oats

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 180°C. In a bowl, mix the strawberries, rhubarb, and sweetener, then transfer to a baking dish.
2. In another bowl, rub together oat flour and butter until it resembles coarse crumbs, then stir in rolled oats.
3. Sprinkle the crumble topping evenly over the fruit mixture. Bake for 30 minutes or until golden brown on top.

**Tips:** Serve warm or cold as desired, and consider adding a dollop of plain Greek yoghurt if desired.

**Serving size:** 1/4 of the dish

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 150; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 21g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 5mg; Sugar: 8g; Cholesterol: <1mg; Fibre: 4g

### 153. Fresh Berry Fool with Greek Yogurt

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 300g mixed fresh berries (such as raspberries, strawberries, and blueberries)
- 20g granulated sweetener
- 500g Greek yogurt (low-fat)
- 5ml vanilla extract

**Directions:**

1. Rinse the berries thoroughly and pat them dry with a clean kitchen towel. Reserve a few for garnishing.
2. Place the rest of the berries in a bowl and sprinkle with the granulated sweetener. Mash lightly with a fork to release some of the juices, but leave some whole for texture.
3. In a separate bowl, mix the Greek yogurt with the vanilla until well combined. Gently fold the berry mixture into the yogurt, creating a swirl effect without overmixing.
4. Divide the mixture equally among four serving glasses or bowls. Garnish with the reserved berries on top.

**Tips:** For added flavour, you can sprinkle some lemon zest over the top before serving. Try to use seasonal berries for maximum flavour and nutritional value.

**Serving size:** 1 bowl/glass

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 140; Fat: 4g; Carbs: 18g; Protein: 10g; Sodium: 50mg; Sugar: 12g; Cholesterol: 5mg; Fibre: 4g

## 154. Roasted Peach Parfait

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 15 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

400g fresh peaches, halved and pitted

- 200ml Greek yoghurt
- 30g almonds, chopped
- 1 tsp cinnamon

**Directions:**

1. Preheat the oven to 200°C. Arrange the peach halves on a baking sheet and sprinkle with cinnamon.
2. Roast the peaches in the oven for about 15 minutes or until tender and caramelised.
3. Allow the peaches to cool slightly, then slice them into smaller pieces.
4. Layer the Greek yoghurt and roasted peaches in serving glasses, topped with chopped almonds.

**Tips:** For added flavour, drizzle a small amount of honey over each parfait before serving.

**Serving size:** 1 glass

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 150; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 16g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 25mg; Sugar: 13g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 3g

## 155. Warm Berry Compote

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 10 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 500g mixed berries (such as strawberries, raspberries, and blueberries)
- 50ml water
- Zest of half a lemon
- 2 tbsp chia seeds

**Directions:**

1. In a medium saucepan, combine the mixed berries and water over a medium heat.
2. Stir and cook for 5 minutes until the berries begin to break down. Add the lemon zest and chia seeds, stirring well to combine.
3. Continue to cook for another few minutes until the mixture thickens slightly.

**Tips:** Serve warm over Greek yoghurt or sugar-free ice cream for a delicious dessert option.

**Serving size:** 125g compote

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 60; Fat: 1g; Carbs: 14g; Protein: 1g; Sodium: 10mg; Sugar: 9g; Cholesterol: 1mg; Fibre: 4g

## 156. Citrus Fruit Salad with Mint

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 2 oranges, peeled and segmented
- 1 grapefruit, peeled and segmented

- 200g watermelon, cubed
- A handful of fresh mint leaves, finely chopped
- Juice of half a lemon

**Directions:**

1. In a large bowl, combine orange segments, grapefruit segments, watermelon cubes, and mint leaves.
2. Drizzle lemon juice over the fruit salad and toss gently to combine.
3. Serve immediately as a refreshing side or dessert.

**Tips:** For extra zest, grate some lemon or orange zest into the salad before serving.

**Serving size:** 1 small bowl

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 60; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 15g; Protein: 1g; Sodium: 2mg; Sugar: 13g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 3g

## 157. Grilled Pineapple Skewers

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 10 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 1 pineapple, peeled and cut into chunks (about 500g)
- 2 tbsp lime juice (about 30ml)
- 1 tbsp honey (optional, about 15ml)
- 1 tsp ground cinnamon

**Directions:**

1. In a large bowl, combine lime juice, honey (if using), and ground cinnamon. Add pineapple chunks and toss to coat.
2. Thread pineapple chunks onto skewers, leaving a little space between each piece for even cooking.

3. Preheat grill to medium-high heat. Cook the skewers on the grill for about 3-4 minutes per side until caramelised and lightly charred. Serve immediately.

**Tips:** Serve with a sprinkle of fresh mint for added flavour.

**Serving size:** 125g of pineapple per skewer

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 70; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 18g; Protein: 1g; Sodium: 1mg; Sugar: 14g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 2g

## **158. Sugar-free Mango Sorbet**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes + freezing time

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 3 ripe mangoes, peeled and diced (about 600g)
- Juice of 1 lime
- A pinch of salt

**Directions:**

1. Place the mango pieces on a baking tray lined with parchment paper and freeze for at least 5 hours or until completely frozen.
2. Once frozen, transfer mango pieces to a food processor. Add lime juice and a pinch of salt, then blend until smooth and creamy.
3. Serve immediately for a soft consistency or freeze for an additional hour for a firmer texture.

**Tips:** For easier blending, allow mango pieces to thaw slightly before processing if your food processor struggles with entirely frozen fruit.

**Serving size:** 150ml scoop

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 100; Fat: 0.5g; Carbs: 25g; Protein: 0.5g; Sodium: 10mg; Sugar: 23g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 2g

## **159. Stewed Plums in Red Wine Sauce**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 500g plums, halved and pitted
- 200ml red wine
- 50g sugar substitute
- 1 cinnamon stick

### **Directions:**

1. In a saucepan, combine the red wine and sugar substitute. Let it simmer over medium heat.
2. Add the cinnamon stick and plums, then simmer gently for about 20 minutes, or until the plums are tender. Remove and let cool slightly before serving.

**Tips:** Use a sugar substitute suitable for cooking to keep sugar levels low.

**Serving size:** 125g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 85; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 19g; Protein: 1g; Sodium: 2mg; Sugar: 15g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 2g

## **160. Poached Pears with Vanilla Cream**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 30 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 4 ripe pears, peeled but stems intact
- 500ml water
- 50g sugar substitute



- 1 vanilla pod, split lengthways
- 150ml low-fat cream

**Directions:**

1. In a large saucepan, combine the water, sugar substitute, and vanilla pod. Let it simmer.
2. Add pears to the saucepan and poach for about 30 minutes, turning occasionally until soft.
3. Remove pears and vanilla pod from the liquid, allowing pears to cool.
4. Serve pears drizzled with any remaining poaching liquid and topped with chilled low-fat cream.

**Tips:** Ensure the pears are not overripe to hold their shape while poaching. For extra flavour, infuse the cream with some vanilla seeds scraped from the pod.

**Serving size:** One pear with sauce

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 110; Fat: 3g; Carbs: 22g; Protein: 1g; Sodium: 10mg; Sugar: 16g; Cholesterol: 10mg; Fibre: 4g

## **CHAPTER 10**

# **Hydrating Drinks**

# Infused Waters

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## 161. Cucumber and Mint Infused Water

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 500ml water
- 100g cucumber, thinly sliced
- 5g fresh mint leaves

**Directions:**

1. In a large jug, combine the water, cucumber slices and mint leaves.
2. Stir the ingredients together gently to ensure the flavours mix well.
3. Let it chill in the refrigerator for at least an hour before serving.

**Tips:** For a stronger flavour, allow the water to infuse overnight. Use cold sparkling water for a refreshing twist.

**Serving size:** 125ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 1; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 0g; Protein: 0g; Sodium: 0mg; Sugar: 0g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 0g

## 162. Lemon and Basil Infused Water

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 500ml water
- 25ml lemon juice
- Thin slices of half a lemon (approx. 50g)
- 5g fresh basil leaves

**Directions:**

1. In a large jug, pour in the water and lemon juice. Add freshly sliced lemon and basil leaves to the jug.
2. Mix well and let it chill in the refrigerator for at least an hour before serving.

**Tips:** Squeeze some extra lemon juice for added zest. Avoid squeezing basil leaves too harshly to prevent bitterness.

**Serving size:** 125ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 2; Fat: 0g; Carbs: <1g; Protein: <1g; Sodium: 1mg; Sugar: <1g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 1g

## 163. Strawberry and Lime Infused Water

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 100g strawberries, sliced
- 1 lime, thinly sliced
- 2L cold water
- Ice cubes

**Directions:**

1. Place the strawberry slices and lime slices into a jug. Fill the jug with 2 litres of cold water.
2. Add ice cubes as desired to keep the drink chilled. Stir well, then let it infuse for about 10 minutes before serving.

**Tips:** For a stronger flavour, prepare ahead and leave in the fridge for an hour before serving.

**Serving size:** 500ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 5; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 1g; Protein: 0g; Sodium: 3mg; Sugar: <1g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 1g

## **164. Orange and Blueberry Infused Water**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 1 orange, sliced
- 100g blueberries
- 2L cold water
- Ice cubes

**Directions:**

1. Add orange slices and blueberries to a large jug. Pour in the cold water to fill the jug.
2. Mix gently and add ice cubes to keep it cool. Allow it to infuse for approximately 10 minutes before serving.

**Tips:** Gently press the blueberries with a spoon for more flavour.

**Serving size:** 500ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 10; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 2g; Protein: <1g; Sodium: 3mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: <1g

## **165. Apple and Cinnamon Stick Infused Water**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 1 medium apple (approximately 100g), thinly sliced
- 2 cinnamon sticks
- 1L cold water

**Directions:**

1. Add the apple slices and cinnamon sticks to a large jug. Pour the cold water into the jug, ensuring the ingredients are fully submerged.
2. Let it sit for about 30 minutes to an hour at room temperature or refrigerate for a more chilled version. Stir before serving.

**Tips:** Choose a crisp, sweet apple like Gala or Pink Lady for added natural sweetness. For more flavour, prepare ahead of time and let it infuse in the fridge overnight.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 5; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 1g; Protein: 0g; Sodium: 0mg; Sugar: 1g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 0.5g

## **166. Raspberry and Lemon Balm Infused Water**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 100g fresh raspberries
- A handful of fresh lemon balm leaves (about 10g)
- 1 litre cold water

**Directions:**

1. Gently wash the raspberries and lemon balm leaves. Add them to a large jug, making sure they're evenly distributed.

2. Pour in the cold water, ensuring all ingredients are covered. Allow the infusion to sit for about half an hour at room temperature or chill in the fridge if desired.

**Tips:** Lightly crushing the raspberries can enhance their flavour in the water.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 10; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 2g; Protein: 0g; Sodium: 1mg; Sugar: 1g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 0.8g

## **167. Grapefruit and Rosemary Infused Water**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 1 grapefruit (about 200g), thinly sliced
- 2 sprigs of fresh rosemary
- 1 litre cold water

**Directions:**

1. In a large jug, add the grapefruit slices. Gently bruise the rosemary sprigs and add them to the jug.
2. Pour in the cold water and stir lightly to mix. Refrigerate for at least 30 minutes to let flavours infuse. Serve cold.

**Tips:** For a stronger infusion, allow the water to sit for up to 2 hours in the fridge before serving.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 10; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 2g; Protein: 0g; Sodium: 0mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 0g

## **168. Kiwi and Mint Infused Water**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 2 kiwis (about 150g), peeled and sliced
- A handful of fresh mint leaves
- 1 litre cold water

**Directions:**

1. Place the kiwi slices in a large jug. Tear the mint leaves slightly to release their flavour, then add to the jug.
2. Pour in the cold water and stir gently to combine ingredients. Allow it to chill in the refrigerator for at least an hour before serving cold.

**Tips:** You can lightly mash some of the kiwi slices for a more intense flavour.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 12; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 3g; Protein: 0g; Sodium: 0mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: <1g

## **169. Pineapple and Ginger Infused Water**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 200g fresh pineapple chunks
- 1 small piece (about 20g) fresh ginger, peeled and sliced thinly
- 1 litre filtered water



**Directions:**

1. Place the pineapple chunks and ginger slices into a large jug or pitcher. Pour over the filtered water.
2. Let it infuse in the fridge for at least 1 hour before serving, allowing flavours to develop.

**Tips:** For a stronger flavour, prepare the day before and let it infuse overnight.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 5; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 1g; Protein: 0g; Sodium: 2mg; Sugar: 1g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 0g

## **170. Watermelon and Basil Infused Water**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 300g watermelon, cubed and deseeded
- A handful of fresh basil leaves (about 10 leaves)
- 1L filtered water

**Directions:**

1. Place the watermelon cubes and basil leaves in a large jug or pitcher. Pour over the filtered water.
2. Allow to infuse in the fridge for at least an hour before serving.

**Tips:** Smash the basil leaves slightly with your fingers to release more flavour.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 6; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 1.5g; Protein: 0g; Sodium: 1mg; Sugar: 1g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 0g

# Herbal Teas

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## 171. Ginger and Turmeric Herbal Tea

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 10 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 500ml water
- 10g fresh ginger, sliced
- 5g ground turmeric
- 15ml lemon juice
- 5ml honey (optional)
- 1 lemon slice for garnish

**Directions:**

1. In a small saucepan, let the water boil. Add the ginger slices and ground turmeric. Let it simmer for about 10 minutes.
2. Remove and strain the tea into a teapot or cups. Stir in the lemon juice and honey if using. Serve hot, garnished with a lemon slice.

**Tips:** Use fresh turmeric if available; grate a small piece instead of using ground turmeric.

**Serving size:** 125ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 9; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 2g; Protein: 0g; Sodium: 1mg; Sugar: 1g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 0.5g

## **172. Chamomile and Lavender Herbal Tea**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 7 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 600ml water
- 12g dried chamomile flowers
- 8g dried lavender buds
- 5g lemon zest
- Honey to taste (optional)

**Directions:**

1. Boil the water in a kettle or saucepan. Combine chamomile flowers, lavender buds, and lemon zest in a teapot or infuser.
2. Pour boiling water over the mixture and cover for steeping. Allow it to steep for 5 to 7 minutes. Strain the tea into cups and add honey if desired.

**Tips:** Adjust the lavender amount according to your taste, as it can be quite strong.

**Serving size:** 150ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 2; Fat: 0 g; Carbs: 1g; Protein: 0.5g; Sodium: 1mg; Sugar: 0.5g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 0.5g

## **173. Peppermint and Liquorice Root Herbal Tea**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 15 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 10g dried peppermint leaves

- 5g liquorice root
- 800ml boiling water

**Directions:**

1. Place the peppermint leaves and liquorice root in a teapot or large heatproof jug.
2. Pour the boiling water over the herbs. Cover and let steep for about 15 minutes. Strain the tea into cups and serve warm.

**Tips:** Adjust the strength by adding more or less peppermint leaves according to your taste.

**Serving size:** 200ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 2; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 1g; Protein: 0g; Sodium: 0mg; Sugar: 0g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 0g

## 174. Hibiscus and Rosehip Herbal Tea

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 10 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 15g dried hibiscus flowers
- 10g dried rosehips
- 1 litre boiling water

**Directions:**

1. Combine the hibiscus flowers and dried rosehips in a teapot or large jug.
2. Pour over with boiling water, cover, and let steep for about 10 minutes. Strain the tea into mugs and enjoy hot or iced.

**Tips:** For a naturally sweet touch, add a slice of orange or lemon.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 4; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 1g; Protein: 1g; Sodium: 0mg; Sugar: 1g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 1g

## **175. Lemon Verbena and Fenugreek Herbal Tea**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 10 minutes

**Servings:** 2

### **Ingredients:**

- 5g lemon verbena leaves
- 5g fenugreek seeds
- 500ml water
- 1g stevia (optional)

### **Directions:**

1. In a saucepan, let the water boil. Add the lemon verbena leaves and fenugreek seeds to the boiling water.
2. Adjust to a simmer for 10 minutes. Strain the tea into cups and sweeten with stevia if desired.

**Tips:** For a stronger flavour, allow the tea to steep for an additional 5 minutes before straining. Serve hot or chilled for a refreshing alternative.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 3; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 0g; Protein: 0g; Sodium: 4mg; Sugar: 0g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 0g

## **176. Dandelion Root and Nettle Leaf Herbal Tea**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 15 minutes

**Servings:** 2

### **Ingredients:**

- 5g dandelion root, chop it coarsely
- 5g dried nettle leaves
- 500ml water
- Slice of lemon (optional)

### **Directions:**

1. In a pot, let the water boil, then add dandelion root and dried nettle leaves. Lower heat and let simmer for about 15 minutes.
2. Strain into tea cups and serve with a slice of lemon if preferred.

**Tips:** Nettle can be quite potent, use lesser initially if unfamiliar with its taste; feel free to add ginger or mint for variation.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 6; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 1g; Protein: 1g; Sodium: 1mg; Sugar: 1g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 1g

## **177. Rooibos and Vanilla Bean Herbal Tea**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 10 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 20g loose rooibos tea or 4 rooibos teabags
- 1 vanilla bean

- 1 litre water
- 5g fresh mint leaves (optional)

**Directions:**

1. Let the water boil in a saucepan. Add the rooibos tea and simmer for about 5 minutes.
2. Slice the vanilla bean lengthwise and scrape the seeds into the pot, then add the bean pod as well. Simmer for an additional 5 minutes.
3. Strain into cups and garnish with mint leaves if desired.

**Tips:** For a stronger flavour, let the tea steep longer before straining.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 0, Fat: 0g, Carbs: 0g, Protein: 0g, Sodium: 0mg, Sugar: 0g, Cholesterol: 0mg, Fibre: 0g

## **178. Sage and Echinacea Herbal Tea**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 10 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 15g dried sage leaves or teabags
- 10g dried echinacea flowers or teabags
- 1 litre water
- Lemon zest stripe (from half lemon)

**Directions:**

1. Boil water in a saucepan. Remove and add sage and echinacea. Let it steep covered for about 10 minutes.
2. Strain into mugs and garnish each with a strip of lemon zest before serving.

**Tips:** This tea can be enjoyed hot or cooled over ice in warmer months.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 1; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 0.2g; Protein: 0.1g; Sodium: 1mg; Sugar: 0.1g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 0.1g

## **179. Fennel Seed and Lemon Balm Herbal Tea**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 10 minutes

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 10g fennel seeds
- 5g dried lemon balm
- 500ml water

**Directions:**

1. In a saucepan, combine the fennel seeds and lemon balm with the water. Let it boil over medium heat.
2. Once boiling, reduce heat and simmer for 5 minutes. Remove and let steep for another 5 minutes. Strain the tea into mugs and enjoy warm.

**Tips:** For added flavour, consider adding a slice of fresh lemon before serving.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 8; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 2g; Protein: 0g; Sodium: 2mg; Sugar: 0g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 1g



## **180. Cinnamon Bark and Clove Herbal Tea**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 10 minutes

**Servings:** 2

**Ingredients:**

- 1 cinnamon stick
- 4 whole cloves
- 500ml water

**Directions:**

1. In a saucepan, add the cinnamon stick and cloves to the water. Let it boil over medium heat.
2. Once boiling, lower the heat and simmer for about 10 minutes to release the flavours.
3. Remove and let it steep for an additional few minutes if stronger flavour is desired. Strain into cups and serve warm.

**Tips:** For a touch of sweetness, consider adding a small amount of stevia or a cinnamon stick as garnish.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 9; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 3g; Protein: 0.5g; Sodium: 2mg; Sugar: 0.5g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 1g

## **CHAPTER 11**

### **Seasonal and Holiday Recipes**

# Seasonal Recipes

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## 181. Spring Asparagus and Pea Risotto

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 25 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 200g asparagus, trimmed and cut into 2cm pieces
- 150g frozen peas
- 15ml olive oil
- 1 onion, finely chopped
- 300g Arborio rice
- 1 litre vegetable stock
- 50g Parmesan cheese, grated

**Directions:**

1. Heat the olive oil in a large saucepan over medium heat. Add the onion and sauté until soft.
2. Stir in the Arborio rice and cook until it becomes slightly translucent around the edges.
3. Gradually add the vegetable stock, one ladle at a time, stirring constantly and allowing each addition to be absorbed before adding the next.
4. After about 15 minutes of cooking, add the asparagus to the risotto. Continue to cook for another 5 minutes.
5. Stir in the peas and continue cooking for 5 minutes until the rice is tender. Remove and stir in the Parmesan cheese until melted and creamy.

**Tips:** To increase flavour, add a squeeze of lemon juice just before serving.

**Serving size:** 200g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 350; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 56g; Protein: 11g; Sodium: 180mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 12mg; Fibre: 3g

## **182. Summer Berry and Spinach Salad**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 200g fresh spinach leaves
- 100g strawberries, sliced
- 100g blueberries
- 50g walnuts, chopped
- 100g feta cheese, crumbled
- 50ml lemon juice
- 15ml extra virgin olive oil

### **Directions:**

1. In a large salad bowl, combine spinach, strawberries, blueberries, walnuts, and feta cheese.
2. In a small bowl, whisk together lemon juice and olive oil to create a dressing.
3. Drizzle dressing over the salad and toss gently until evenly coated.

**Tips:** For added crunch, toast walnuts lightly before adding them to the salad.

**Serving size:** 1/4 of the total salad

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 220; Fat: 12g; Carbs: 18g; Protein: 8g; Sodium: 340mg; Sugar: 10g; Cholesterol: 18mg; Fibre: 4g

### **183. Autumn Root Vegetable Stew**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 30 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 500 g mixed root vegetables (carrots, parsnips, swede), peeled and cubed
- 15ml olive oil
- 1 onion, finely chopped
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 tsp dried thyme
- 500ml vegetable stock
- Salt and pepper to taste

**Directions:**

1. Heat the olive oil in a large saucepan over medium heat. Add the onion and garlic and sauté until soft.
2. Add the mixed root vegetables and thyme, stirring for about 5 minutes.
3. Pour in the vegetable stock, season with salt and pepper, and let it boil. Adjust to low heat, cover, and simmer for 30 minutes or until vegetables are tender.

**Tips:** Use low-sodium stock to further reduce sodium content.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 160; Fat: 4g; Carbs: 29g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 7g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 6g

## **184. Winter Spiced Carrot and Lentil Soup**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 25 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 400g carrots, peeled and sliced
- 15ml olive oil
- 1 onion, chopped
- 2 garlic cloves, crushed
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- 100g red lentils
- 800ml low-sodium vegetable stock
- Salt and pepper to taste

### **Directions:**

1. Heat the olive oil in a large pot over medium heat. Add the onion and garlic, cooking until soft.
2. Stir in the cumin followed by carrots for a few minutes. Add red lentils and stock. Let it boil, cover and simmer for 25 minutes or until carrots are tender.
3. Puree the soup with an immersion blender until smooth. Season with salt and pepper as needed.

**Tips:** For extra flavour, add a dash of smoked paprika.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 180; Fat: 5g; Carbs: 28g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 120mg; Sugar: 6g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 5g

## **185. Summer Herb Grilled Chicken with Courgettes**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 15 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 600g chicken breasts, boneless and skinless
- 2 courgettes, sliced
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 2 tbsp fresh thyme, chopped
- 1 tbsp lemon juice
- Salt and pepper to taste

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat the grill to medium-high heat. In a bowl, mix olive oil, thyme, lemon juice, salt, and pepper.
2. Coat the chicken breasts with the herb mixture. Grill the chicken for 6-7 minutes on each side or until thoroughly cooked.
3. Meanwhile, place courgette slices on the grill and cook for 3-4 minutes each side until tender. Serve the grilled chicken with courgettes on a platter.

**Tips:** Ensure the grill is properly preheated to avoid sticking; use a meat thermometer to ensure chicken is cooked (internal temperature should reach at least 75°C).

**Serving size:** 150g chicken & courgettes

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 310; Fat: 16g; Carbs: 5g; Protein: 35g; Sodium: 80mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 85mg; Fibre: 2g

## 186. Autumn Pumpkin and Sage Quiche

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 30 minutes

**Servings:** 6

### **Ingredients:**

- 500g pumpkin, peeled and cubed
- 6 whole eggs
- 200ml skimmed milk
- Handful of sage leaves, chopped
- Salt and pepper to taste
- Olive oil spray

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 180°C. Line a quiche tin with parchment paper and lightly spray with olive oil.
2. In a sauté pan over medium heat, cook the pumpkin pieces for about 10 minutes until tender using a little water if necessary to prevent sticking.
3. In a large bowl, whisk together eggs and milk, season with salt, pepper, then add in chopped sage.
4. Arrange cooked pumpkin cubes evenly in the prepared quiche tin. Pour egg mixture over the top evenly dispersing sage as necessary.
5. Bake for 30 minutes or until set in centre and slightly golden on top.

**Tips:** Serving warm will bring out the flavours more distinctly; pair with green salad for added freshness.

**Serving size:** 1 slice

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 180; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 11g; Protein: 12g; Sodium: 70mg; Sugar: 7g; Cholesterol: 130mg; Fibre: 3g



## **187. Winter Beetroot and Apple Slaw**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 300g beetroot, peeled and grated
- 150g apple, cored and grated
- 100g red cabbage, finely shredded
- 50ml low-fat natural yoghurt
- 15ml lemon juice
- Salt and pepper to taste

**Directions:**

1. In a large bowl, combine the beetroot, apple, and red cabbage.
2. In a separate small bowl, mix together the yoghurt and lemon juice. Season with salt and pepper.
3. Pour the dressing over the beetroot mixture and toss well to combine. Serve.

**Tips:** Use a mix of red and golden beetroots for added colour. For extra crunch, incorporate a tbsp of chopped walnuts.

**Serving size:** 150g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 62; Fat: 0.7g; Carbs: 12g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 54mg; Sugar: 8g; Cholesterol: 2mg; Fibre: 4g

## **188. Spring Green Vegetable Frittata**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 200g spring greens, shredded
- 6 large eggs
- 100ml semi-skimmed milk
- 50g feta cheese, crumbled
- Salt and pepper to taste
- Olive oil spray

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 180°C. Lightly spray an ovenproof frying pan with olive oil and set over medium heat. Add spring greens and cook for about 5 minutes until wilted.
2. In a bowl, whisk together eggs and milk, then season with salt and pepper. Pour egg mixture over the greens in the frying pan. Sprinkle with crumbled feta cheese.
3. Transfer frying pan to the oven and bake for 15 minutes until set. Serve.

**Tips:** Add some fresh herbs like chives or parsley for extra flavour.

**Serving size:** A quarter of the frittata

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 184; Fat: 11g; Carbs: 4g; Protein: 16g; Sodium: 240mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 112mg; Fibre: 1g

## **189. Summer Tomato and Basil Gazpacho**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 600g tomatoes, chopped
- 1 red pepper, deseeded and chopped
- 1 cucumber, peeled and chopped
- 1 small red onion, chopped
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 30ml extra virgin olive oil
- 30ml red wine vinegar
- A handful of fresh basil leaves
- Salt and black pepper to taste

### **Directions:**

1. Combine the tomatoes, red pepper, cucumber, red onion, and garlic in a blender. Add the olive oil and red wine vinegar.
2. Blend until smooth. Adjust the seasoning with salt and black pepper. Chill in the refrigerator for at least an hour. Serve cold with fresh basil leaves on top.

**Tips:** For a chunkier texture, reserve some chopped vegetables to stir into the blended soup before serving.

**Serving size:** 250ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 80; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 5g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 15mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 2g

## **190. Autumn Spiced Butternut Squash Soup**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 25 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 1kg butternut squash, peeled and cubed
- 1 large onion, chopped
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 750ml vegetable stock
- 5ml olive oil
- Half tsp ground cinnamon
- Half tsp ground nutmeg
- Salt and black pepper to taste

### **Directions:**

1. Heat olive oil in a large pot over medium heat. Add onion and garlic, then sauté until soft. Stir in the butternut squash cubes and cook for another couple of minutes.
2. Pour in the vegetable stock, then add cinnamon and nutmeg. Let it boil, then lower heat to simmer for about 20 minutes or until squash is tender.
3. Use a blender to puree the soup until smooth. Season with salt and pepper before serving.

**Tips:** Garnish with a few roasted pumpkin seeds or a swirl of low-fat yoghurt for added flavour.

**Serving size:** 300ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 140; Fat: 3g; Carbs: 28g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 6g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 6g

# Holiday Recipes

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## 191. Christmas Roast Turkey with Herb Infused Stuffing

**Preparation time:** 20 minutes

**Cooking time:** 2 hours & 30 minutes

**Servings:** 6

### Ingredients:

1 ½ kg turkey breast

- 60ml olive oil
- 150g wholemeal breadcrumbs
- 100g chopped onions
- 50g celery, finely chopped
- 2 tbsp fresh parsley, chopped
- 1 tbsp fresh sage, chopped

### Directions:

1. Preheat the oven to 180°C. In a pan, heat half the olive oil and sauté onions and celery until soft. Add breadcrumbs, parsley, and sage to the pan, mixing thoroughly.
2. Place turkey breast in a roasting tin and stuff with the herb mixture. Drizzle the remaining olive oil over the turkey and season accordingly.
3. Roast in the oven for 2 to 2.5 hours or until fully cooked. Let it rest for 15 minutes before carving.

**Tips:** Serve with steamed green vegetables for added fibre.

**Serving size:** 200g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 320; Fat: 12g; Carbs: 10g; Protein: 45g; Sodium: 85mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 115mg; Fibre: 3g

## **192. Easter Lemon and Dill Baked Salmon**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 500g salmon fillet
- Juice of one lemon
- Zest of one lemon
- 45ml olive oil
- Handful of fresh dill, chopped
- Salt and pepper to taste

**Directions:**

1. Preheat the oven to 200°C. Place salmon fillet on a lined baking tray.
2. In a small bowl, mix lemon juice, zest, olive oil, chopped dill, salt, and pepper. Pour this mixture evenly over the salmon fillet.
3. Bake for about 15-20 minutes until salmon is cooked through and flakes easily with a fork.

**Tips:** Pair with quinoa or brown rice for a balanced meal. Add your preferred herbs for additional flavour.

**Serving size:** 125g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 260; Fat: 14g; Carbs: 1g; Protein: 28g; Sodium: 70mg; Sugar: 0g; Cholesterol: 20mg; Fibre: 0g

### 193. Halloween Black Bean and Pumpkin Chilli

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 25 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 400g black beans, drained and rinsed
- 500g pumpkin, peeled and diced
- 1 onion, chopped
- 200g tinned tomatoes
- 1 red pepper, chopped
- 30ml olive oil
- 5g ground cumin

**Directions:**

1. Heat olive oil in a large pot over medium heat. Add the onion and pepper, then sauté for 5 minutes.
2. Stir in pumpkin, cumin, and tinned tomatoes, then cook for another 5 minutes. Add black beans and simmer for 15 minutes until pumpkin is tender.

**Tips:** Add fresh coriander as garnish for extra flavour.

**Serving size:** 300ml

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 192; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 28g; Protein: 7g; Sodium: 220mg; Sugar: 6g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 8g

## **194. Bonfire Night Smoky Sweet Potato Wedges**

**Preparation time:** 5 minutes

**Cooking time:** 30 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 600g sweet potatoes, cut into wedges
- 30ml olive oil
- 5g smoked paprika

**Directions:**

1. Preheat the oven to 200°C. Toss the sweet potato wedges in olive oil and smoked paprika until well-coated.
2. Spread on a lined baking tray and bake for about 30 minutes until crispy, turning halfway through cooking.

**Tips:** Serve with a yoghurt dip mixed with chopped chives for added texture and flavour.

**Serving size:** 150g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 190; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 30g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 50mg; Sugar: 6g; Cholesterol: 0mg; Fibre: 5g

## **195. New Year's Day Mushroom and Spinach Filo Parcels**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 200g mushrooms, sliced
- 100g fresh spinach
- 1 onion, finely chopped



- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 100g reduced-fat feta cheese, crumbled
- 4 sheets of filo pastry
- 15ml olive oil
- Salt and pepper to taste

**Directions:**

1. Preheat the oven to 180°C. In a frying pan, heat olive oil over medium heat. Sauté onions and garlic until soft. Add mushrooms and cook until golden brown.
2. Stir in spinach until wilted. Season with salt and pepper. Remove and let cool slightly. Mix the mushroom-spinach mixture with crumbled feta cheese.
3. Lay out one sheet of filo pastry, then brush lightly with olive oil. Place a quarter of the filling in the centre, fold the corners to form a parcel, and brush the top with olive oil.
4. Repeat with remaining sheets and filling. Place parcels on a baking tray and bake for about 20 minutes or until golden brown and crispy.

**Tips:** Ensure filo pastry is covered with a damp cloth while working to prevent it from drying.

**Serving size:** 1 parcel

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 175; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 15g; Protein: 8g; Sodium: 340mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 15mg; Fibre: 3g

## **196. Valentine's Day Beetroot and Goat's Cheese Salad**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** N/A

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 300g cooked beetroot, sliced
- 100g soft goat's cheese
- Mixed salad leaves (rocket, watercress), approximately 200g
- Handful of walnuts, roughly chopped

- Balsamic vinegar for dressing
- Extra virgin olive oil for dressing
- Salt and pepper to taste

**Directions:**

1. Arrange salad leaves on a large serving plate or four individual plates. Place beetroot slices on top of the leaves followed by crumbles of goat's cheese.
2. Sprinkle walnuts over the salad. Drizzle with balsamic vinegar and extra virgin olive oil as desired. Season with salt and pepper before serving.

**Tips:** Use pre-cooked beetroot to save time. To enhance flavour, toast walnuts lightly before adding them.

**Serving size:** One-quarter portion of the salad

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 220; Fat: 14g; Carbs: 16g; Protein: 7g; Sodium: 250mg; Sugar: 11g; Cholesterol: 10mg; Fibre: 4g

## 197. St George's Day Beef and Barley Hotpot

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 40 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

500g lean beef, diced

- 150g pearl barley
- 1 large onion, chopped
- 2 large carrots, sliced
- 1 litre low-sodium beef stock
- 30ml olive oil
- Salt and pepper to taste

**Directions:**

1. In a large pot, heat olive oil over medium heat. Add the onion and carrots and sauté until softened.
2. Add the diced beef, searing until browned on all sides. Season with salt and pepper. Stir in the barley, then pour in the beef stock. Let it boil.
3. Adjust to low heat, cover, and simmer for about 30 minutes or until the barley is cooked and tender.

**Tips:** For added flavour, sprinkle finely chopped parsley before serving.

**Serving size:** 1 bowl

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 350; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 45g; Protein: 28g; Sodium: 180mg; Sugar: 4g; Cholesterol: 70mg; Fibre: 8g

## **198.     Guy Fawkes Night Chickpea and Spinach Curry**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 20 minutes

**Servings:** 4

**Ingredients:**

- 400g canned chickpeas, drained and rinsed
- 100g fresh spinach leaves, washed
- 1 large onion, chopped
- 200ml coconut milk (light)
- 2 tbsp curry powder
- Salt to taste
- 15ml olive oil

**Directions:**

1. Heat olive oil in a pan over medium heat. Add the onion and sauté until translucent. Stir in curry powder, cooking for another minute until fragrant.
2. Add chickpeas to the pan followed by coconut milk, stirring everything together well. Simmer for about 10 minutes then add spinach leaves to wilt before serving.

**Tips:** Serve with a wedge of lime for added zest.

**Serving size:** ¼ of the recipe

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 240; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 28g; Protein: 15g; Sodium: 160mg; Sugar: 3g; Cholesterol: 12mg; Fibre: 8g

## **199. Boxing Day Turkey and Cranberry Stir-fry**

**Preparation time:** 10 minutes

**Cooking time:** 15 minutes

**Servings:** 4

### **Ingredients:**

- 500g cooked turkey breast, sliced
- 150g fresh cranberries
- 1 red bell pepper, sliced
- 100g sugar snap peas, halved
- 30ml olive oil
- 15ml low-sodium soy sauce
- 1 tsp grated ginger
- Salt and pepper to taste

### **Directions:**

1. Heat the olive oil in a large frying pan over medium heat. Add the ginger and sliced red bell pepper, cooking for about 3 minutes until softened.
2. Toss in the sugar snap peas and fresh cranberries, stir-frying for another 2 minutes.
3. Add the turkey slices to the pan, followed by the low-sodium soy sauce, stirring well to combine all ingredients. Cook for 5 minutes until heated through.
4. Season with salt and pepper to taste before serving hot on plates.

**Tips:** You can substitute cranberries with pomegranate seeds if preferred.

**Serving size:** 250g

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 290; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 16g; Protein: 38g; Sodium: 340mg; Sugar: 6g; Cholesterol: 85mg; Fibre: 3g

## **200. Easter Roast Lamb with Minted Peas**

**Preparation time:** 15 minutes

**Cooking time:** 60 minutes

**Servings:** 6

### **Ingredients:**

- 1.5kg leg of lamb
- Salt and pepper to taste
- Fresh rosemary sprigs
- 200ml chicken stock
- Juice of one lemon
- Zest of one lemon

### **For Minted Peas:**

- 500g frozen peas
- A small bunch of fresh mint leaves, chopped
- Zest of half a lemon
- Salt and pepper to taste

### **Directions:**

1. Preheat your oven to 190°C. Score the lamb leg and season thoroughly with salt, pepper, rosemary sprigs, lemon juice, and zest.
2. Place the lamb in a roasting tin with chicken stock at its base, and roast in the oven for about an hour or until done to your preference.
3. For minted peas, cook frozen peas in boiling water for about three minutes until tender then drain them well.
4. Stir through mint leaves along with lemon zest into cooked peas before seasoning them lightly with salt and freshly ground black pepper.

5. Serve warm roasted lamb slices alongside minted pea accompaniment on each plate.

**Tips:** Leftover lamb can be used for sandwiches or salads later adding variety through minimal food waste!

**Serving size:** 150g lamb + minty green peas separately served

**Nutritional values (per serving):** Calories: 420; Fat: 20g; Carbs: 12g; Protein: 45g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 2g; Cholesterol: 120mg; Fibre: 4g

# 60-DAY MEAL PLAN

| DAY | BREAKFAST                             | LUNCH                                                         | SNACK/DESSERT                                     | DINNER                                         |
|-----|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| 1   | Mushroom and Spinach Frittata         | Lentil and Vegetable Stew                                     | Cottage Cheese and Herb Spread on Breadsticks     | Lentil Shepherd's Pie with Mashed Sweet Potato |
| 2   | Herbed Quinoa Breakfast Pilaf         | Spinach and Strawberry Salad with Balsamic Vinaigrette        | Low-Sugar Cakes and Muffins                       | Chicken and Chickpea Stew with Spinach         |
| 3   | Thyme Roasted Sweet Potato Hash       | Moroccan Chickpea Stew                                        | Basil Pesto Yoghurt Dip with Carrot Chips         | Creamy Carrot and Coriander Soup               |
| 4   | Pepper Jack Stuffed Peppers           | Asian Cabbage Slaw with Sesame-Ginger Dressing                | Ginger and Pear Muffins                           | Thai Coconut Curry Chicken Thighs              |
| 5   | Cumin-Spiced Lentil Patties           | Quick Fish Chowder                                            | Greek Olive Tapenade on Rice Cakes                | Courgette Noodles with Pesto Sauce             |
| 6   | Cheesy Cauliflower Muffins            | Courgette Ribbon Salad with Chilli-Lime Vinaigrette           | Vanilla Chia Seed Cake                            | Pork and Apple Braised Cabbage Pot             |
| 7   | Spicy Baked Beans on Wholegrain Toast | Tomato Basil Soup                                             | Eggplant Baba Ganoush with Pita Crisps            | Baked Sweet Potato Stuffed with Quinoa Salad   |
| 8   | Tomato and Avocado Breakfast Bake     | Mixed Berry Salad with Honey-Mustard Drizzle                  | Coconut and Lime Cupcakes                         | Mediterranean Chickpea and Spinach Skillet     |
| 9   | Mediterranean Vegetable Stir Fry      | Chicken and Mushroom Soup                                     | Creamy Avocado Salsa Dip with Wholegrain Crackers | Vegan Black Bean Chilli with Avocado           |
| 10  | Savoury Courgette Bread with Seeds    | Roasted Beetroot and Goat's Cheese Salad with Walnut Dressing | Almond and Lemon Drizzle Cake                     | Turkey Mince and Kidney Bean Chilli            |

|           |                                            |                                                            |                                              |                                                       |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>11</b> | Vegetable Omelette with Spinach and Tomato | Turkey and Kale Soup                                       | Baked Sweet Potato Chips with Lentil Dip     | Spicy Chickpea and Quinoa Stir Fry                    |
| <b>12</b> | Cottage Cheese and Berry Parfait           | Grilled Vegetable Salad with Basil Pesto                   | Blueberry and Yogurt Muffins                 | Vegetable Lentil Soup with Herbs                      |
| <b>13</b> | Poached Egg on Whole Grain Toast           | Spiced Pumpkin Stew                                        | Spinach Artichoke Dip with Oat Crackers      | Mushroom and Spinach Risotto                          |
| <b>14</b> | Protein-Packed Veggie Breakfast Burrito    | Quinoa Tabbouleh with Mint Dressing                        | Spiced Apple and Cinnamon Cake               | Sausage, Tomato, and Pepper Stew                      |
| <b>15</b> | Lean Turkey Sausage Egg Bake               | Creamy Cauliflower Soup                                    | Beetroot Hummus with Seeded Crackers         | Cauliflower and Broccoli Tikka Masala                 |
| <b>16</b> | Grilled Chicken Breakfast Wrap             | Avocado and Black Bean Salad with Lime- Coriander Dressing | Sugar-Free Banana Bread                      | Cod and Vegetable Ratatouille Medley                  |
| <b>17</b> | Quinoa Protein Pancakes                    | Spicy Sweet Potato Soup                                    | Roasted Red Pepper Hummus with Veggie Sticks | Roasted Red Pepper and Tomato Soup                    |
| <b>18</b> | Tofu Scramble with Mixed Vegetables        | Greek Salad with Herbed Olive Oil Dressing                 | Zesty Orange Polenta Cake                    | Tuscan White Bean Chicken Skillet                     |
| <b>19</b> | Egg White Veggie Muffins                   | Beef and Broccoli Stir-Fry Soup                            | Smoked Salmon Spread on Rye Crispbread       | Aubergine Bolognese over Whole Wheat Spaghetti        |
| <b>20</b> | Smoked Salmon Scrambled Eggs               | Chickpea and Tomato Salad with Lemon-Tahini Dressing       | Carrot and Walnut Muffins                    | Beef and Barley Casserole with Mushrooms              |
| <b>21</b> | Apple Cinnamon Porridge                    | Chicken Caesar Lettuce Wraps                               | Walnut and Chia Seed Energy Balls            | Balanced Grilled and Roasted Proteins with Vegetables |



|    |                                       |                                                |                                         |                                                      |
|----|---------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| 22 | Berry Spinach Smoothie                | Lentil Shepherd's Pie with Mashed Sweet Potato | Raspberry and Oat Muffins               | Moroccan Spiced Roast Duck with Carrots              |
| 23 | Apricot and Hazelnut Breakfast Bowl   | Caprese Salad Chicken Sandwich                 | Almond Flour and Cranberry Cookies      | Spring Asparagus and Pea Risotto                     |
| 24 | Apple Cinnamon Protein Shake          | Creamy Carrot and Coriander Soup               | Dark Chocolate Avocado Mousse           | Ginger Soy Chicken Thighs with Bok Choy              |
| 25 | Cinnamon Raisin High-Fibre Cereal Mix | Roast Beef and Horseradish Lettuce Wraps       | Pecan and Pear Mini Tarts               | Autumn Spiced Butternut Squash Soup                  |
| 26 | Ginger Peach Protein Shake            | Courgette Noodles with Pesto Sauce             | Coconut Milk Hot Chocolate              | Grilled Cod Fillets with Cherry Tomatoes and Spinach |
| 27 | Blackberry Almond Crisp Oats          | Hummus and Veggie Stuffed Pita Pockets         | Sunflower Seed and Raspberry Snack Bars | Summer Tomato and Basil Gazpacho                     |
| 28 | Mango Turmeric Smoothie               | Baked Sweet Potato Stuffed with Quinoa Salad   | Sugar-Free Chocolate Lava Cakes         | Paprika Spiced Beef Steaks with Courgettes           |
| 29 | Banana Nut High-Fibre Porridge        | Smoked Salmon and Cucumber Sandwich            | Blueberry and Hazelnut Overnight Oats   | Summer Berry and Spinach Salad                       |
| 30 | Avocado and Mint Smoothie             | Vegan Black Bean Chilli with Avocado           | Hazelnut Cocoa Truffles                 | Garlic and Thyme Roasted Sea Bass with Green Beans   |
| 31 | Pumpkin Spice Oatmeal with Walnuts    | Egg and Spinach Breakfast Wrap                 | Cashew and Mango Coconut Rice Pudding   | Spring Green Vegetable Frittata                      |
| 32 | Coconut and Lime Green Shake          | Aubergine Bolognese over Whole Wheat Spaghetti | Baked Chocolate Custard Pots            | Rosemary Infused Lamb Chops with Cauliflower         |
| 33 | Raspberry Chia Breakfast Bowl         | Grilled Chicken and Peppers Lettuce Boats      | Pumpkin Seed and Apricot Granola Bars   | Winter Beetroot and Apple Slaw                       |

|           |                                        |                                                        |                                          |                                                 |
|-----------|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| <b>34</b> | Blueberry and Almond Smoothie          | Mushroom and Spinach Risotto                           | Cocoa and Almond Butter Fudge            | Lemon Herb Grilled Chicken with Asparagus       |
| <b>35</b> | Chia Berry Overnight Oats              | Turkey and Avocado Collard Greens Wraps                | Almond and Apple Quinoa Salad            | Autumn Pumpkin and Sage Quiche                  |
| <b>36</b> | Kale and Kiwi Smoothie                 | Cauliflower and Broccoli Tikka Masala                  | Pistachio Chocolate Bark                 | Grilled Lime Marinated Pork Chops with Broccoli |
| <b>37</b> | Flaxseed and Blueberry Porridge        | Tuna and Cucumber Nori Wraps                           | Pistachio-Crusted Chicken Tenders        | Autumn Root Vegetable Stew                      |
| <b>38</b> | Peanut Butter Banana Shake             | Roasted Red Pepper and Tomato Soup                     | Dark Chocolate Chia Pudding              | Cajun Spice Turkey Breasts with Bell Peppers    |
| <b>39</b> | Quinoa Breakfast Bowl with Almond Milk | Mediterranean Veggie Flatbread Sandwich                | Flaxseed and Banana Smoothie Bowl        | Summer Herb Grilled Chicken with Courgettes     |
| <b>40</b> | Chia Seed and Cinnamon Shake           | Spicy Chickpea and Quinoa Stir Fry                     | Black Bean Chocolate Cake                | Balsamic Roasted Salmon and Brussels Sprouts    |
| <b>41</b> | Mushroom and Spinach Frittata          | Lentil and Vegetable Stew                              | Baked Kale Chips with Sea Salt           | Winter Spiced Carrot and Lentil Soup            |
| <b>42</b> | Herbed Quinoa Breakfast Pilaf          | Spinach and Strawberry Salad with Balsamic Vinaigrette | Sugar-Free Chocolate Brownies            | Lentil Shepherd's Pie with Mashed Sweet Potato  |
| <b>43</b> | Thyme Roasted Sweet Potato Hash        | Moroccan Chickpea Stew                                 | Strawberries with Dark Chocolate Drizzle | Chicken and Chickpea Stew with Spinach          |
| <b>44</b> | Pepper Jack Stuffed Peppers            | Asian Cabbage Slaw with Sesame-Ginger Dressing         | Celery Sticks with Peanut Butter         | Creamy Carrot and Coriander Soup                |
| <b>45</b> | Cumin-Spiced Lentil Patties            | Quick Fish Chowder                                     | Avocado and Tomato Lettuce Wraps         | Thai Coconut Curry Chicken Thighs               |

|    |                                            |                                                               |                                         |                                              |
|----|--------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| 46 | Cheesy Cauliflower Muffins                 | Courgette Ribbon Salad with Chilli-Lime Vinaigrette           | Wholegrain Crackers with Low-Fat Cheese | Courgette Noodles with Pesto Sauce           |
| 47 | Spicy Baked Beans on Wholegrain Toast      | Tomato Basil Soup                                             | Carrot Sticks with Low-Fat Ranch Dip    | Pork and Apple Braised Cabbage Pot           |
| 48 | Tomato and Avocado Breakfast Bake          | Mixed Berry Salad with Honey-Mustard Drizzle                  | Roasted Chickpeas with Paprika          | Baked Sweet Potato Stuffed with Quinoa Salad |
| 49 | Mediterranean Vegetable Stir Fry           | Chicken and Mushroom Soup                                     | Apple Slices with Almond Butter         | Mediterranean Chickpea and Spinach Skillet   |
| 50 | Savoury Courgette Bread with Seeds         | Roasted Beetroot and Goat's Cheese Salad with Walnut Dressing | Greek Yoghurt Parfait with Berries      | Vegan Black Bean Chilli with Avocado         |
| 51 | Vegetable Omelette with Spinach and Tomato | Turkey and Kale Soup                                          | Cucumber Slices with Hummus             | Turkey Mince and Kidney Bean Chilli          |
| 52 | Cottage Cheese and Berry Parfait           | Grilled Vegetable Salad with Basil Pesto                      | Baked Cinnamon Apples with Nuts         | Spicy Chickpea and Quinoa Stir Fry           |
| 53 | Poached Egg on Whole Grain Toast           | Spiced Pumpkin Stew                                           | Poached Pears with Vanilla Cream        | Vegetable Lentil Soup with Herbs             |
| 54 | Protein-Packed Veggie Breakfast Burrito    | Quinoa Tabbouleh with Mint Dressing                           | Stewed Plums in Red Wine Sauce          | Mushroom and Spinach Risotto                 |
| 55 | Lean Turkey Sausage Egg Bake               | Creamy Cauliflower Soup                                       | Sugar-free Mango Sorbet                 | Sausage, Tomato, and Pepper Stew             |
| 56 | Grilled Chicken Breakfast Wrap             | Avocado and Black Bean Salad with Lime- Coriander Dressing    | Grilled Pineapple Skewers               | Cauliflower and Broccoli Tikka Masala        |
| 57 | Quinoa Protein Pancakes                    | Spicy Sweet Potato Soup                                       | Citrus Fruit Salad with Mint            | Cod and Vegetable Ratatouille Medley         |

|           |                                     |                                                      |                                    |                                                |
|-----------|-------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| <b>58</b> | Tofu Scramble with Mixed Vegetables | Greek Salad with Herbed Olive Oil Dressing           | Warm Berry Compote                 | Roasted Red Pepper and Tomato Soup             |
| <b>59</b> | Egg White Veggie Muffins            | Beef and Broccoli Stir-Fry Soup                      | Roasted Peach Parfait              | Tuscan White Bean Chicken Skillet              |
| <b>60</b> | Smoked Salmon Scrambled Eggs        | Chickpea and Tomato Salad with Lemon-Tahini Dressing | Fresh Berry Fool with Greek Yogurt | Aubergine Bolognese over Whole Wheat Spaghetti |

# CONCLUSION

Now, I hope you feel empowered and motivated to embrace a lifestyle that supports the effective management of type 2 diabetes. The recipes and meal plans offered are crafted not only to be delicious but also mindful of nutritional goals that help maintain steady blood sugar levels. I want to take a moment to encourage you in your ongoing management of type 2 diabetes, as it is a lifelong commitment that can lead to significant rewards in terms of health and well-being.

It's important to remember that consistent management doesn't stop at the dinner table. Incorporating physical activity into your daily routine is an additional pillar of diabetes care. Regular exercise aids in regulating blood glucose levels, enhances cardiovascular health, and can boost your mood. You don't need to begin with intense workouts; activities like walking, cycling, or even dancing can be enjoyable ways to stay active. Start at a comfortable pace and gradually increase intensity as you feel more confident in your abilities.

Achieving these nutritional and physical activity goals can often feel challenging, particularly when life gets busy or during times of stress. However, one effective strategy is to celebrate small victories. Each step towards better health is an accomplishment worth recognising. Whether it's choosing a healthy option at a restaurant, completing a weekly exercise goal, or attending regular check-ups with your healthcare provider, these actions contribute significantly towards managing your diabetes.

Developing a habit of setting achievable short-term goals can foster motivation and provide tangible successes along the way. Perhaps aim for cooking three new recipes from this book each week or plan your meals ahead for several days. Use this as a valuable tool in understanding what works for you in controlling blood sugar while enjoying diverse flavours and dishes.

Staying informed about type 2 diabetes is also important. Being aware of the latest dietary recommendations or research helps make proactive choices regarding both food and lifestyle changes. Engage with support groups, whether online or in person; they offer communal encouragement and shared experiences that can enhance personal resolve.

Always communicate openly with healthcare professionals about any concerns or changes in how you feel physically or emotionally. This dialogue helps tailor your management plan effectively. As you close this book, know that success lies not merely in reaching a destination but in embracing the journey itself with positivity and determination. Thank you for letting me guide you through this chapter toward healthier living with type 2 diabetes.

*Here's wishing you continued progress, newfound culinary adventures, and above all, sustained health.*

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# MEASUREMENTS AND CONVERSIONS

| VOLUME EQUIVALENTS (LIQUID) |               |           |
|-----------------------------|---------------|-----------|
| METRIC (APPROX.)            | US STANDARD   | US OUNCES |
| 5 ml                        | 1 tsp         | 1/6 oz    |
| 15 ml                       | 1 tbsp        | 1/2 oz    |
| 30 ml                       | 1 fluid ounce | 1 oz      |
| 240 ml                      | 1 cup         | 8 oz      |
| 475 ml                      | 1 pint        | 16 oz     |
| 950 ml                      | 1 quart       | 32 oz     |
| 3.8 L                       | 1 gallon      | 128 oz    |

| VOLUME EQUIVALENTS (DRY) |             | WEIGHT EQUIVALENTS |                  |
|--------------------------|-------------|--------------------|------------------|
| METRIC (APPROX.)         | US STANDARD | METRIC (APPROX.)   | US STANDARD      |
| 1.25 ml                  | 1/4 tsp     | 28 g               | 1 ounce          |
| 2.5 ml                   | 1/2 tsp     | 113 g              | 4 ounces         |
| 5 ml                     | 1 tsp       | 225 g              | 8 ounces         |
| 60 ml                    | 1/4 cup     | 340 g              | 12 ounces        |
| 80 ml                    | 1/3 cup     | 455 g              | One pound (16oz) |
| 120 ml                   | 1/2 cup     |                    |                  |
| 240 ml                   | 1 cup       |                    |                  |

| OVEN TEMPERATURES |            |
|-------------------|------------|
| CELSIUS (APPROX.) | FAHRENHEIT |
| 93° C             | 200° F     |
| 107° C            | 225° F     |
| 121° C            | 250° F     |
| 135° C            | 275° F     |
| 149° C            | 300° F     |
| 163° C            | 325° F     |
| 177° C            | 350° F     |
| 191° C            | 375°F      |
| 204° C            | 400°F      |
| 218°C             | 425°F      |

*Note: The values in the tables are approximate and should be used for reference as a guide when cooking.*